CHENNAI - SUNDAY - OCTOBER 11, 2026

₹12 • Pages 14 • Volume 33 • Number 282

www.thehindubusinessline.com/portfolio

BlPortfolio Blportfolio BL Portfolio

the hindu businessline.

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

LUXURY LIVING

In The Heart of Coimbatore, Peelamedu

HAVEN

An exclusive collection of **40 premium 3 & 4 BHK residences,** set across **1 acre** with a **Stilt + 8-floor** configuration and zero wall sharing, defined by contemporary design and elevated living.

24 YEARS OF EXCELLENCE

Centralized AC | Italian Marble Flooring | Italian Catalano Fittings | Aluminum Fixtures | Premium Amenities

+91 98426 22222

www.blueleafspaces.com

enquiry@blueleafspaces.com

Near PSG Primary School, Peelamedu, Coimbatore - 641004

BLUE LEAF

ELEVATED LIVING. DISTINCTLY CRAFTED.

TNRERA/11/BLG/0358/2026 Dated 06.10.2026

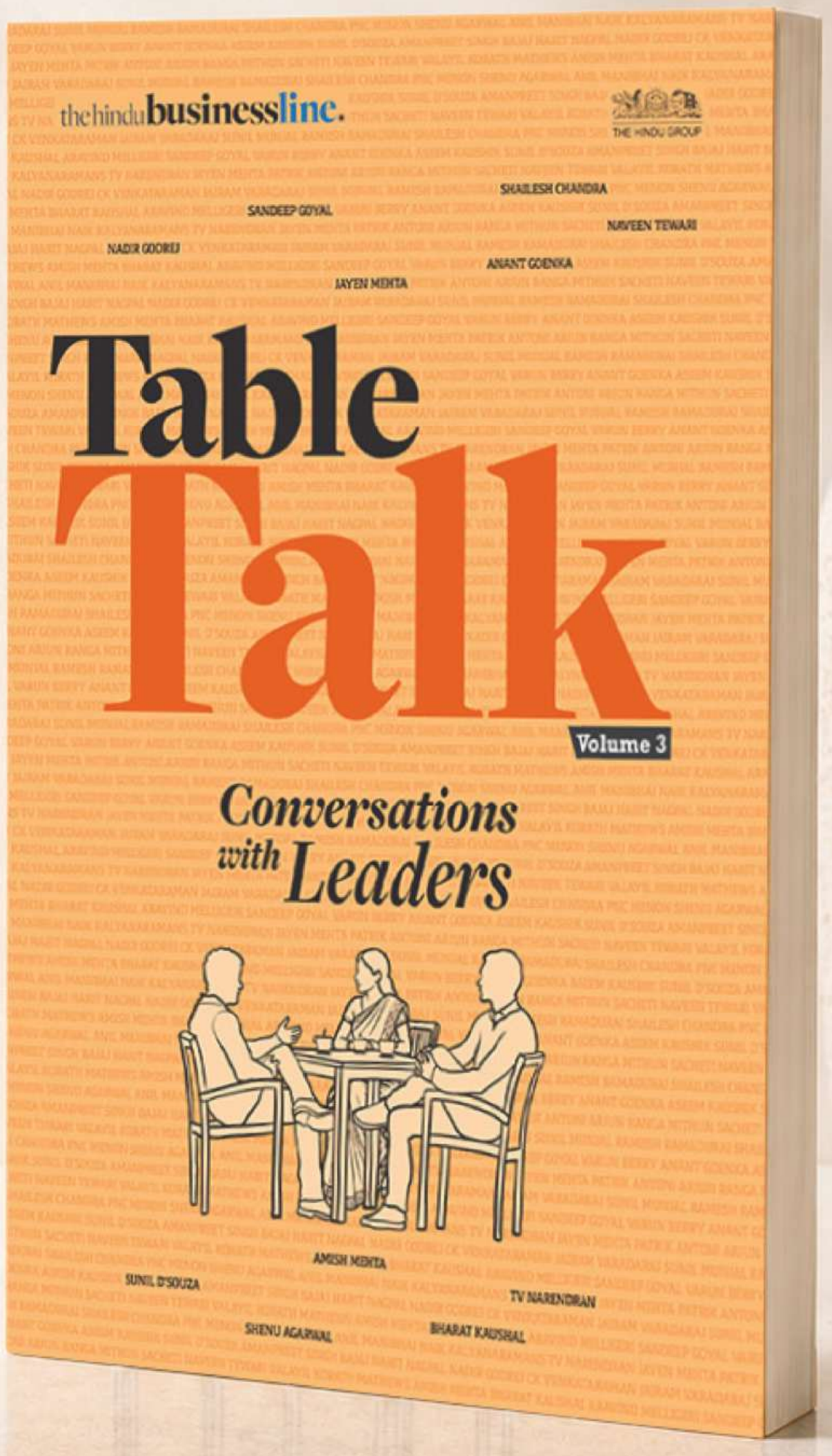
THE HINDU GROUP

A Special Publication from

www.businessline.in businessline thehindubusinessline

thehindu businessline.

The third volume in our Table Talk series brings you fascinating insights on the personalities of business leaders and how they run their companies



NEW ARRIVAL

COVER PRICE
₹400*

SCAN QR CODE OR VISIT
newsth.live/THBookStore

THG BOOKS

For bulk booking and enquiries, contact us at bookstore@thehindu.co.in

* Shipping charges applicable | Terms and Conditions apply

CHENNAI - SUNDAY - OCTOBER 11, 2026

₹12 • Pages 14 • Volume 33 • Number 282

www.thehindubusinessline.com/portfolio

BlPortfolio Blportfolio BL Portfolio

the hindu businessline.

bl.portfolio



Open secret.
The balance sheets that threaten to throw AI 'off' balance
BIG STORY P2



Real Returns.
What should investors' debt strategy be amid rising rates?
YOUR MONEY P3

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

Overseas ETFs: Nearly 30% of turnover at inflated prices

PREMIUM PAIN. Price-NAV gaps widen amid investment curbs, as overseas exchange traded funds continue to see sustained trading on local bourses

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

With Indian equities delivering paltry returns over the past two-and-a-half years, many investors have turned to overseas markets in search of better opportunities. However, this shift towards global investments, particularly US technology and Artificial Intelligence (AI) stocks, has brought an unexpected risk.

The high price of going global

Nearly 30% of overseas ETF trades in 2026 executed above NAV

Year	Total traded value across BSE and NSE (₹ crore)	Turnover executed at a premium to NAV (₹ crore)	Premium turnover as % of total turnover
2022*	3,162	62	2
2023	3,772	20	1
2024	7,970	424	5
2025	12,485	1,372	11
YTD 2026**	10,440	3,094	30
Grand Total	37,829	4,972	13

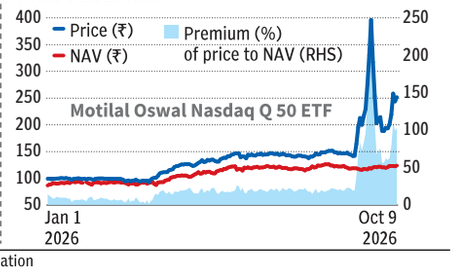
From February 2, 2022, when the RBI imposed restrictions on fresh overseas investments by mutual funds
**YTD as of Oct 09, 2026

Average & maximum premium across six ETFs^

Overseas ETF	(in %) Min	Avg	Max
Mirae Asset Hang Seng TECH ETF	20	24	27
Mirae Asset NYSE FANG+ ETF	27	35	50
Mirae Asset S&P 500 Top 50 ETF	39	49	83
Motilal Oswal NASDAQ 100 ETF	11	17	26
Motilal Oswal Nasdaq Q 50 ETF	38	93	235
Nippon India ETF Hang Seng BEES	1	3	4

^Calculated using trading data for the 21 trading days from September 9 to October 9, 2026

Price versus NAV†



†Based on NSE price

Source: ACEMF, Bloomberg, BSE and NSE bl.portfolio compilation

STARK DISCONNECT

An overseas exchange-traded fund (ETF) worth about ₹118 a unit traded at as much as ₹396 on Indian exchanges last month. The episode highlights a stark disconnect between market price and underlying value, undermining the low-cost appeal of passive investing.

The price distortion is not confined to one ETF but reflects a broader phenomenon across all six international ETFs.

Together, these funds recorded a turnover of ₹10,440 crore on the NSE and BSE so far in 2026, of which an estimated ₹3,094 crore involved trades at prices above net asset value (NAV), according to an analysis by *bl.portfolio*.

Motilal Oswal Nasdaq Q50 ETF's market price surged from ₹142 on September 4 to ₹396.30 on September 18, against an NAV of ₹118.14, taking its premium to 235 per cent. Buyers were paying more than three times the underlying asset value, knowingly or otherwise. The ETF's market price subsequently plunged to about ₹188 on September 28 before recovering to ₹252 by October 9. Its NAV, however, rose to ₹123.80 on October 9 from ₹118.14 on September 18. The sharp divergence illustrates how ETF prices can fluctuate dramatically without comparable movements in their underlying investments.

An analysis of market-price premiums over NAV across 21 trading sessions in the past month reveals wide divergences. Mirae Asset S&P 500 Top 50 ETF averaged a 49 per cent premium, peaking at 83 per cent. Mirae Asset NYSE FANG+ ETF averaged a 35 per cent premium, Mirae Asset Hang Seng TECH ETF 24 per cent and Motilal Oswal Nasdaq 100 ETF 17 per cent. Nippon India ETF Hang Seng BeES was relatively insulated, averaging a premium of 3 per cent.

By contrast, overseas ETFs listed in other countries tracking similar indices traded at premiums or discounts ranging from a marginal 0.01 per cent discount to a 15 per cent premium. China's Guotai Nasdaq-100 ETF traded at a 15 per cent premium to NAV, while South Korea's Samsung KODEX US NASDAQ 100 ETF traded at a 0.01 per cent discount. South Africa's Satrix S&P 500 ETF and China Southern S&P 500 ETF traded at premiums of 0.3 per cent and 8.6 per cent, respectively.

TRADING SURGE

The six ETFs recorded about 25.3 lakh trades across the NSE and BSE during the 21-session period. Elevated trading activity, sharp price swings and steep premiums point to intense short-term speculation.

Jatin Vasaria, Head of Products, Passive Funds, Motilal Oswal AMC, said the Motilal Oswal Nasdaq Q50 ETF, which previously recorded daily trading volumes of around ₹4-5 crore on a good day, suddenly saw volumes jump to ₹50-60 crore. Such activity was unusual for the fund, he said.

The surge suggests that some traders who entered during the initial rally may have booked profits as prices corrected, while fresh buying may have supported the subsequent recovery.

SUPPLY SQUEEZE

The distortion stems from overseas investment limits of $7 billion for overseas securities and $1 billion for overseas ETFs. These caps have constrained domestic fund houses from creating fresh units despite sustained demand for global equities.

Normally, authorised participants create or redeem ETF units to keep market prices aligned with NAV through arbitrage. Restrictions on fresh unit creation weaken this mechanism, allowing premiums to widen when demand outstrips supply.

The sharp price movements have also coincided with changes to the framework governing ETF trading bands. Following SEBI's June 15 circular, exchanges implemented revised trading parameters from September 7, changing the reference used to determine permissible price movements. Previously, the reference NAV was from two trading days earlier (T-2). Under the revised mechanism, the base price is linked to the previous trading day's closing price. This may have enabled sharper price movements in ETFs already facing supply constraints.

SEBI has also asked exchanges and asset management companies to work towards adopting the previous trading day's closing NAV as the base price from April 1, 2027.

The unusual premiums have prompted warnings from both the NSE and BSE. They could narrow if overseas investment limits are raised, allowing fund houses to create fresh units, or as changes to the T-1 NAV-based price-band framework take effect.

For investors, the risk is two-fold: A decline in overseas markets and an erosion of the premium paid to acquire ETF units. Even if the underlying securities hold their value, a sharp contraction in the premium could cause substantial losses for investors who buy at elevated market prices.

Regulatory changes could eventually ease these distortions, potentially triggering a swift and sharp correction in ETF prices.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

HDFC Flexi Cap Fund

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

HDFC Flexi Cap Fund has built a strong long-term record without taking aggressive bets on smaller companies. The ₹1.14-lakh-crore scheme, which carries a 5-star *bl.portfolio* Star Track rating, has delivered impressive rolling returns while containing downside risks.

Over seven years of NAV history, its three-year rolling returns averaged 24.26 per cent against 18.19 per cent for the Nifty 500 TRI. Its portfolio remains predominantly large-cap, though recent shifts towards mid-caps and active sector rotation reflect a more flexible investment approach. The fund also scores well on risk-adjusted returns and expenses.

Its relatively measured risk profile, consistent long-term performance and predominantly large-cap portfolio make HDFC Flexi Cap Fund a suitable core equity holding for investors with a long-term horizon.

Details P4

RBI tightens forex derivatives framework, opens a separate dollar window for oil marketing companies

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India on Saturday announced a series of restrictions on foreign exchange (forex) derivatives contracts and opened a special window to meet the entire daily dollar requirements of three public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs), citing evolving market conditions and the need to ensure orderly functioning of the forex market.

The measures come amid a weakening rupee and may be aimed at preventing the currency from breaching the 97/dollar mark.

Under the new rules, authorised dealers (ADs) — banks authorised to deal in forex — cannot allow users to rebook any rupee-involving forex derivative contract that has been cancelled after the issuance of the directions. The restriction covers both deliverable and non-deliverable contracts. Rollover of contracts on maturity will continue to be permitted, subject to existing regulatory provisions.

The RBI also cut the threshold for undertaking forex derivative transactions to hedge contracted exposures without establishing the underlying exposure from $100 million to $5 million across all ADs.

The corresponding threshold for taking positions in exchange-traded currency derivatives involving the rupee, without establishing an underlying exposure, has been reduced from $100 million to $5 million across all recognised stock exchanges combined.

ADs must also obtain and retain an undertaking from users entering into rupee-involving forex derivative contracts to hedge contracted exposures, confirming that the same underlying exposure has not been hedged through another AD.

FOREX RISK RESERVE

For rupee-involving forex derivative contracts with a notional value exceeding $2 million, ADs must maintain a Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve with the RBI in cash, equivalent to 20 per cent of the rupee value of each transaction.

The requirement applies to such contracts undertaken to hedge current account exposures where the user buys foreign currency against the rupee.

V Rama Chandra Reddy, Head of Treasury, Karur Vysya Bank, said the 20 per cent cash reserve requirement on specified transactions exceeding $2 million would impose an additional liquidity cost and discourage excessive positions.

The measures appear aimed at curbing excessive speculative positions, preventing duplicate hedging of the same exposure and ensuring that forex derivatives are used primarily for genuine risk management, he said.

"It would.... be more credible to say the measures may help moderate excessive positioning rather than claim that they will necessarily strengthen the currency. The rupee will continue to be influenced by global factors and underlying dollar demand and supply," he said.

$ WINDOW FOR OIL COS

Separately, the RBI said it would open a special window to meet the entire daily dollar requirements of three public sector OMCs — Indian Oil Corporation, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation and Bharat Petroleum Corporation.

Under the facility, the RBI will sell dollars to the OMCs through designated banks. The facility takes effect on October 12, and will remain in place until further notice.

Anti-CEC protest: Barricades, detentions disrupt Delhi; CJP, Opposition leaders detained



DETAINED. TMC Chief Mamata Banerjee with party MPs Dola Sen and Pratima Mondal in a police van after being detained by the Delhi Police during a protest seeking resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, in New Delhi on Saturday ANI

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

Defying a blanket ban on protests at Jantar Mantar, demonstrators continued to pour into Delhi.

While the protest site was turned into a fortress, with people approaching the area detained, impromptu sit-ins happened on several major roads leading to it.

More than 4,000 people had been detained since Saturday morning, including top leaders of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP). Abhijeet Dipke, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were detained soon after it landed in Delhi. They were taken to an undisclosed location, but not before their detention was captured live on video.

Dipke went live on Instagram as police personnel boarded the aircraft, recording the commotion as the leaders questioned the action. "You could have waited till we came out. Come, arrest us, we are not afraid," he was seen telling women police personnel. He had travelled from Mumbai to Delhi to lead the planned protest at Jantar Mantar demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

In a statement, the CJP condemned what it called the "authoritarian detention" of Dipke, Das and Ranka. Following the detention of its top leadership, the party named Ajinkya Shinde as the new in-charge of the protests in Delhi. Earlier in the morning,

YouTuber Dhruv Rathee and Ratna Singh, head of the CJP legal cell, were detained at their homes to prevent them from joining the protest, according to information available.

Meanwhile, BJP MP Ravi Shankar Prasad said at a press conference in Delhi that the day's developments showed that "Indian democracy has crushed the attempts to promote anarchy".

He added that "the country will be governed through Parliament, not the streets".

OPPOSITION LEADERS DETAINED

The protest was called to demand Gyanesh Kumar's resignation over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Several Opposition leaders were detained, including former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee and five Trinamool Congress leaders, including Rajya Sabha MPs Derek O'Brien and Dola Sen; Aam Aadmi Party chief and former Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal; former Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan; CPI(M) general secretary M A Baby and party veteran Brinda Karat; former Tripura Chief Minister Manik Sarkar; CPI(M) leaders MV Govindan, A Vijayaraghavan, KK Shailaja, John Brittas, K N Balagopal and PK Sreemathi; and CPI(ML) Liberation general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya.

Congress leaders stayed away from the protest, with Rahul Gandhi travelling to Tamil Nadu for the 'Chattron ki Goonj' event.

HEAVY SECURITY DEPLOYMENT

The Delhi Police set up 12 detention centres. Chhatrasal Stadium in north Delhi and Rajiv Gandhi Stadium in Bawana, north-west Delhi, were among the locations used to hold detained protesters. The police also put up 37 blocking points across the New Delhi district to prevent demonstrators from reaching Jantar Mantar.

Around 35,000 Delhi Police and Central Armed Police Forces personnel, along with forces from Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Haryana, were deployed to contain the protests. The day unfolded into a cat-and-mouse game, with protesters attempting to reach the site braving restrictions and extensive security deployments. Several journalists were also detained.

E-commerce festival sales start with a bang driven by Tier-2/-3 town participation, premium purchases

Our Bureau
Bengaluru



WIDER REACH. Festival demand is spreading beyond metros, with shoppers balancing discounts and financing options with aspirational purchases

India's festival shopping season opened on a strong note, with Flipkart, Amazon, Myntra and Meesho reporting sharp increases in orders, customer participation and demand from smaller towns. Shoppers combined value-led purchases with premium upgrades across categories.

Flipkart recorded 6.3 million concurrent users in a minute during the opening hour of its 13th Big Billion Days sale, while sessions crossed 287 million during early access. New customers grew 34 per cent, with nearly half of visits in the opening hour coming from Tier-3 towns and beyond. Non-metro customers accounted for about 60 per cent of demand.

Amazon said the opening of its Great Indian Festival was the biggest in the event's history, with products ordered rising more than 100 per cent year-on-year. Orders came from every pin code, while sales of premium Android smartphones grew 70 per cent year-on-year. Fashion sales reached seven times the level of a regular day.

PREMIUM SHIFT

Myntra's Big Fashion Festival (BFF), which began on October 8, recorded a four-fold surge in demand over business-as-usual levels in its first 24 hours. Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities contributed more than half of first-day orders, while the average order value exceeded that on the opening day of last year's edition, pointing to a shift towards premium purchases.

Meesho's Mega Blockbuster Sale also saw strong traction, with Day 1 orders rising about 75 per cent year-on-year and transacting customers growing around 60 per cent. Orders peaked at more than 75,000 a minute within 15 minutes of the sale going live.

The early trends point to festival demand spreading beyond metros, even as shoppers seek discounts and financing options alongside aspirational products.

APPLIANCE SALES UP

Electronics, fashion, beauty and home products featured prominently across platforms. On Flipkart, large-appliance sales grew 30 per cent year-on-year in the opening hour, while tablet sales rose 73 per cent. Beauty product sales increased 42 per cent, driven by men's grooming and personal care.

Amazon reported strong demand for premium electronics and home upgrades. Sales of laptops, premium wearables and large appliances rose sharply over regular-day levels, while televisions measuring 55 inches and above accounted for 65 per cent of TV sales. Fashion sales reached seven times the regular-day level, with footwear, denim and ethnic wear driving demand.

On Myntra, menswear and womenswear were among the most sought-after products. The platform also reported strong demand for occasion wear, beauty products and premium brands.

Meesho saw strong demand for clothing, beauty products and home essentials. Orders through its branded shopping proposition, Meesho Mall, grew more than 200 per cent year-on-year, while customers from Tier-3 and smaller markets nearly tripled.

Q-COMM GAINS

Quick commerce also gained traction as platforms extended rapid delivery beyond everyday essentials. Flipkart Minutes recorded a 3.5-fold increase in order volumes over regular days during its opening phase, while new customers grew 11x in the first hour.

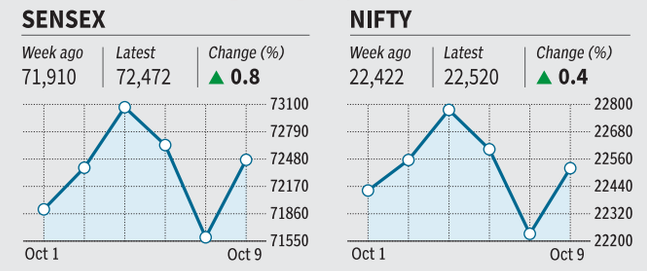
Myntra's M-Now's orders doubled on BFF's first day, reflecting demand for faster delivery during festive shopping. Amazon said that in more than 120 cities served by Amazon Now, one in every two products was delivered within minutes.

bl.portfolio

WISE WORDS.

> Enron and Tyco and WorldCom — but that wave of fraud was due to the fact we had a 10-year bull market and people began to believe things that were too good to be true.
>
> **JIM CHANOS**
> Legendary Forensic Investor

MARKET ACTION.



Balance sheets that can throw AI 'off' balance

OPEN SECRET. In a world where investing in AI is the only game in town, investors must warm up to these off balance sheet realities and risks they pose to global markets

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

If AI is too complex to comprehend, so are the jargons that surround the business models of AI companies. Not keeping track of them could mean staying behind the curve when it comes to what is apparently the most disruptive and transformative force the world has seen since the industrial revolution. It probably is the most disruptive force the investing world has seen as well. Keeping this in mind, at *bl.portfolio*, we have been demystifying the AI world via a series of articles namely, *Too big to fail* (September 21, 2025), *When bits and bytes take a large bite* (May 31, 2026), *Welcome to the world of AI-nomics* (July 12, 2026) and *AI's dotcom déjà vu* (August 2, 2026).

Today, we deep dive into a few key aspects that have been making ripples recently, when it comes to the AI theme. We are talking about off balance sheet debt and variable interest entities.

These have become too big to ignore that quite a few experts have voiced their concerns. *Big Short* investor Michael Burry, who is known to have short positions on AI stocks, recently warned in his newsletter that the off balance sheet liabilities are in 'hypergrowth mode' and added, 'When the music's over, these off-balance sheet commitments become real liabilities very quickly'. Another *Big Short* investor Steve Eisman, had expressed that the off balance sheet debt and the existence of variable interest entities or VIEs reminded him of the Enron scandal.

So, what is up with these jargons? We unpack here.

OFF BALANCE SHEET DEBT

Off balance sheet debt or off balance sheet obligations (sometimes called hidden debt too) is simple, if one understands the substance of these transactions and why they are disclosed off the balance sheet.

In so far as hyperscalers are concerned, off balance sheet obligations appear in two forms:

- Leases (largely for data centres) that are yet to commence
- Obligations to purchase network infrastructure (including GPUs, CPUs, memory chips, servers and other network gear) and long-term agreements to procure energy to run the data centres.

Why off balance sheet?

Financial statements are prepared by following certain rules. These rules are called accounting standards. Companies need to statutorily comply with them and doing so enables an investor to compare the financials of two companies.

For assets and liabilities to be recognised on the balance sheet, they need to satisfy a few conditions — technically called recognition criteria. For example, to book an item as inventory, it should be a tangible asset and is either held for sale in the ordinary course of business or consumed during production of other goods or in the process of rendering a service.

As far as leases go for certain long-term assets, the standards stipulate that under certain conditions, the lessee must simultaneously capitalise a lease asset (called right of use asset) and the present value of all future lease payments as a liability, on either sides of the balance sheet respectively. This is called initial recognition. How the lease asset and lease liability are accounted for subsequent to initial recognition is more complex and need not be focused now. The standards also prescribe the timing of initial recognition on a day termed as the 'commencement date'. This is the day on which the lessor makes the leased asset available for use by the lessee. Hence, lessees must wait until the commencement date to record the lease asset and lease liability.

In case of hyperscalers, they are the lessees of data centres, which take years to build. Since these leases are contracted for already, companies disclose these material transactions in the notes to accounts (off the balance sheet), until the data centres are delivered for their use by the developer/lessor.

Similarly, obligations to purchase network/ compute infrastructure are also disclosed in the notes, till they meet the recognition criteria meant for fixed assets. You can check out Amazon's off balance sheet obligations in page 15 here: https://tinyurl.com/muhnka9t

How the leases are structured

As an example, we shall look at the structure of Project Jupiter, which is part of the $500-billion Stargate project. At the core are four large data centres, co-developed by STACK Infrastructure and BorderPlex Digital Assets. STACK is ultimately controlled by Blue Owl Capital, a private credit firm. The project is being developed in Doña Ana County of New Mexico State in the US.

Once built, the developers transfer the project assets temporarily to the county for 30 years and in turn, the county leases them back. This is to make use of a tax-efficient model to avoid paying high property taxes (property title is with the county itself for 30 years). PILOTs (payments in lieu of taxes) replace property taxes and act as consideration for the 30-year lease.

Once up and running, the data centre is contracted to be leased to Oracle. Oracle pays Project Jupiter out of the revenue it generates from OpenAI's use of compute. The deal between OpenAI and Oracle is a $300-billion multi-year one.

Why is the street alarmed?

The off balance sheet liabilities of major hyperscalers are given in the graphic. Together, they add up to $2.9 trillion — for leases, network gear and energy. Against this gigantic figure, the current cash balance (net of debt) of these generally cash-rich companies sits at a mere $126 billion. Their combined TTM operating cash flows work out to $724 billion, meaning unless cash flows grow/ sustain from potential AI-related revenue, the hyperscalers may not be able to pay for these obligations. Some of them have even turned to debt, and debt issuances of these companies in 2025-26 has touched about $380 billion.

It is to be noted that a lot of the obligations are non-cancellable or on take-or-pay basis, and this seems to be the reason behind Oracle issuing *force majeure* (expressing inability to discharge obligations due to circumstances out of a party's control) to STACK Infrastructure in late September. Contractually, Oracle is still liable to pay the developer, even if the first phase of the project is not completed by the H1 2027 deadline, per *Financial Times*. The setback seems to have stemmed from permit delays, amid local opposition. The two parties have since clarified that the project is still on.

On the income side, the companies are banking on massive revenue from compute deals. These are called remaining performance obligations (RPOs), and they total to $2.5 trillion. However, about 40 per cent is expected from OpenAI and Anthropic alone — a serious concentration risk.

In 2025, Anthropic is reported to have generated a revenue of $4.6 billion, lost $8 billion on operating level and a net loss of a staggering $42 billion. These are as per a confidential prospectus accessed by *Reuters*. In the same year, OpenAI had earned $13 billion in revenue, incurred an operating loss of $21 billion and a net loss of $39 billion. These figures are as reported by Ed Zitron, an independent journalist. At this rate, the two AI labs would like their IPOs to happen soon and at desired valuations, helping them sustain the cash burn. While Anthropic may go public by November-end, OpenAI has postponed its IPO to 2027.

Steve Eisman had an interesting argument about why Anthropic may be pushing for a November IPO. An IPO now would mean the latest revenue figures in the prospectus would likely be that of H1 2026, which also marks the end of token-maxxing — a trend where employees were incentivised based on the number of tokens consumed, as a proxy for productivity, rather than actual outcomes.

Token prices for users are declining as well. Measured by the Ramp AI index, Anthropic's token price has sharply declined from $2.56 per million tokens in January to $0.84 now. OpenAI's has fallen from $0.95 to $0.64. In this backdrop, per the *Financial Times*, OpenAI, as late as Thursday, has clarified that its annualised revenue run rate is only $50 billion against the *Axios*-reported $70 billion. In reaction, Oracle's shares fell 5.5 per cent, yield on its 10-year bond climbed to 7.6 per cent (coupon was 5.7 per cent on issue in February 2026), CDS spread thereon has widened 1.76x year to date and is at all-time highs.

VARIABLE INTEREST ENTITIES

Before moving on to the concept of VIEs, let's brush up the basics of consolidation. Assume two companies P and Q. P consolidates Q if it has controlling interest in Q. The usual way to check if P has a controlling interest is to check if it has a majority stake in Q. There could be other ways by which an entity can control another, even without a majority stake. For example, P has the power to appoint majority of directors on Q's board, through an agreement. This can be example of controlling interest as well.

To keep it very simple, when a company consolidates its controlling interest in another, irrespective of its voting share in the latter (51 per cent stake, 90 per cent stake, etc.), 100 per cent of the latter's assets, liabilities, revenue and expenses are added to those of the former. There are also consolidation adjustments like elimination of inter-company balances, accounting for minority interest and so on. But a discussion on them is not warranted now.

In case there is no controlling interest, P accounts for its investment in Q using equity method or at the fair value of its stake, as given in the chart. Do note the difference here. Unlike above, where 100 per cent of Q's assets, liabilities, etc. become P's on consolidation, under equity method or when recording at fair value, Q's assets, liabilities need not be added. The investment in Q merely reflects the value of P's partial stake in Q.

Companies can, at times, be creative and structure deals such that the other company's liabilities (Q's) are kept off their books. Optically, there may be no controlling interest, but not so in substance. The accounting standards (US GAAP) provide for such cases and lay down the rules when a company must consolidate its variable interest in an entity.

Consolidation criteria

Simply, readers can understand variable interest as follows. A variable interest is any stake in an entity whose value goes up or down as the entity's value goes up or down. Under US GAAP, advancing loans and financial guarantees are also considered variable interests, besides outright equity stake.

The standards stipulate that when a company's variable interest in another (VIE) satisfies both the following conditions, the company is termed the primary beneficiary of the VIE. On becoming the primary beneficiary, it must consolidate the VIE's asset, liabilities, revenue and expenses in full.

- Whether the company has the power to direct activities that most significantly affect the economic performance of the VIE
- Whether the company absorbs losses or receives benefits that could potentially be significant to the VIE.

Take a look at the illustration. A has a small 9-per cent stake in B that doesn't outright warrant A consolidating B. But take a closer look at B's balance sheet. Of the $2.1 billion of total assets that B owns, $2 billion of them have been financed by a loan that A arranged, by providing a guarantee to the bank, in case B defaults. Owing to this deal, B agrees to let A decide to whom the compute is leased. Thus, A directs B's activities that most significantly affect its economic performance (leasing compute) and also absorbs B's potential losses, in the event when B defaults and A repays the bank. With these conditions satisfied, A becomes the primary beneficiary of B and A is required to consolidate B.

That said, a key point to note here is that the standards require the management of companies themselves to use their judgment to determine which activities most significantly affect the economic performance of the VIE.

The Enron story

Market voices have expressed concerns that these kinds of VIE structures remind them of the Enron scandal. Enron is known to have floated special purpose entities (SPEs) to keep debt off its balance sheet. Often Enron's own C-suite were made the owners of these SPEs, with a minor low single-digit stake held by unrelated parties. Enron largely didn't have any direct stake in the SPEs. The SPEs then borrowed from the banks, backed by Enron's guarntee. Next, with the loan funds, the SPEs bought Enron's loss-making investments off its balance sheet, while Enron booked revenue on the sale. Thus, Enron managed to keep losses and debt off its balance sheet. Legally, it wasn't required to consolidate the SPEs, as regulations were not as stringent then. Particularly, Enron took advantage of a rule that exempted consolidating an SPE, if independent, unrelated entities hold at least 3 per cent of the SPE's capital.

Today, regulations are much stringent, and are, to some extent, products of the Enron scandal. In our view, comparing today's VIEs to Enron's SPEs may be far-fetched. But there may be lacunas in this space, when the managements' judgments determine whether they are the primary beneficiaries or not. The managements have an inherent incentive to opine that VIEs need not be consolidated, protecting their debt metrics from appearing alarming.

Real-life examples

Going through the 10-Qs and 10-Ks of the hyperscalers reveals a divided picture. Microsoft and CoreWeave have concluded that they are not the primary beneficiaries of any of their VIEs, thus taking the equity method or the fair value route (as applicable) to account for them. Amazon has disclosed that its variable interest/ stake in Anthropic and OpenAI do not call for a consolidation, which appears logical. On the other hand, Alphabet has determined it to be the primary beneficiary of some VIEs (consolidating them, of course), while not so for the rest.

However, the most interesting case has to be that of Meta and its variable interest in the Hyperion data center. While Meta has concluded that it is not the primary beneficiary, its auditors, EY, have pointed the same as a critical audit matter (CAM), noting that they found the audit of Meta's determination of the primary beneficiary of the VIE was especially challenging. Basically, auditors use the CAMs section to invite the attention of stakeholders to areas of audit that involve complex judgments or were challenging. However, a CAM does not amount to an audit qualification.

Let's examine the case now. The data centre is owned 80:20 by Blue Owl and Meta (no outright majority stake). The deal is such that Hyperion will initially lease the data centre to Meta for $12 billion over a four-year period. Meta will also have the option to renew the lease for up to 20 years. This opens it up for interpretation whether Meta exercising the option would mean it has effectively directed Hyperion's activities for the next 20 years or not.

The deal also includes a residual value guarantee (RVG) element. RVG ensures Hyperion will be indemnified by Meta, in case Meta terminates the lease or it fails to renew the lease. The indemnity value is as per the formula given in the chart. The initial RVG threshold is set close to the development cost but will taper down with time.

Here is a simulation. Assume at the end of the second year of the lease, Meta wants to call the deal off due to a slowdown in AI usage. Let the RVG threshold then be taken as $25 billion. Hyperion assesses the fair value of its business at $10 billion. Here, Meta has to indemnify Hyperion to the tune of $15 billion. This makes it open for interpretation whether the RVG, in a way, absorbs potential losses of the VIE (Hyperion) — the second condition for determination of primary beneficiary. Right now, investors can only rely on the auditors.

In a world where AI is highly capital-intensive and is increasingly turning the cash-rich companies towards debt, investors need to warm up to these off balance sheet realities. Only then can they not say, 'Didn't see it coming' when actually it was all in clear plain sight!

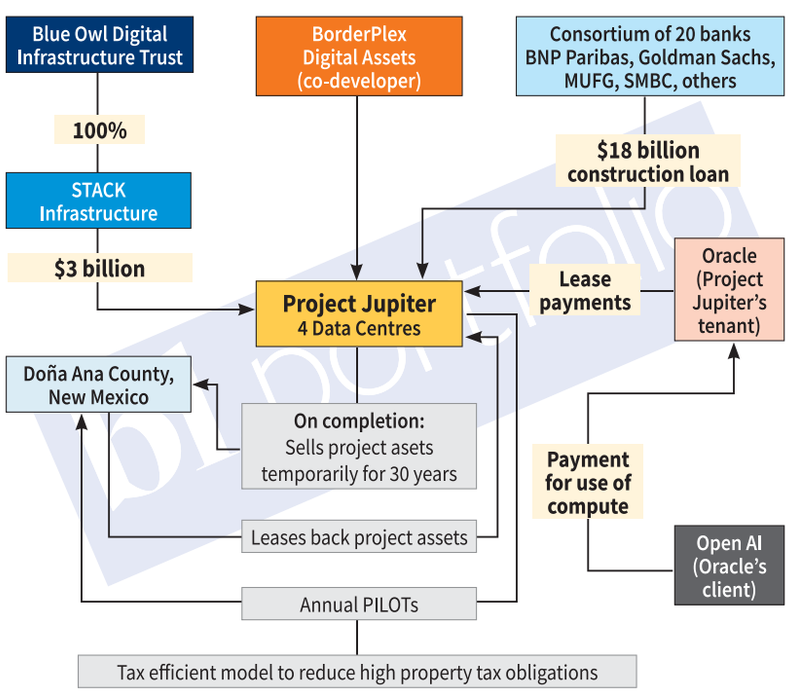
Big Tech and the $2.9-trillion bill

$ billion

	Leases yet to commence	Purchase commitments	Total off balance sheet debt^	Net cash**	RPO or revenue backlog^
Alphabet*	91	811	978	144	520
Meta Platforms	347	349	696	7	NA
Microsoft	329	229	558	37	684
Oracle	288	34	322	-88	664
Amazon.com	137	130	267	-6	496
CoreWeave	50	0.5-1.2	51	-29	104
SpaceX#	0	30	30	62	48
Total	**1,242**	**1,584**	**2,902**	**126**	**2,515**

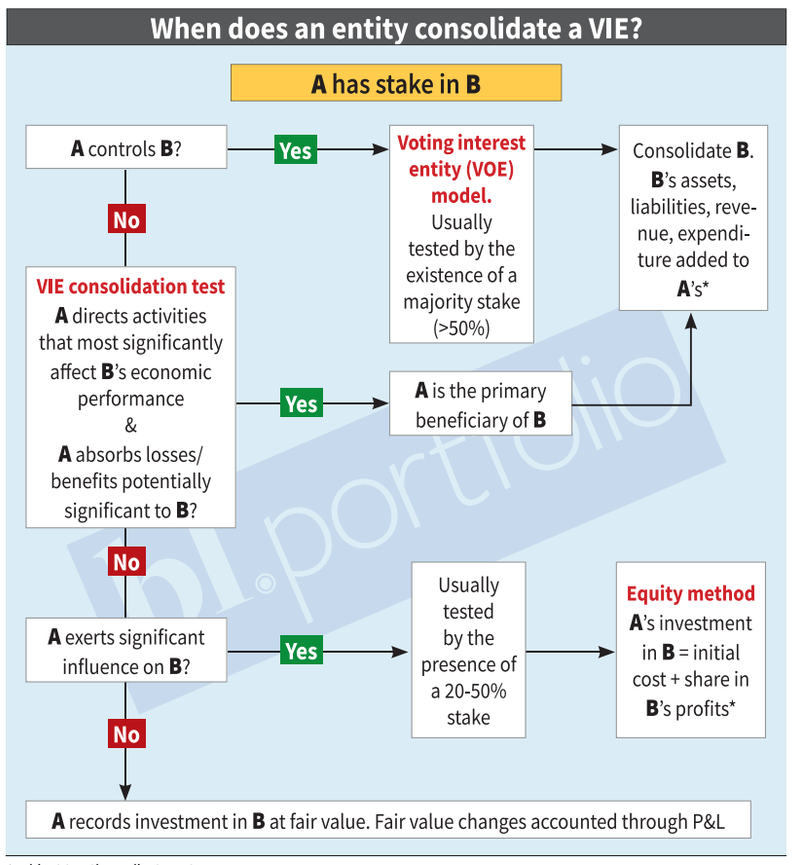
*Alphabet's total off balance sheet obligations include $75.5 billion in backstops; **Negative indicates debt higher than cash balance; #SpaceX's cash balance is higher due to IPO proceeds of $86 billion; ^Subject to additions and cancellations
Source: Latest SEC filings

How Oracle's lease is structured



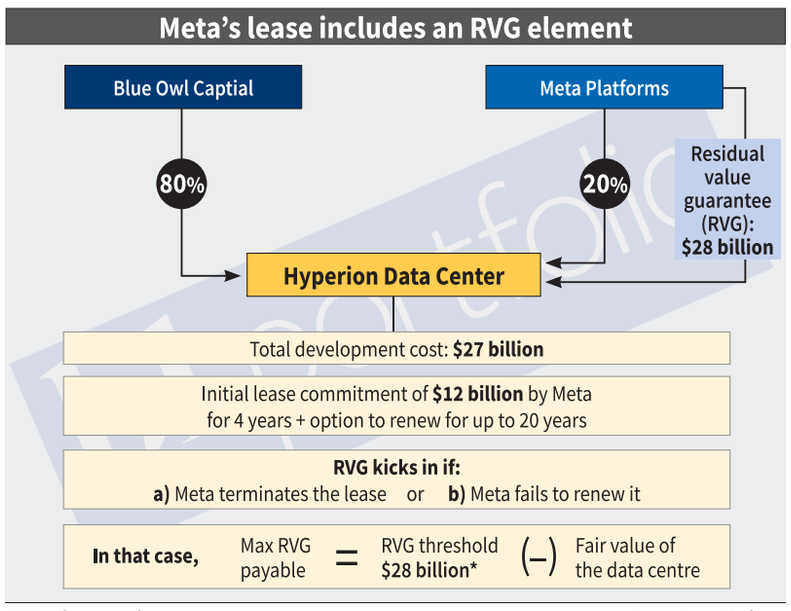
As per available information
Source: Oracle, STACK Infrastructure, Project Jupiter, Financial Times

When does an entity consolidate a VIE?



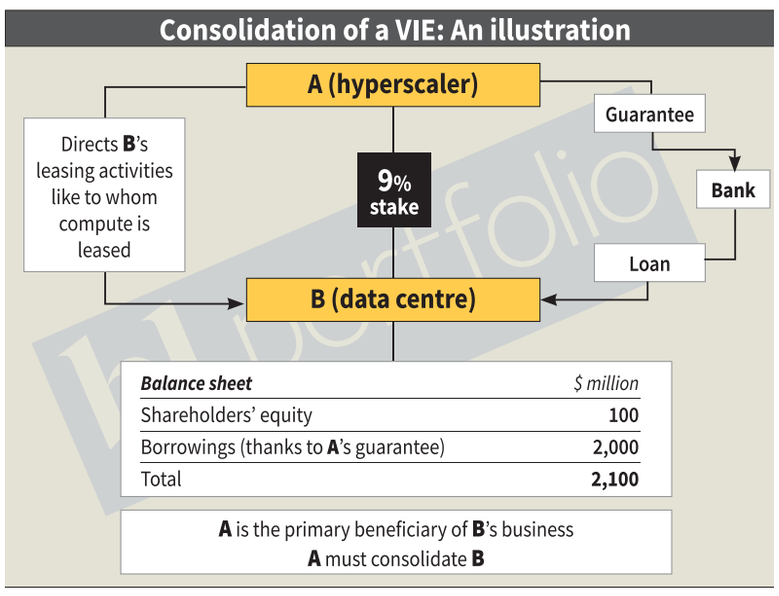
*subject to other adjustments

Meta's lease includes an RVG element

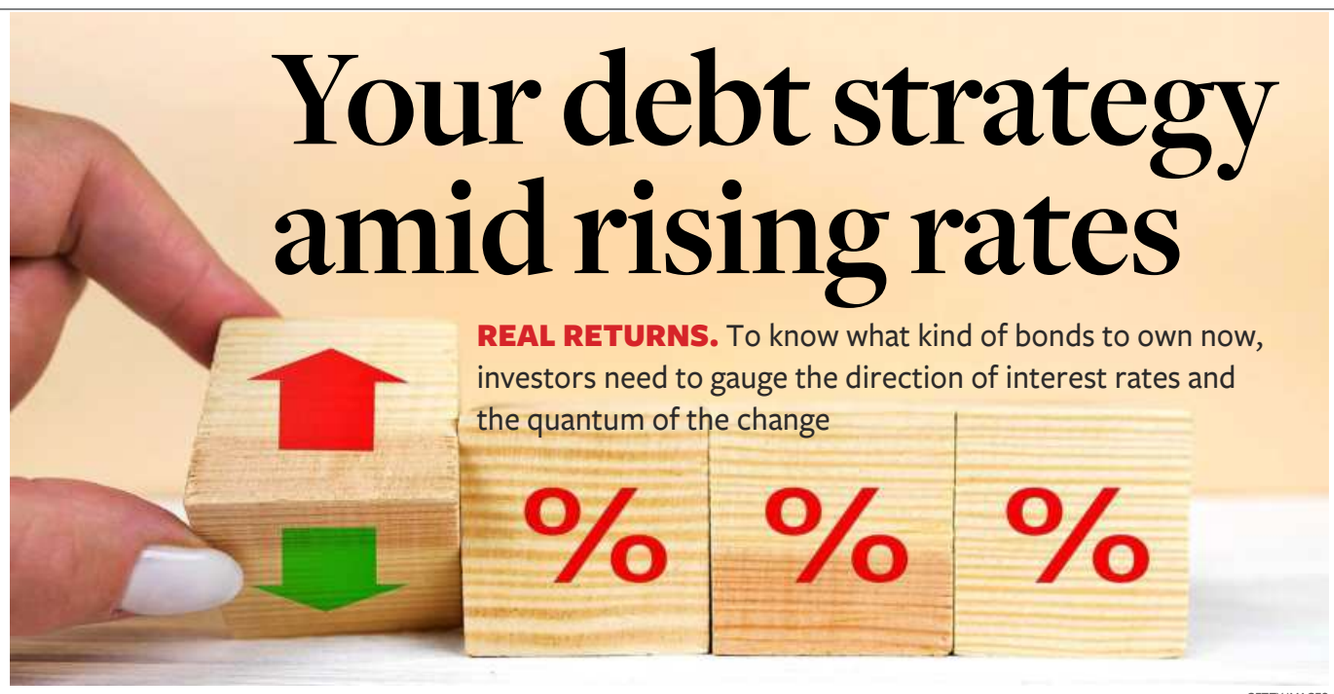


*RVG reduces over time
Source: Meta Platforms

Consolidation of a VIE: An illustration



Your debt strategy amid rising rates



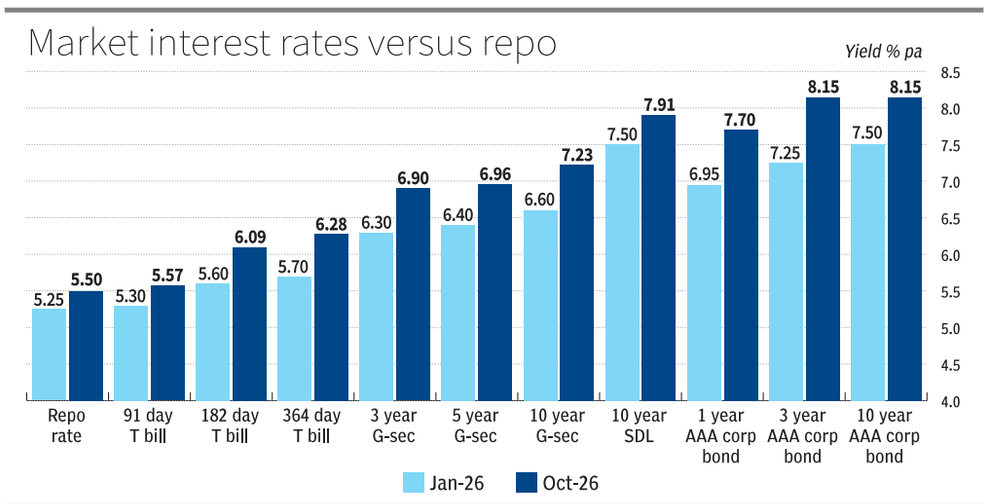
REAL RETURNS. To know what kind of bonds to own now, investors need to gauge the direction of interest rates and the quantum of the change

GETTY IMAGES

Aarati Krishnan

In last week's *Big Story*, we talked about why rising bond yields (and central banks hiking rates) globally, could represent a regime change for equity investors. As global interest rates climb after a prolonged phase of repression, investors may need to lower their return expectations from equities, at least at the market level. But there's a positive side to this yield spike too — it opens up better return opportunities for debt investors.

In India, interest rates never went to zero. Therefore, the rise in yields poses less of a shock than in say, the US or Japan. However, with the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) restarting a rate hike cycle after a four-year gap, Indian debt investors may need to recalibrate their strategies to benefit from higher rates. To know what kind of bonds to own now, you need to gauge the direction of interest rates and the quantum of the change.



Yields as of October 8, 2026

HOW MARKET RATES BEHAVED

Today, whether you consider long-term interest rates or short-term, the direction is clearly up.

Long-term bond yields in India are pegged to the 10-year government security, which acts as the floor for long-term borrowing costs. After the Iran war broke out in February 2026 and oil prices surged, Indian bond markets worried about rising subsidies forcing the Central government to overshoot its deficit target. Therefore, the yield on longer-tenure Central government securities spiked first. Between January and April 2026, the yield on the 10-year G-Sec (government bond) rose from 6.6 per cent to 6.9 per cent. During this period, inflation remained low and there was no talk of policy rate hikes; so short-term interest rates stayed put.

With State governments on a borrowing binge, yields on SDLs (State government loans) spiked more, from 7.5 per cent to 7.9 per cent. Corporate bonds, which usually trade at a spread over G-Secs saw their yields increase. They rose from 7 per cent to 7.5 per cent for one-year AAA-rated bonds and 7.25 per cent to 7.6 per cent for three-year AAA-rated bonds. However, a frugal budget, which stayed with a 4.3 per cent fiscal deficit target in March and fuel price hikes in May, thereafter allayed fears about the deficit overshooting. Therefore, between April and October 2026, India's 10-year government bond yields have risen only marginally from 6.9 per cent to 7.25 per cent.

However, yields on short-term bonds have played catch-up in this period. In recent months, it has become quite clear that a quick resolution to the Iran war is unlikely. Elevated energy prices and the long-lasting El Nino, have thus put upward pressure on domestic inflation, propping up CPI (consumer price index) inflation from 3.4 per cent in March to 4.8 per cent by August. This prompted bond markets to begin pricing in rate hikes by the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC), with yields on 91-day to 364-day treasury bills rising from 5.3-5.6 per cent in April to 5.5-6.2 per cent now.

This week, the MPC met the market's expectations by raising the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5 per cent. It also indicated that further rate hikes were in the offing, by talking of "calibrated tightening".

WHAT'S PRICED IN

The above analysis shows that the direction of rates is pretty clear today. But how much will rates rise from here and how much of this is already priced into market yields? This is an important question because bond markets, like stock markets, price in events much before they happen.

On the first question, it is too early for a definitive answer. In the post-Covid rate hiking cycle that lasted from 2022 to 2023, the MPC hiked rates from 4 per cent to 6.5 per cent (250 basis points). In the extended cycle from 2010 to 2014, it hiked rates from 5 per cent all the way to 8 per cent, a 300-basis point hike. However, there have been shallower cycles too like 2017-18 when rates went up just 50 basis points from 6 per cent to 6.5 per cent. The quantum of hikes this time around will depend on incoming data on inflation, growth and capital flows. But it would be good to brace for an extended cycle.

On the second question of what the market is pricing in, the bond market seems to be pricing in another 70-75 basis points in rate hikes. One, the 364-day Treasury bill trades at about 6.28 per cent now, which is 78 basis points above the repo rate; T-bills yields have usually traded pretty close to the repo rate. Two, the 10-year G-Sec yield, at 7.23 per cent, is now 173 basis points above the repo rate. The average spread between the 10-year G-Sec and the repo has historically hovered at 80-100 basis points. This suggests that the additional 73 basis points is the market expectation for further rate increases.

YOUR DEBT STRATEGY

This means three things for your debt strategy:

* With rate hikes just beginning, it may be risky to lock into bonds or debt mutual funds with long tenures (five years plus). Should market yields continue to shoot up or rate hikes go on for long, you can lose money by buying into long-duration bonds or debt funds today. In the past 15 years or so, 10-year G-Sec yields in India have topped out close to 8 per cent. Therefore, it would be good to wait for levels of 7.5-8 per cent on the 10-year G-Sec before considering long-duration bonds or debt funds. If you have surpluses to deploy now, it is safer today to invest them in bonds or debt funds with tenures of upto three years. This way, you can benefit from further rate hikes for as long as this cycle continues.

* Among three-year instruments, high-quality corporate bonds look attractive at yields of over 8 per cent. One- year and three-year AAA corporate bonds now trade at spreads of 142 and 125 basis points respectively over similar maturity G-Secs, which is high from a historical perspective. This makes such bonds a good buy. Currently, bonds from M&M Financial, Tata Capital, rated AAA and maturing in 2029, offer yields of about 8.1 per cent. PSU bonds from IRFC, HUDCO and SIDBI, maturing in 2029, offer about 7.65-7.8 per cent.

* While yields on G-Secs and corporate bonds are already factoring in the rise in policy rates, the fixed deposit market is yet to catch up. Large banks like SBI and ICICI still offer just 6.3-6.5 per cent for three-year deposits. Small finance banks, which traditionally offer the best FD deals, offer only 7.5-8 per cent, that too for special windows. Highly-rated NBFCs like Sundaram Finance and Bajaj Finance offer 7.25-7.75 per cent on three-year deposits. This could be due to banks enjoying comfortable liquidity after their FCNR (B) flows.

Debt investors fishing for higher returns today should thus stick to corporate bonds or debt mutual funds, opting for the shortest tenure possible within three years.

The author is a Contributing Editor

TAKEAWAYS

- Interest rates going up
- Stick to corporate bonds, debt MFs
- Opt for the shortest tenure possible within three years

TAX QUERY



SANJIV CHAUDHARY



My queries pertain to taxation of debt mutual funds:
1 Will there be TDS on the interest accrued on units of debt mutual funds if they are not sold during the financial year?
2 If the units are held for a long period, upon sale, will the interest/capital gain be taxed at 12.5 per cent or 20 per cent, or will it be added to the annual income and taxed at the applicable rate?

Thimmaiah M M

Investors in a debt mutual fund do not earn interest in their hands. Interest earned by the scheme on its underlying securities stays inside the fund and is reflected in the Net Asset Value (NAV) of the units. So, where the units are held under the growth option and are not redeemed or transferred during the financial year:

* no income arises in the investor's hands for that year, and

* no TDS is deducted on the increase rise in NAV.

Income arises only when the units are redeemed or transferred, and it is taxed then as capital gains in the hands of the investor. Where the units are held under the IDCW (dividend) option, any amount paid out is taxable as income in the investor's hands at the applicable slab rate. The mutual fund deducts TDS at 10 per cent where such payouts to a resident investor exceed ₹10,000 in a financial year.

QUERY NO 2

Units acquired on or after April 1, 2023: Gains on redemption or transfer are treated as short-term capital gains, whatever the holding period, as per provisions of section 76 of Income tax Act, 2025. These gains are added to total income and taxed at the applicable slab rate. Neither the rate of 12.5 per cent nor earlier rate of 20 per cent are applicable. A "specified mutual fund" is a fund investing more than 65 per cent of its total proceeds in debt and money market instruments, or a fund investing 65 per cent or more in units of such funds. The scheme's classification should be confirmed from its scheme information document.

Units acquired before April 1, 2023: If held for more than 24 months, then the gain is a long-term capital gain, taxable at 12.5 per cent without indexation (plus applicable surcharge and cess). If held for 24 months or less, the gain is a short-term capital gain, taxable at the applicable slab rate.

Further, 20 per cent rate with indexation is no longer available for mutual fund units. It applied only to transfers before July 23, 2024. The limited grandfathering of the 20 per cent rate with indexation under Section 197 of the Income tax Act, 2025, covers only land or buildings acquired before that date, and not mutual fund units.

The writer is a practising chartered accountant
Send your queries to **taxtalk@thehindu.co.in**

Interest rates on home loans (%)

Institution	Loan amount		
	Under ₹30 lakh	₹30 to 75 lakh	Over ₹75 lakh
BANKS (Floating rates)			
Axis Bank	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10
Bank of Baroda	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95
Bank of India	7.35-10.25	7.35-10.25	7.35-10.25
Bank of Maharashtra	7.0-9.65	7.0-9.65	7.0-9.65
Canara Bank	7.15-10	7.10-10	7.05-9.90
Central Bank	7.0-8.75	7.0-8.75	7.0-8.75
DBS Bank	<=8.70	<=8.70	<=8.70
Dhanlaxmi Bank	>=7.65	>=7.65	>=7.65
Federal Bank	7.35-9.6	7.35-9.6	7.35-9.6
HDFC Bank	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20
ICICI Bank	>=7.55	>=7.55	>=7.55
Indian Bank	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55
IOB	7.45-8.55	7.45-8.55	7.45-8.55
IDBI Bank	7.40-11.90	7.40-11.90	7.40-11.90
J&K Bank	>= 7.25	>= 7.25	>= 7.25
Karnataka Bank	7.51-11.83	7.51-11.83	7.51-11.83
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Kotak Mahindra Bank	>=7.60	>=7.60	>=7.60
Punjab National Bank	7.50-9.35	7.45-9.35	7.45-9.25
Punjab & Sind Bank	7.60-11.0	7.60-11.0	7.60-11.0
RBL Bank	>= 9.0	>= 9.0	>= 9.0
State Bank of India	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55
South Indian Bank	>=7.25	>=7.25	>=7.25
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	8.15-9.55	8.15-9.55	8.15-9.55
BANKS (Fixed rates)			
Indian Bank	9.20-9.40	9.20-9.40	9.20-9.40
Bank of Baroda	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95
Canara Bank	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Floating rates)			
Tata Capital	>=7.50	>=7.50	>=7.50
PNB Housing	7.75-10.05	7.60-10.05	7.50-9.95
Central Bank Housing	10-12.85	10-12.85	10-12.35
Samman Capital	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
Aditya Birla Housing Fin	>=7.75	>=7.75	>=7.75
Bajaj Finserv	7.25-20	7.25-20	7.25-20
GIC Housing Finance	>=8.80	>=8.80	>=8.80
Sundaram Home Finance *	>=10.65	>=10.65	>=10.65
Piramal Finance Limited	>=9.99	>=9.99	>=9.99
IIFL Home Finance	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
LIC Housing Finance	7.15-9.65	7.15-9.75	7.15-10.10
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Fixed rates)			
LIC Housing Finance	10-10.25	10-10.25	10-10.25

*Data as on respective banks' website on October 09, 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau



The six hues of risks

INVEST SMART. SEBI's new Credit Risk-o-Meter focusses mainly on a debt security's credit risk

In a move to make bond investing easier for retail investors, market regulator SEBI has introduced a mandatory Credit Risk-o-Meter for debt securities. Issuers and Online Bond Platform Providers (OBPPs) must display the colour-coded risk meter in offer documents, abridged prospectuses, private-placement memorandums, advertisements, and the web and mobile platforms of OBPPs. The framework covers listed and proposed-to-be-listed non-convertible securities, commercial papers, securitised debt instruments, security receipts and structured debt or market-linked debentures, whether issued through public issues or private placements. The provisions will come into force 45 days after the October 7, 2026, circular.

The pictorial representation is not new to the industry. This colour-coded Risk-o-Meter is used in mutual fund disclosures. SEBI introduced product labelling for mutual funds more than a decade ago and subsequently developed the current Risk-o-Meter framework. All mutual fund schemes must display a six-level Risk-o-Meter, ranging from Low to Very High risk, which is recalibrated monthly based on the underlying portfolio. The new bond Credit Risk-o-Meter adopts a similar colour-coded approach, moving from green for the lowest credit risk to red for the highest risk of default.

WHAT IT IS

While a mutual fund Risk-o-Meter captures multiple risks, including market, interest-rate, liquidity and credit risks, the new Credit Risk-o-Meter focuses exclusively on the credit risk associated with a debt security. It is intended to help small investors understand the risk of an issuer failing to meet its financial obligations.

Traditionally, investors have relied on credit ratings assigned by credit rating agencies (CRAs) such as Crisil, ICRA, CARE Ratings and India Ratings. While institutional investors and experienced market participants are familiar with rating symbols such as AAA, AA and BBB, retail investors may find these labels difficult to interpret. By translating rating symbols into familiar colour-coded risk categories, SEBI aims to make credit risk easier to assess.

Under the framework, credit ratings will be mapped to six risk categories. The first, Lowest Credit Risk, covers AAA-rated long-term debt securities and A1+-rated short-term instruments.

The second, Very Low Credit Risk, covers AA-rated securities, including the AA+ and AA- variants, and A1-rated short-term instruments.

IN A NUTSHELL

Investors can use the meter as a quick screening tool to understand where a security stands on the credit-risk spectrum

The third, Low Credit Risk, includes A-rated securities and A2-rated short-term instruments.

BBB-rated securities fall under Moderate Credit Risk, alongside A3-rated short-term instruments. BB-rated securities are placed in the Moderate Risk of Default category, alongside A4+-rated short-term instruments.

The final category, High to Very High Risk of Default, covers B-, C- and D-rated securities, including their applicable rating modifiers, as well as A4- and D-rated short-term instruments. The colour spectrum progresses from green through yellow, brown and orange to red. The traffic-light format is designed to make differences in credit risk more immediately visible.

Where a CRA identifies an issuer as "Issuer Not Cooperating" (INC), the Credit Risk-o-Meter must indicate the INC status, with an arrow pointing towards it.

Issuers and OBPPs must additionally disclose the CRA's name and the actual credit rating of the debt security in text below the meter. For unsecured debt instruments, the word "unsecured" must appear in bold red text. Where a security has ratings from multiple CRAs, the meter must reflect the lowest rating, although all ratings may be disclosed alongside it.

On mobile interfaces, the meter may be condensed, provided the entire risk spectrum remains visible and an arrow points to the product's specific risk level. Selecting the information ('i') icon must bring up the detailed version, consistent with the web display.

INVESTOR IMPLICATIONS

Retail participation in bonds has grown alongside the emergence of online bond platforms, which allow investors to access corporate debt more conveniently. However, easier access does not necessarily mean investors fully understand the risks involved. A colour-coded meter could help bridge this gap by making the credit quality of a debt security easier to interpret at a glance.

SEBI has clarified that the meter reflects only credit risk and does not constitute investment advice or a recommendation to invest. It does not capture all the other risks associated with debt securities, including market and liquidity risks.

The distinction is particularly important for unsecured perpetual bonds, such as additional tier-1 (AT1) bonds issued by banks.

SEBI has prescribed an additional disclaimer for these instruments, warning that the meter does not reflect their unique structural risks and that investors could lose their entire invested capital.

In essence, SEBI's initiative seeks to make credit risk more visible. Investors can use the meter as a quick screening tool to understand where a security stands on the credit-risk spectrum.

A green indicator signals a lower assessed credit risk, while orange and red indicate elevated risk. However, a lower credit-risk category does not automatically make a bond suitable for every investor.

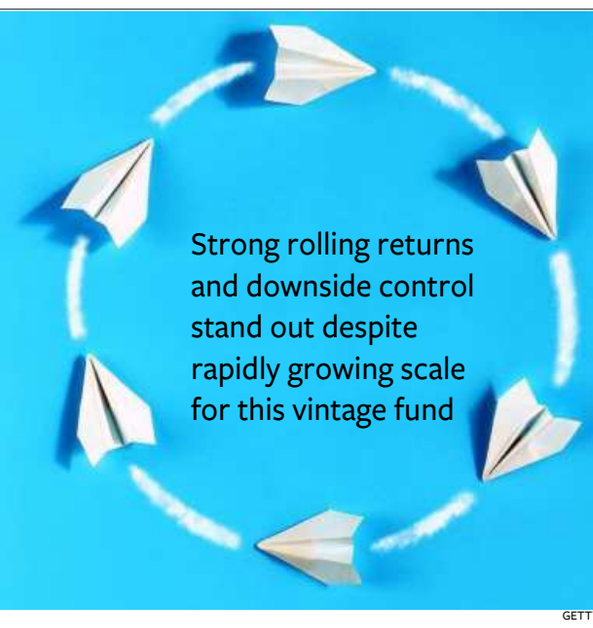
Yield, maturity, liquidity, issuer fundamentals, instrument structure and portfolio allocation must also be considered before investing.

CHENNAI
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - OCTOBER 11 - 2026

FUND CALL. HDFC FLEXI CAP FUND

Consistency with controlled aggression

Strong rolling returns and downside control stand out despite rapidly growing scale for this vintage fund



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

HDFC Flexi Cap Fund is among the oldest and largest diversified equity schemes in India, but its current identity needs to be explained in the right context. Launched in January 1995 as HDFC Equity Fund, the scheme was categorised as a flexi-cap fund and renamed HDFC Flexi Cap Fund from January 29, 2021. Therefore, its three-decade record cannot be viewed entirely through the lens of the current flexi-cap mandate — the freedom to invest across large-, mid- and small-cap stocks without fixed allocation limits.

What is more relevant today is how the fund has evolved over the last five-seven years. It has become more willing to vary equity and market-cap exposure and rotate across stocks and sectors, while remaining predominantly large-cap. This has worked well. The scheme carries a 5-star *bl.portfolio* Star Track rating.

Importantly, its record has not come from loading up on smaller companies. With assets of nearly ₹1.14 lakh crore, however, scale is now an important variable in assessing what comes next. Here is a detailed fund review.

STRATEGY

The fund's portfolio reveals a combination of long holding periods and meaningful rotation rather than either pure buy-and-hold investing or high-frequency churn.

Several stocks have persisted through essentially the fund's 10-year history, including ICICI Bank, HDFC Bank, SBI, Infosys, Bank of Baroda, Larsen & Toubro, Cipla and Kalpataru Projects International, though their portfolio weights have changed substantially.

The current portfolio contains 78 stocks, but conviction is visible at the top. ICICI Bank accounts for 9.19 per cent, Axis Bank 6.19 per cent and HDFC Bank 5.71 per cent. Banks together constitute 28.6 per cent of assets against about 21.1 per cent for the flexi-cap category aggregate.

Relative to the flexi-cap category, the fund is overweight automobiles, pharmaceuticals and biotechnology, healthcare services, construction, insurance and transport services, while it is underweight IT software.

The AMC describes its stock-selection approach as valuation-led rather than conventionally value-oriented, combining quality, growth, turnaround and valuation considerations.

This helps explain why valuation discipline can coexist with a portfolio that does not necessarily look cheap on multiples from an absolute standpoint. As per ACE MF data, the fund portfolio is valued at about 35 times earnings and 7.3 times book value. Note, data available for peer set shows category P/E at 41.6 times and P/B at 7.8 times.

The fund's active positioning does not rely on aggressive small-cap exposure. In August 2026, large-, mid- and small-cap allocations were 69.96 per cent, 14.90 per cent and 9.62 per cent, against category levels of 62.37 per cent, 15.69 per cent and 11.80 per cent.

Yet the fund is moving down the market-cap curve. Large-caps are at their lowest weight in the available history, while mid-caps have jumped from 4.08 per cent in August 2025 to 14.90 per cent.

The fund has also used non-equity exposure tactically. Equity fell to 82.1 per cent in January 2026 before climbing back to over 94 per cent by August.

PERFORMANCE

The strongest evidence in favour of HDFC Flexi Cap comes from rolling returns rather than isolated point-to-point numbers.

Over seven years of NAV history to October 1, 2026, its three-year rolling returns averaged 24.26 per cent against 18.19 per cent for the Nifty 500 TRI and 17.33 per cent for the flexi-cap category. The more telling figure is the minimum return: 13.47 per cent (fund) against 9.15 per cent (benchmark) and 8.47 per cent (category).

The five-year numbers strengthen this argument. HDFC Flexi Cap delivered a mean rolling return of 23.76 per cent and a minimum of 14.50 per cent. The corresponding flexi-cap category figures were 17.06 per cent and 8.58 per cent. The Nifty 500 TRI recorded a mean of 17.95 per cent and minimum of 8.64 per cent.

SIP numbers point in the same direction (*see chart*).

Risk-adjusted numbers help explain the longer-term outcome. Over three years, the fund's beta stood at 0.85, while up capture was 96.99 and down capture only 68.84.

Sharpe and Sortino ratios were among the strongest in the available peer-set. The fund has, in effect, participated in most of the market upside while absorbing materially less of the downside.

The fund has seen multiple manager transitions over its long history, with Prashant Jain having the longest tenure from 2003 to 2022. Since then, the management has changed more frequently, with Amit Ganatra taking charge from February 2026.

The base expense ratio of the fund's direct plan at 57 basis points (1 bps = 0.01 per cent) is sharply lower than the category's 72 bps average and is placed at the second-lowest quartile of the peer-set.

TAKEAWAYS

Three aspects stand out in our reading of this fund.

First, strong returns have not required unusually-high smaller-cap exposure. In fact, HDFC remains more large-cap oriented than the category even after its recent mid-cap increase.

Second, its large-cap orientation should not be mistaken for passivity. Meaningful stock and sector rotation over the past three years shows a willingness to take differentiated calls, while beta and downside capture ratio suggest this has not translated into excessive portfolio risk.

Recent performance has nevertheless been ordinary, reminding investors that long-term consistency does not preclude shorter spells of underperformance.

Third, investors should not extrapolate past returns mechanically because both the fund and its scale have changed.

Before recategorisation, equity exposure averaged 98.4 per cent; since February 2021, it has averaged 91.3 per cent with much wider swings, alongside more flexible market-cap positioning.

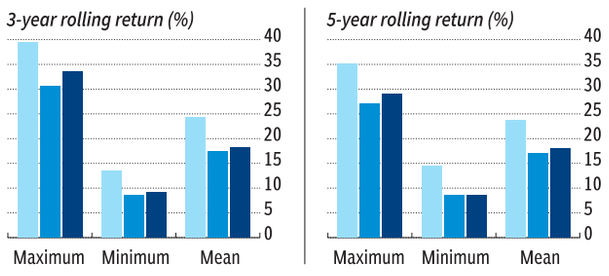
AUM has, meanwhile, risen from about ₹25,500 crore in August 2021 to ₹1.14 lakh crore in August 2026, more than doubling since August 2024.

Yet, size has not pushed HDFC Flexi Cap into the same portfolio constraints visible in Parag Parikh Flexi Cap.

The HDFC fund still holds nearly 15 per cent in mid-caps and about 10 per cent in small-caps, compared with only about 3.4 per cent and 4.4 per cent, respectively, for the giant ₹1.47-lakh-crore Parag Parikh offering. This shows that large AUM does not automatically force a flexi-cap fund towards an overwhelmingly large-cap portfolio.

In a long-term portfolio, HDFC Flexi Cap can sit well in the core equity bucket, given its relatively measured risk profile.

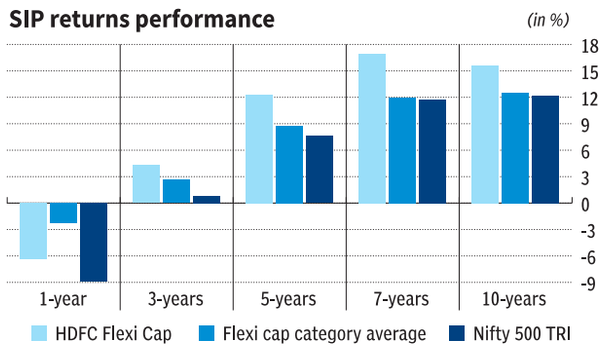
Rolling returns performance



Rolling return calculated from 7-year NAV history TRI: Total Return Index

SIP returns performance

(in %)



SIP done every 1st month of each month Returns in XIRR format

Source: ACEMF

How it differs

Selected parameter	HDFC Flexi Cap	Flexi cap category average
Large cap allocation (%)	70.0	62.4
Mid cap allocation (%)	14.9	15.7
Small cap allocation (%)	9.6	11.8
Other allocation (%)	5.5	10.2
Top-5 stock allocation (%)	28.6	22.1
Top-10 stock allocation (%)	44.0	35.8
Upside capture* (%)	96.9	107.6
Downside capture* (%)	68.8	90.3
Portfolio P/E (times)	35.1	41.6
Portfolio P/B (times)	7.3	7.8

Numbers have been rounded off *Calculated for 3 years monthly basis
Data above for latest disclosed portfolios Source: ACEMF

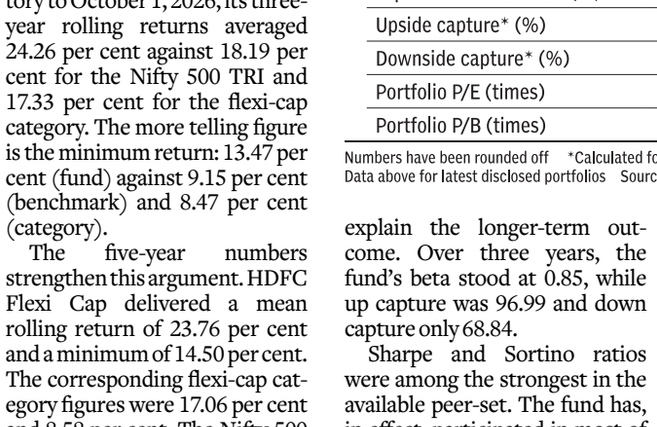
MIND IT

- Downside capture materially below benchmark
- Large-cap anchored, actively rotated portfolio
- Scale rising, execution worth tracking

Rate worries cloud Wall Street's AI rally

GLOBAL VIEW. Yields on 10-year US Treasuries approached 5.4 per cent this week, their highest since 2002

Bloomberg



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

The AI-fuelled resilience of the world's most-watched stock indexes is masking a widening retreat across financial markets, as elevated oil prices and borrowing costs take their toll.

Yields on 10-year US Treasuries approached 5.4 per cent this week, their highest since 2002, as Brent crude hovered above $100 a barrel, stoking fears of a prolonged inflation shock. The price of money is rising across much of the world, sending the UK borrowing costs to a 19-year high and adding to the pressure on French government debt.

For all the turmoil, the big equity benchmarks have proved resilient. The S&P 500 hit a record on Tuesday, stumbled over the next two sessions amid fears over AI demand, then bounced back Friday as traders looked ahead to another bumper earnings season. It remains within striking distance of its peak.

Enduring economic growth is allowing investors to look past rising yields and geopolitical upheaval. But the market's ability to absorb the shock depends heavily on where investors are looking. Barely a third of S&P 500 members are trading above their 50-day moving averages, a widely-watched gauge of near-term breadth. The picture is even starker for the interest-rate-sensitive Russell 2000, where just 27 per cent of its small-cap constituents are above that threshold.

Bonds issued by the weakest borrowers yield about 15 per cent, a punishing hurdle for companies that need to refinance. US high-yield corporate spreads have widened in recent days, and a junk-bond ETF has dropped to around its lowest levels since last spring's tariff-war-fuelled selloff.

The landscape for new equity listings is feeling the chill, with a clutch of high-profile delays that NYSE Group President Lynn Martin has attributed to higher interest rates.

"The cap-weighted S&P 500 is masking a lot of the damage happening beneath the surface," said James St. Aubin, chief investment officer at Ocean Park Asset Management. "The bond market is effectively imposing tighter financial conditions even without help from the Fed. The risk is that what began as an energy shock eventually becomes an earnings problem, and the equity market has yet to fully price that possibility."

PORTFOLIO RESHUFFLE

For now, the rate shock is spurring investors to reshuffle portfolios rather than triggering a wholesale flight from risk. Investors are peeling back positions vulnerable to volatile bond yields and expensive financing, from speculative credit to currency carry trades.

The Russell 2000 notched its fifth straight weekly loss, down roughly 8.5 per cent from its high and nearing correction territory, while real estate stocks endured an extended losing streak. By contrast, the S&P 500 and tech-heavy Nasdaq 100 both climbed.

CHURN TIME

Investors are peeling back positions vulnerable to volatile bond yields and expensive financing, from speculative credit to currency carry trades

Thursday's selloff in chipmakers showed that even the AI trade isn't immune to a wobble in confidence. How much longer the big indexes can withstand the pressure may also come down to what happens next in oil and bonds.

A scenario combining a continued drain on megacap tech's cash flow with a 6 per cent yield on 10-year Treasuries and oil at $150 a barrel could send the S&P 500 down more than 20 per cent next year, according to Societe Generale strategists Manish Kabra, Charles de Boissezon and Kawtar Mamouni. A retreat in yields toward 4 per cent and oil to $80 alongside with improved fundamentals by Big Tech, by contrast, would leave room for further gains, they wrote in a recent note.

"5% yield creates valuation headwind but at 6% we should see a credit event" that is more likely to occur outside the private sector where the most leveraged balance sheets exist, Kabra said in an interview. "All questions are currently on the fiscal stability and debt sustainability of sovereigns."

Ocean Park's St. Aubin says his firm's internal models have flagged downtrends in several investments exposed to higher rates, prompting his team to cut exposure to credit-sensitive assets, including high-yield debt, as spreads widen. He calls below-investment-grade credit spreads "the true barometer of fear," making the widening since mid-September particularly unsettling.

The S&P 500's all-time high arrived with unprecedentedly thin breadth. With only 30 per cent of the index's members trading above their 50-day moving average, the participation was the weakest among all record days since Bloomberg data began in 1990.

Others aren't waiting for the squeeze to reach the stock market's winners. Jeff Muhlenkamp, whose $270-million fund has beaten the S&P 500 this year, has increased its energy holdings and sold almost all its AI-related stakes. "I'm happy to leave the party while it is still in full swing," he said, referring to the frenzy over the technology. "Financing is still available. When that is exhausted it will be game over."

ALERTS.

ICICI Prudential Nifty Pharma ETF NFO



ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has announced the launch of ICICI Prudential Nifty Pharma ETF, an open-ended Index ETF tracking the Nifty Pharma Index. The New Fund Offer (NFO) opens October 12 and closes October 19. India is the third-largest pharma producer and supplies roughly 20 per cent of the global generic medicines in terms of volume. India's pharma sector is moving up the value chain, from generics towards complex generics, injectables, specialty medicines and biologics, while global majors are increasingly outsourcing higher-margin work such as biosimilars and CDMO to Indian companies. The minimum application amount during the NFO is ₹1,000 and in multiples of ₹1.

Mahindra Manulife Mutual Fund debuts in SIF segment



Mahindra Manulife Mutual Fund has announced the launch of MSIF Equity Long-Short Fund, an open-ended equity investment strategy under its Specialised Investment Fund platform. The New Fund Offer will close on October 14. The investment strategy will reopen for continuous sale and repurchase from October 26. The strategy will invest predominantly in listed equity and equity-related instruments while selectively employing short positions through derivatives. It aims to identify opportunities across different market environments and seeking risk-adjusted returns across market cycles.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹) as on Oct 9	Price (₹) as on Oct 9	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
ETF				
Motilal Oswal Nasdaq Q50	123.8	252.0	30.5	8,858
Mirae Asset NYSE FANG+	185.4	287.1	15.7	6,852
Mirae Asset S&P 500 Top 50	70.2	115.1	13.4	6,578
UTI Nifty 500 ETF	35.2	37.2	7.5	69
Tata Nifty Digital ETF	85.0	84.9	4.1	1,237
Mirae Ast Nifty Ind Internet	13.5	13.7	3.7	1,118
Mirae Asset Hang Seng Tech	17.4	22.4	3.7	2,884
GOLD ETFs				
Invesco India Gold ETF	128.8	129.9	1.5	402
Baroda BNP Paribas Gold ETF	143.4	144.0	1.4	22
ICICI Prudential Gold ETF	126.8	127.4	1.2	27,916

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on October 9, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Oct 9	Returns (% CAGR) 3-year	5-year	10-year	Assets (₹ cr)
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	50.7	8.3	7.4	11.8	84,399
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	69.5	9.0	8.2	11.7	32,619
Kotak Pension Fund	63.4	8.4	7.9	11.5	4,874
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	31.1	6.6	5.8	7.4	9,328
SBI Pension Fund	41.7	6.7	5.8	6.9	31,577
HDFC Pension Fund	28.5	6.3	5.5	6.8	57,211
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.7	7.6	6.6	7.6	36,660
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	46.5	7.6	6.5	7.5	14,933
SBI Pension Fund	46.5	7.5	6.4	7.4	16,782
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	44.0	8.5	7.6	11.9	1,920
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	54.9	8.7	8.2	11.8	865
Kotak Pension Fund	55.9	8.4	8.0	11.5	233

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on October 9, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR) 1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	379	21.3	19.1	23.7
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE Bluechip	4	8.7	16.6	15.4
ICICI Pru	Largecap	945	11.1	18.8	15.0
Nippon Life India	Absolute Freedom	NA	10.7	15.8	13.6
MULTI CAP					
New Berry Capitals	Seeking Alpha	9	22.8	18.8	42.0
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	NA	26.0	19.3	23.7
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	9,547	18.2	32.7	23.6
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	119	14.2	22.2	23.5
Systematix Shares And Stock (I)	Dynamic Investment	NA	33.7	25.7	21.8
Turtle Wealth Management	Profit Mantra	NA	28.3	18.5	21.3
MID-CAP					
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	26.1	15.0	18.0
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	47.5	24.0	15.9
Nippon Life India	Emerging India	NA	15.4	15.8	15.3
Renaissance Invest. Managers	Midcap Portfolio	NA	0.9	8.3	15.1
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	2,380	34.7	27.4	32.5
Counter Cyclical Invest.	Diversified Long Term Value	1,087	14.7	18.6	29.2
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,633	1.1	18.2	22.7
Green Portfolio	Super 30 Dynamic Fund	267	25.1	18.6	22.3

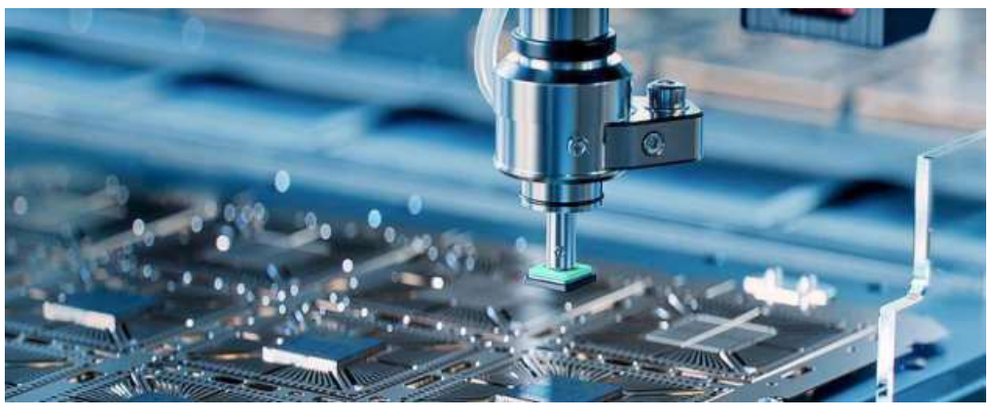
*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on October 09, 2026

EMS. AMBER ENTERPRISES ₹6,449.30

Journeying from Amber to Green

Electronics and mobile manufacturing support fast growth expectations in the medium term

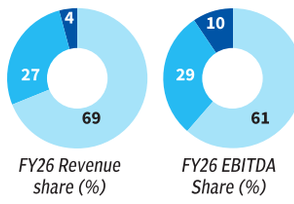
Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau



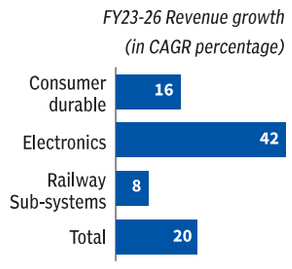
Amber Enterprises is transitioning to an electronics-led EMS manufacturer from a consumer-durables led company in the next three years. This should imply margin improvement, diversified exposure to a high growth sector and lower seasonality in earnings. Several new projects are lined up for the electronics division, including PCBs (printed circuit boards) and mobile manufacturing over the long term, while acquisitions done in 2025 should drive growth in the near term.

The stock is trading at 45 times one-year forward earnings (similar to last five-year average), which is at the lower range of the industry, but with comparatively stronger earnings prospects. Despite premium valuation, the stock holds long term potential; however, investors must periodically assess margin improvement and revenue growth and can consider accumulating the stock on dips.

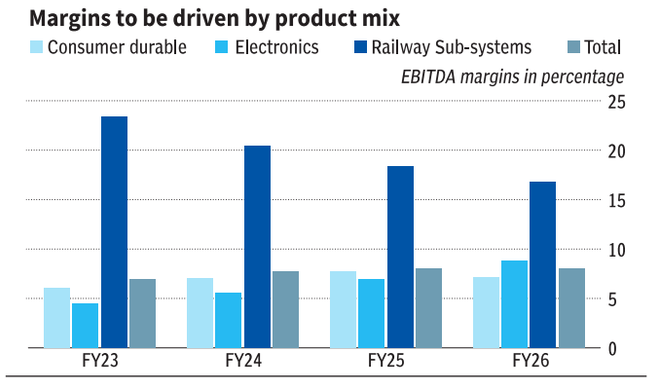
Revenue share



Electronics driven growth



Margins to be driven by product mix



KEY POINTS

- Electronics division expansion in PCBs.
- Foray into mobile manufacturing
- Material costs to impact margins in near term

NEAR-TERM DRIVERS

The company primarily manufactures RACs — components or assembly — in the consumer durables section, PCBs in the electronics and railway components in the railways division.

As shown in the table, the electronics division has grown at 42 per cent CAGR in FY23-26 and accounts for 27 per cent/29 per cent of FY26 revenues and EBITDA, respectively. The management has guided for a revenue growth of 40 per cent in FY27 as well, supported by organic expansion and the three acquisitions done in FY25 — Power-One in August (₹260 crore for a 60 per cent stake), Unitronics in October (around ₹500 crore for a 50.4 per cent stake) and Shogini in December (₹525 crore for an 80 per cent stake). The acquisitions offer cross-selling and operational synergies in FY27, which will be the first full year of consolidation.

Unitronics is an Israel-based company, which designs and assembles industrial electronics including interfaces for HVAC (heating, ventilation and air conditioning) systems. Amber can offer backward integration with its bare PCB (electronics division) and injection moulding (consumer durables), and open new avenues for Unitronics on supplies and Indian markets. The samples for the same and further product development are in progress.

Power-one manufactures UPS, solar-inverters, BESS and EV chargers. Similar to Unitronics, Amber can extend back-end facilities for the same and expand the market to North India for the South-based operator with its pan-India presence.

Shogini manufactures PCBs (multi-layered and flexible boards) and opens Amber to PCB demand from automobiles, medical, industrial and power divisions, which complements Amber's existing PCB and PCBA (PCB assembly) sales across consumer durables, telecom and other sectors.

The railways segment will benefit from a new facility in Haryana, which will manufacture HVACs, pantry systems, gangways and doors for railways. The facility, operationalised in Q1FY27, is backed by a strong ₹2,600-crore order-book. The segment is expected to nearly double in the next two years reporting 30-35 per cent growth in FY27 and FY28, as per the company. The segment also serves metro rails (around 35 per cent share) and is developing a defence section as well (10 per cent).

Compared to the high growth expected in the other two divisions, the consumer durables segment is expected to face a milder growth of 13-15 per cent in FY27 owing to slow recovery expected in the RAC segment. Non-AC exposure (30 per cent of revenues including washing machines, refrigerators and others) and a growing commercial AC (more than two tonnes) are the other divisions supporting the segment growth. The company also augmented its existing RAC facility in Sri City, Andhra Pradesh.

LONG-TERM DRIVERS

Based on the above, Amber should be expected to grow revenues at 20 per cent in FY27 with a slight moderation in EBITDA margins. The longer-term prospects are equally strong for the company.

First, Amber has now announced a manufacturing collaboration with Oppo (includes brands of Oppo, OnePlus and Realme) for mobile phones. While the details of the financial tie-up are expected, the company expects to start commercial production by Q1FY28 with eight million phones in FY28 and 15-16 million in the next fiscal. For comparison, Dixon, which leads the mobile-manufacturing EMS segment, manufactures around 40 million phones per year. This venture should launch the company in the fast-growing segment of mobile manufacturing in India.

Amber has received approval for ₹4,500-crore investment under the ECMS or Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme of the Central government, which provides a capital and turnover incentives.

The investment plan is led by a joint venture (70:30 in favour of Amber) with Korea Circuits on a 16-acre plot located near Noida Airport. The project is expected to cost around ₹3,200 crore and trial production is expected by Q3FY28. The facility is expected to produce HDI (high-density interconnect) PCB and the JV partner also provides an offtake of the full capacity for two years. Amber is also developing a multi-layer PCB manufacturing facility at Hosur at ₹1,000 crore and the plant is expected to commercialise in this financial year. With an assumed asset turnover ratio of 1 times, this should add 20-30 per cent to revenues in two-three years.

FINANCIALS, VALUATION

The company reported revenue and PAT of ₹12,187 crore/₹230 crore in FY26 with an EBITDA margin of 8 per cent in the year. Margins in the longer term will be supported by the product mix change – faster growth of the electronics and railways divisions, which have a higher EBITDA margin than the consumer durables division, as shown in the figure. But the current higher costs of copperwill impact EBITDA margins in the near term. Amber passes on the raw material costs, but after a quarter lag in consumer durables and two-quarter lag in electronics (second order supplier). Overall, the product mix changes and raw material costs (with pass-on impact) will limit margin expansion in the near term.

The company reported a net debt of ₹1,225 crore in June 2026, which is 1.26 times FY26 EBITDA. The metric will be further strained by the upcoming capital commitments. But over a long run, the capital strain should be offset by incentives from the ECMS scheme and also State government schemes (UP and Tamil Nadu).

AUTO ANCILLARY. STUDDS ACCESSORIES ₹413.40

Under the helmet, value is beginning to rise

Premiumisation and exports offer growth opportunities, but earnings recovery and delayed capacity expansion need watching

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau



Studds Accessories, the country's largest two-wheeler helmet maker, has seen its stock decline about 29 per cent from its ₹585 IPO price in November 2025 to ₹413.40 (BSE). Its market capitalisation has shrunk from ₹2,300 crore at the IPO to ₹1,627 crore.

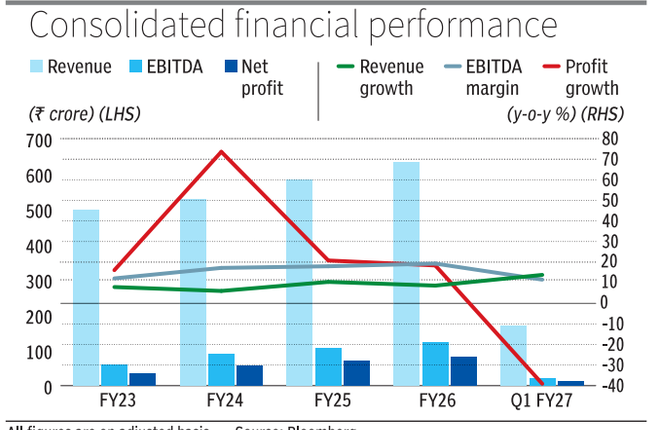
The stock's fall has been sharper than the broader market's 12.2 per cent decline and the roughly 7.5 per cent correction in the Nifty Auto index since its November 7 listing, though there are some stocks in the auto ancillary space that have fallen 25-35 per cent in the same period.

While we had suggested subscribing to the Studds IPO with a three-to-five-year horizon, our premise was that the valuation of 33 times FY25 earnings per share left little room for disappointment but long-term growth prospects made it worth considering.

The subsequent stock price weakness reflects both valuation correction and some earnings growth concerns. FY26-adjusted revenue grew 8.6 per cent, slower than the 10.4 per cent growth in FY25. Subsequently, a sharp rise in raw material prices, aggravated by geopolitical disruptions and higher wage costs squeezed margins. In Q1FY27, though topline grew 13.8 per cent, EBITDA declined 35 per cent and net profit dropped 39 per cent year on year. Delays in commissioning additional capacity (manufacturing facility – V) have also added to the uncertainty.

At 19.7 times trailing 12-month earnings (and 21.4x based on FY26 earnings), Studds' valuations seem reasonable. Premium helmets and exports are gaining ground, while the balance sheet remains decent. This positions the stock for margin and profit growth recovery. Historically, EBITDA margins for the company were in the 11-12 per cent range in FY22 and FY23, before climbing to the 17-19 per cent range in later years. Q1FY27 margin stood at 11.5 per cent.

Consolidated financial performance



All figures are on adjusted basis Source: Bloomberg

Bloomberg consensus estimates FY27 earnings per share at ₹17.80, down nearly 15.2 per cent from FY26. This is estimated to be followed by a recovery of EPS to ₹26.25 in FY28. Thus, Studds' valuation argument rests on the expected earnings rebound. Therefore, long-term investors should stagger purchases in small quantities rather than assume that the stock correction has fully priced in the risks. Also, given the current sentiment in equity markets and rising interest scenario, investors should aim for a bigger margin of safety than previously.

KEY POINTS

- Lower valuations improve prospects
- Premium helmet contribution rising
- Earnings, margins recovery remains monitorable

BUSINESS

Studds manufactures two-wheeler helmets under the Studds and SMK brands, besides supplying helmets under private labels and selling riding accessories. Studds caters mainly to the mass and mid-market segments, while SMK targets premium customers. The company holds about 25 per cent share of India's domestic helmet market. Its manufacturing operations are concentrated in Faridabad, Haryana. Note, Studds' key raw materials include ABS (acrylonitrile butadiene styrene), polycarbonate and EPS (expanded polystyrene), along with paints, fabrics, visors and packaging materials.

Studds sold 81.3 lakh helmets and boxes in FY26, with production of 82.7 lakh units and capacity utilisation of about 89 per cent. It has over 360 distributors in India and exports to more than 70 countries. The company is expanding annual helmet and box capacity from about 95 lakh units to 1.25 crore units through its fifth manufacturing facility. The first phase will add 15 lakh units annually.

Studds also plans to expand beyond helmets into riding jackets, Bluetooth communication systems and bicycle helmets. It has secured a manufacturing relationship with Decathlon for bicycle helmets.

The management said underlying demand was stable across its key markets, supported by two-wheeler ownership, premium motorcycles, adventure touring and greater safety awareness.

WHAT WE LIKE

SMK's revenue share rose from 11.8 per cent in FY25 to 15.7 per cent in FY26, while exports increased from 16.75 per cent to 20.1 per cent. Both offer an avenue for growth beyond the domestic mass-market helmet business.

SMK generates EBITDA margins roughly 10 percentage points higher than Studds, while SMK exports can earn margins of 30-35 per cent. A greater contribution from these could support profitability as volumes expand.

Studds is also establishing direct dealer operations in Italy, Germany and France, aimed at reducing dependence on distributors in these markets. Its Italian subsidiary is expected to improve delivery responsiveness and support European expansion, although profitability will take time.

Underlying demand has remained resilient. Q1 FY27 helmet volumes grew 8.5 per cent despite price increases, while revenue rose 13.8 per cent. The management expects volume growth of about 8-10 per cent for FY27.

Balance sheet provides further comfort. Bloomberg data show FY26 cash of ₹84.6 crore against borrowings of ₹8.2 crore. Operating cash flow was ₹91.2 crore, versus ₹82.6 crore net profit.

WHAT TO MONITOR

The immediate concern is profitability. EBITDA margin contracted from 20.3 per cent in Q1 FY26 to 11.5 per cent in Q1 FY27, as raw material costs and wages rose sharply. The management attributed around six percentage points of margin pressure to materials and another two percentage points to manpower costs (hike in minimum wages in Haryana).

Studds has increased selling prices by about 9 per cent, but the benefit is being realised gradually across customers. Raw material prices have moderated from their peak, although higher wage costs are likely to persist. The management expects EBITDA margins of 14-15 per cent in Q2 FY27 and a return to an 18-20 per cent by Q4.

The first phase of the fifth facility was initially expected in Q4 FY26. Following successive delays, commercial production is now expected by October-end.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — **Editor**

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	Oct 1	Oct 9		
Trent	2,597.4	2,920.0	▲	12.4
Kotak Mahindra Bank	419.8	440.1	▲	4.8
TCS	2,079.3	2,163.0	▲	4.0
Bharti Airtel	1,741.0	1,806.6	▲	3.8
ICICI Bank	1,305.5	1,354.1	▲	3.7
Axis Bank	1,214.0	1,259.0	▲	3.7
ITC	257.0	266.2	▲	3.6
Eternal	313.5	323.4	▲	3.1
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,738.0	1,760.0	▲	1.3
HUL	1,841.0	1,861.0	▲	1.1
Bajaj Finance	949.4	958.2	▲	0.9
SBI	954.0	958.1	▲	0.4
Bajaj Finserv	1,729.9	1,737.3	▲	0.4
Reliance Industries	1,166.0	1,170.8	▲	0.4
L&T	3,685.5	3,699.1	▲	0.4
Maruti Suzuki	11,400.0	11,395.0	▼	0.0
Tata Motors PV	280.0	279.1	▼	-0.3
Infosys	1,035.0	1,024.1	▼	-1.1
UltraTech Cement	10,799.0	10,680.0	▼	-1.1
Tech Mahindra	1,539.0	1,517.1	▼	-1.4
HDFC Bank	719.4	707.1	▼	-1.7
NTPC	316.7	311.1	▼	-1.8
Power Grid	254.7	249.5	▼	-2.0
M & M	2,851.1	2,792.1	▼	-2.1
HCL Tech	1,246.0	1,214.3	▼	-2.5
Asian Paints	2,406.3	2,345.0	▼	-2.5
Titan	4,535.0	4,406.3	▼	-2.8
Sun Pharma	1,810.0	1,756.9	▼	-2.9
Tata Steel	179.1	173.6	▼	-3.1
Bharat Electronics	383.5	368.5	▼	-3.9

How sectoral indices moved

	Oct 1	Oct 9	Movement	% change
FMCG	16,651.3	17,056.4	▲	2.4
TECK	14,283.2	14,546.4	▲	1.8
BANKEX	61,356.1	62,159.2	▲	1.3
IT	27,198.8	27,406.6	▲	0.8
PSU	19,298.0	19,154.0	▼	-0.7
CONSUMER DURABLES	57,809.5	57,153.3	▼	-1.1
CAPITAL GOODS	74,133.3	73,291.7	▼	-1.1
OIL&GAS	24,621.7	24,157.9	▼	-1.9
HEALTHCARE	49,899.9	48,828.0	▼	-2.1
AUTO	56,364.1	55,145.9	▼	-2.2
POWER	7,145.0	6,986.3	▼	-2.2
METALS	39,634.3	37,979.3	▼	-4.2
REALTY	6,554.3	6,279.8	▼	-4.2

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

1. I have become the largest player nationally in less than two decades and am considered to be a pioneer in this industry.
2. I got listed through a corporate restructuring of my parent, which was split twice last decade due to a family settlement.
3. My MD is a resident of a foreign country and never let his personal challenges with the Delhi Police several years ago intrude into his professional responsibilities.
4. My negative earnings last year, for the first time since listing, pulled my stock down by almost half, and it now needs to more than quadruple from current levels to reach its all-time high.
5. Despite negative returns to shareholders in recent years, institutional stake has been steadily on the rise and is now about 30 per cent.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to **who-am-i@thehindu.co.in**, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL
Investing With Conviction

Last week's stock: Paradeep Phosphates
Last week's winner: Siddharth Gautam

CHENNAI
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - OCTOBER 11 - 2026

Bulls face a test

F&O TRACKER. Indices snap losing streaks but charts are yet to confirm a trend reversal



GETTY IMAGES

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (22,520) snapped an eight-week decline by gaining 0.4 per cent last week. Nifty Bank (55,257), after falling for six weeks consecutively, was up 1.5 per cent.

However, it might be too early to call the recovery as a bullish trend reversal. Below is an analysis.

NIFTY 50
Nifty (Oct) futures (22,613) gained 0.4 per cent last week. However, there was no significant change in outstanding open interest (OI), suggesting that traders largely retained their existing positions.

The OI of October futures stood at 190.7 lakh contracts on Friday compared with 191.6 lakh contracts at the end of the preceding week.

The cumulative futures OI, too, remained largely unchanged at 218 lakh contracts on Friday against 219 lakh contracts a week earlier.

The Put Call Ratio (PCR) of October options remained unchanged at 1. However, the PCR of November options increased marginally from 0.9 to 1, indicating relatively higher put writing during the week.

This suggests a slight moderation in bearish sentiment in the next month's series.

Overall, the derivatives data does not provide a clear directional signal, although there are signs of easing bearishness.

The chart, on the other hand, shows that the downtrend remains intact, with key resistance levels standing in the way of a bullish reversal.

The nearest hurdle for Nifty futures is at 22,915, the 23.6 per cent Fibonacci retracement level of the recent downswing. The next resistance is at 23,120, where the 21-day moving average coincides.

Only a breakout above 23,120 can turn the near-term outlook positive. Such a move can trigger a rally to 23,300 and subsequently to 23,600.

Alternatively, if October futures slips below the important support at 22,250, the downtrend can resume, potentially dragging the contract to 22,000. The region between 21,800 and 22,000 is a notable support band.

Overall, a breakout above 23,120 is necessary to signal a potential bullish reversal. Until then, the broader outlook remains weak.

Strategy: The direction of the next leg of the trend hinges on a breakout above 23,120 or a breakdown below 22,250.

Therefore, we suggest traders stay on the sidelines for now.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank (Oct) futures (55,480) rallied 1.3 per cent last week. However, the outstanding OI of this contract remained unchanged on a weekly basis at 23.6 lakh contracts.

ROOM FOR RISE
- Selling pressure eases
- Key hurdles remain
- Traders advised caution

The cumulative OI witnessed a marginal decline from 25.9 lakh contracts to 25.5 lakh contracts during the week.

While futures positioning does not provide a clear directional signal, the PCR of options offers some relief to the bulls. The ratio of October options improved from 0.86 to 1, while that of November contracts rose from 0.40 to 0.63.

This indicates relatively higher put writing compared to calls, a positive sign.

However, the chart is yet to confirm a bullish trend reversal. Nifty Bank (Oct) futures faces resistance at 55,600, followed by another hurdle at 56,000. The 21-day moving average and the 38.2 per cent Fibonacci retracement of the recent downtrend coincide at 56,000. Therefore, a breakout above this level is crucial for a trend reversal.

Comparatively, Nifty futures has some room to rise before encountering resistance, whereas Nifty Bank futures is already hovering near a significant hurdle.

If the contract surpasses 56,000, it can advance to 57,000. The region between 57,000 and 57,250 is a resistance band.

Alternatively, if Nifty Bank (Oct) futures declines from the current level of 55,480, it can fall to the nearest support at 54,350. Subsequent support is at 54,000.

Strategy: So long as Nifty Bank (Oct) futures trades within 54,350 and 56,000, the path of next price swing will remain uncertain.

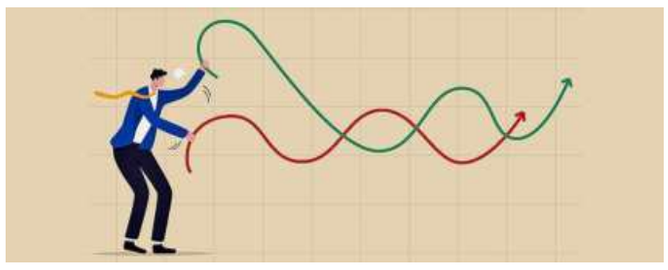
Hence, traders can stay out until either of these levels are breached.

Managing spread positions

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Volatility during closing hours of the market can impact your trades

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

As a retail trader, you are forced to compete with trading algorithms. You must also be mindful of technology-driven trading architecture used by exchanges that impact your trading process. Previously, we discussed the impact of closing auction session (CAS) on intraday futures position. Based on feedback from market participants, SEBI intends to revise the process for determining closing prices. Whatever the trading architecture, volatility during closing hours of the market can impact your position. This week, we discuss two strategies you can adopt to reduce delivery risk on your overnight spread position because of high volatility at market close.



MITIGATING RISKS
Strategies that can be adopted to reduce delivery risk on your overnight spread position due to high volatility at market close

CLOSING COSTS
A bull call spread involves going long on a lower strike call and short on a higher strike call of the same expiry on the same underlying. The spread is set up for a net debit, with the difference between the strikes less the net debit as your maximum gains. Previously, we discussed two important aspects of the spread — slippage costs when initiating the position and delivery risk on the day of expiry. We showed how you can lower slippage costs by setting up a basket order to initiate the spread. Delivery risk arises because of the possibility of the underlying price closing between the two strikes at expiry. This will force you to take delivery of the stock because the long leg will be in-the-money (ITM) whereas the short leg will expire worthless. Such a situation will expose you to large capital outlay on the long leg. How can you reduce this risk?

You can consider one of the following two strategies. First, set up bull call spread on the Nifty Index if you are comfortable trading short-dated (weekly) options. You can also consider Bank Nifty if you are open to trading monthly options. The advantage of trading options on the Nifty Index and Bank Nifty Index is that they are cash-settled. So, you are not exposed to the risk of having to take delivery if the long call ends ITM. Second, if you want to trade equity options, consider a diagonal spread closer to the near-month expiry instead of a bull call spread. This spread involves going long on the next-month lower strike call and short on the near-month higher strike call on the same underlying. There are two benefits. One, the long call expires later. So, you are not exposed to delivery risk on the expiry of the short call. And two, the short call will have a faster time decay. You could close the position on the expiry of the short call.

OPTIONAL READING
You should be mindful of several factors before initiating spread strategies. One, margin on the short leg. Two, lowering slippage costs while initiating and closing the position. Three, delivery margins and delivery risk on the long leg. Four, reward-to-risk ratio if you close the position four days before expiry. Small wonder that active traders lean on technology to manage their positions.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Rally may falter

BULLION CUES. Resistance can cap recovery

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold ($4,194.70/ounce) and silver ($60.40/ounce) appreciated 1.3 and 0.7 per cent respectively. In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,51,499/10 gm) gained 0.7 per cent whereas silver futures (₹2,25,755/kg) was down by a marginal 0.1 per cent.



MCX-GOLD (₹1,51,499)
Gold (Dec) futures has been trading flat recently. Although the contract gained over 1 per cent on Friday, there are key resistance levels ahead that can cap the rise.

The nearest hurdle is at ₹1,54,000. If this level is breached, the bulls will gain strength, possibly lifting the price higher to ₹1,60,000. Resistance above ₹1,60,000 is at ₹1,65,000.

However, if gold futures falls from the current level, it can find support at ₹1,48,000. A breakdown below this can open the door for a fall to ₹1,44,000.

Strategy: Traders can initiate short position on gold (Dec) futures at ₹1,53,000. Keep stop-loss at ₹1,56,000. Book profits at ₹1,44,000.

MCX-SILVER ((₹2,25,755)
Silver (Dec) futures saw a decline and made a low of ₹2,19,801 on Thursday. However, it rallied over 2 per cent on Friday, recouping the loss.

Nevertheless, the contract remains below an important resistance at ₹2,30,000. So, as long as this level holds, silver futures will retain the bearish inclination.

In case silver futures breaks out of ₹2,30,000, it can extend the rally to ₹2,42,000, a resistance. Subsequent barrier is at ₹2,50,000.

On the other hand, if the contract resumes the fall, it can touch ₹2,19,000, an important base. A breach of this can lead to a swift fall to ₹2,10,000.

Strategy: Sell silver (Dec) futures at ₹2,29,000 and place a stop-loss at ₹2,33,000. Book profits at ₹2,20,000.

More gains likely

CRUDE CHECK. Higher levels stay within reach

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) ($104.70/barrel) rallied 2.4 per cent last week. Whereas crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,881/barrel) was down 0.4 per cent.



BRENT FUTURES ($104.70)
Brent crude futures, which saw some correction in price in the first half of last week, recovered in the last two sessions. Thus, the contract has formed a higher base and has rebounded from a trendline support.

Given the current conditions, the probability for further rally is high.

We expect Brent crude futures to retest the resistance at $110. A breakout of this can take the contract higher to $115.

Instead, if the contract falls from the current level, it can find support at $100 and $96. A breach of the latter can turn the outlook weak, possibly dragging the contract to $86.

MCX CRUDE OIL (₹8,881)
Crude oil (Oct) futures fell to mark a low of ₹8,388 on Tuesday. However, it recovered on the same day, keeping the support at ₹8,500 valid.

The contract went up in the second half of last week. Thus, the bulls continue to hold an edge over the bears.

Although ₹9,000 is a resistance ahead, we anticipate a breakout of this. A rally past ₹9,000 can take crude oil futures to ₹9,750.

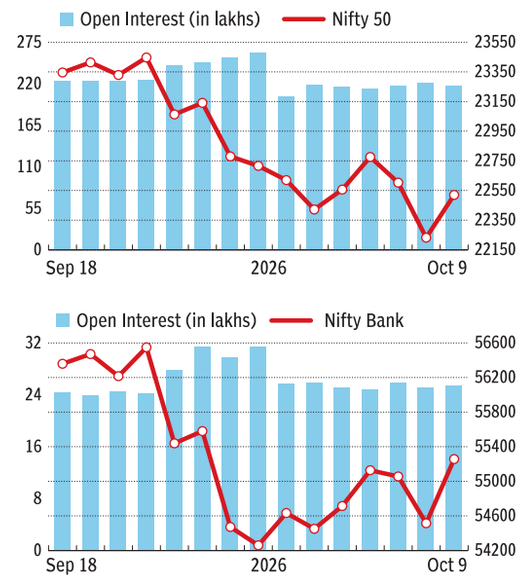
A breach of this can lift the contract to ₹10,000 and subsequently to ₹10,500.

However, if the contract falls and invalidates the support at ₹8,500, it can fall to ₹8,200.

A breach of ₹8,200 can turn the near-term outlook weak, possibly taking the price lower to ₹7,500.

Strategy: Buy crude oil (Oct) futures now at ₹8,881 and place a stop-loss at ₹8,300. Exit at ₹9,750.

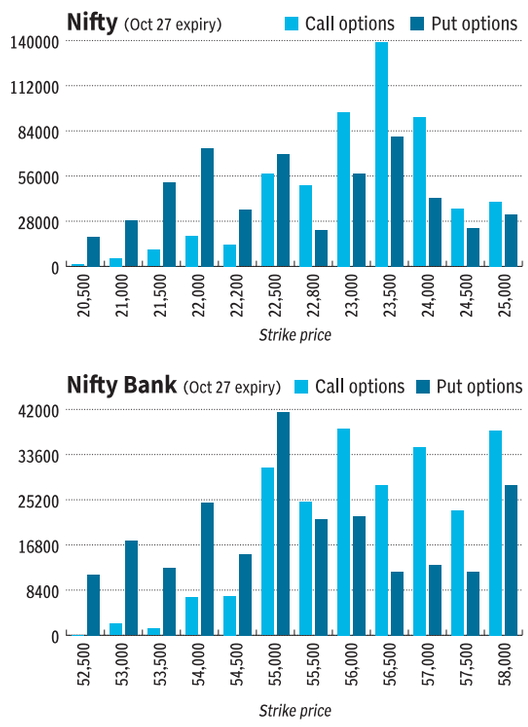
Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain

(as on Oct 9)

Put-Call ratio Nifty **1.00** | Nifty Bank **1.00**



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Oct 9	Weekly change %	As on Oct 9	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	34,943	18	291,627	-5
Future Index Short	328,931	-3	62,104	9
Net Futures	-293,988	-5	229,523	-8
Index Call options Long	600,034	-11	3,396,080	-9
Index Call options Short	946,852	-14	3,337,345	-3
Net Call options	-346,818	-20	58,735	-80
Index Put options Long	1,245,164	12	3,418,874	45
Index Put options Short	704,672	57	4,049,875	26
Net Put Options	540,492	-19	-631,001	-25

FIIs have reduced net short on index futures. They've also cut net short on index calls and net long on index puts. These indicate easing bearishness.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Oct 9)				
ANANDRATHI	2,038.70	-3.7	70.8	829.9
UJJIVANSFB	61.45	-6.3	441.4	143.1
DMART	3,516.80	-7.8	128.9	101.0
ENRIN	3,101.00	-7.0	9.7	72.6
ITC	266.00	3.9	3774.1	47.0
FALL (as on Oct 9)				
BANKINDIA	134.46	3.8	1193.7	-11.1
BANDHANBNK	157.00	-10.8	1840.8	-6.8
RECLTD	300.00	4.3	815.2	-4.4
SOLARINDS	20,000.00	3.1	18.3	-3.6
AMBUJACEM	351.50	-3.0	1126.3	-3.5

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Oct 12)

AMBUJACEM	BANDHANBNK	LICHSGFIN

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹) (Weekly change %)	OI (Weekly change %)	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on Oct 9)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Oct	335.4 (-0.4)	4,840 (20)	Short build-up
COPPER	30-Oct	1,427.2 (2.0)	8,346 (0)	Long build-up
CRUDEOIL	19-Oct	8,881.0 (-0.4)	9,688 (-14)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOILM	19-Oct	8,878.0 (-0.4)	28,206 (-21)	Long unwinding
GOLD	4-Dec	1,51,499.0 (0.7)	16,126 (1)	Long build-up
GOLDGUINEA	30-Oct	1,20,750.0 (0.6)	14,379 (6)	Long build-up
GOLDM	5-Nov	1,50,130.0 (0.7)	43,126 (1)	Long build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Oct	15,101.0 (0.7)	1,88,357 (-5)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	30-Oct	1,50,459.0 (0.7)	29,868 (0)	Long build-up
LEAD	30-Oct	195.2 (1.6)	582 (12)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	27-Oct	313.9 (9.2)	29,501 (-46)	Short covering
SILVER	4-Dec	2,25,755.0 (-0.1)	16,859 (2)	Short build-up
SILVERM	30-Nov	2,27,797.0 (-0.1)	39,118 (-1)	Long unwinding
SILVERMIC	30-Nov	2,27,845.0 (-0.1)	1,32,410 (-1)	Long unwinding
ZINC	30-Oct	422.1 (2.8)	1,993 (-25)	Short covering
CURRENCIES (as on Oct 9)				
USDINR	28-Oct	96.95 (0.5)	17,28,068 (40)	Long build-up
EURINR	28-Oct	108.85 (-0.3)	7,362 (16)	Short build-up
GBPINR	28-Oct	128.28 (0.5)	2,649 (1)	Long build-up
JPYINR	28-Oct	61.47 (0.3)	533 (-1)	Short covering

F&O Strategy

Buy Solar Industries call

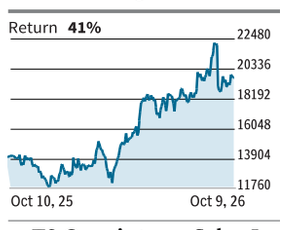
KS Badri Narayanan

The long-term outlook remains positive for the stock of Solar Industries India (₹20,000) while the short-term outlook is neutral.

The immediate support is at ₹18,555. A conclusive close below this will change the short-term outlook negative. The next support is at ₹16,900. A close below this can turn the long-term outlook also negative.

On the other hand, if the current trend sustains, the stock can rise to new heights.

Note that Solar Industries is a recently included stock in the F&O segment.



F&O pointers: Solar Industries October futures closed at ₹19,963, which is at a discount to the spot close of ₹20,000.

However, the contract saw unwinding of open positions in the last couple of days. Currently, open interests stand at 8.67 lakh.

Option trading signals that the stock could move in the range of ₹22,500-17,000.

Strategy: We suggest buying 20,250-call on Solar Industries that closed with a premium of ₹439.35. As the market lot is 50 shares, this would cost traders ₹21,967.50. This would be the maximum loss and that will happen, if the stock fails to cross ₹20,250.

That said, there is good profit potential if Solar Industries surges sharply.

We advise traders to book profit if the premium rises to ₹500. Stop-loss can be ₹390. This strategy is valid only for a week.

Follow-up: Hold Federal Bank long strategy.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Short Take

Strike arbitrage strategy

BL Research Bureau

Strike arbitrage in options can be executed with two option contracts (i.e., simultaneously buying and selling two strikes) of the same underlying with the same maturity but with different strike prices. Arbitrage is done to capitalise on the price difference and earn a risk-free return.

To understand this, let us consider call options (CE) of a security, say stock A, trading at ₹100. The price of all call options with strike above



₹100 will ideally be lower than ₹100-strike call option (₹100-CE) i.e., higher the strike, lower the option price. For example, assuming that the strike interval is ₹10, and suppose ₹110-CE is trading at ₹50, the price of, say ₹120-CE, can be lower, maybe ₹40. But this may not always hold true because of the supply and demand of the contracts.

For instance, when ₹120-CE is trading at ₹40, the ₹130-CE might trade at ₹45. There is a strike arbitrage opportunity here. One can buy ₹120-CE and short ₹130-CE and earn a risk-free profit irrespective of underlying price on expiry (excluding charges).

Suppose the price of stock A is ₹105 on expiry, both ₹120- and ₹130-CE will become worthless, effectively earning a profit of ₹5. But if it closes at say ₹150 on expiry, the price of ₹120-CE and ₹130-CE will be ₹30 and ₹20, respectively. Here net loss in ₹120-CE is ₹10 (₹40-₹30) whereas net profit in ₹130-CE is ₹25 (₹45-₹20). Here, the net risk-free profit is ₹15.



Staying afloat

INDEX OUTLOOK. The benchmark indices are holding well above their crucial support

ETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 and Sensex have snapped their eight-week fall. Both the indices managed to witness some recovery and close the week higher by 0.44 per cent and 0.78 per cent, respectively. Nifty Bank index on the other hand was up 1.48 per cent last week after having fallen for six consecutive weeks.

On the charts, the benchmark indices are holding very well above their crucial support in spite of high volatility. That keeps alive the chances of seeing a good recovery in the coming weeks. The danger is only if the indices break below their key support.

FPI'S SELL

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) continue to sell heavily. The equity segment saw a net outflow of $3.6 billion last week. With this, the total outflow in the equities for the month of October stands at $4.58 billion. Continuous selling from the FPIs can keep the benchmark indices subdued.



NIFTY 50 (22,520.45)

Short-term outlook: The support at 22,100 is holding well for now. As long as the Nifty stays above this support, a rise to 22,800-23,000 is possible from here. Failure to breach 23,000 can drag the index down to 22,100 again.

A strong break above 23,000 will ease the downside pressure. Such a break can take the Nifty higher to 23,200, 23,600, and even 24,000 in the short term.

The danger is only if the Nifty breaks below 22,100. If that happens, we can see the index declining to 20,500.

Medium-term view: For now, the broad 22,000-26,500 range is intact. The rise to 24,000 mentioned above will keep the upside open to see 26,500 over the medium term.

We are continuing to retain our long-term bullish view. We expect the Nifty to breach 26,500 in the coming months and go up to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term.

The break below 21,800 and the fall to 20,500 will be an initial sign to indicate that our bullish view is going wrong.

NIFTY BANK (55,256.65)

Short-term view: The index sustained higher and stable above 54,350 all through the week. Immediate resistance is at 55,600. A break above it can take the Nifty Bank index higher to 57,000-57,500. Failure to break 55,600 can drag the index down to 54,350-54,000 again.

The level of 53,800 is a crucial support to watch. The index will come under more selling pressure if it breaks below this support. Such a break can drag the Nifty Bank index down to 51,000 in the coming weeks.

Medium-term view: The level of 51,000 is a strong support which can limit the downside. As long as the index sustains above 51,000, there is no major change in our long-term bullish view. We reiterate that 65,000 and 68,000-69,000 can be seen on the upside in the long term. A sustained rise above 61,000 will clear the way for this rally.

Nifty Bank index has to decline below 51,000 to prove our bullish view wrong. In that case, 49,000-48,000 can be seen on the downside.

SENSEX (72,472.33)

Short-term view: The crucial 71,200-71,000 support zone is holding well for now. A follow-through rise from current levels can take the Sensex up to 73,550 in the near term. A decisive break above 73,550 will confirm a double bottom on the daily chart. It will then take the Sensex higher to 74,500 or 74,800-75,000 in the short-term.

On the other hand, failure to breach 73,550 and a downward reversal from here can take the index down to 71,200-71,000 again.

Sensex will come under more selling pressure if it breaks below 71,000. If that happens, 70,700 and 69,800 can be seen on the downside.

Medium-term view: Sensex is managing to hold around the lower end of its broad 71,000-86,000 range. If the rise to 75,000 mentioned above happens, then the index can get some breather. It will then increase the chances of seeing a rise to 86,000, the upper end of the range over the medium term.

For now, we retain our bullish view of the Sensex breaking above 86,000 and rally to 90,000 and 94,000 in the long term.

This bullish view will come under threat only if the Sensex declines below 69,800.

CRUCIAL SUPPORT

- Nifty 50: 22,100, 21,800
- Sensex: 71,000, 70,700
- Nifty Bank: 53,800

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (21,603.25)

The resistance in the 21,900-22,100 region mentioned last week is holding well. The Nifty Midcap 150 index touched a high of 21,983.95 and has come down from there. That keeps the index vulnerable to break the immediate support level of 21,350. Such a break can take the Nifty Midcap 150 index down to 20,800 or 20,500 in the short term.

After this fall, we can expect a fresh leg of upmove to begin targeting 22,000 initially and then 23,500 eventally. That in turn will keep our broader bullish view intact. We retain our view of the Nifty Midcap 150 index targeting 26,000-26,500 and 28,000 on the upside over the long term.

In case the index breaks below 20,500, then an extended fall to 19,000-18,500 can be seen. In that case, the expected long-term rally will only get delayed and not get negated.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (17,574.85)

The support in the 17,300-17,200 region is holding well amid the strong fall from the intra-week high of 17,969. A follow-through rise from here can take the Nifty Smallcap 250 index higher to 17,900 and even 18,300 in the coming weeks.

A strong break above 18,300 and a subsequent rise above 18,500 will strengthen our long-term bullish case. That will take the Nifty Smallcap 250 index higher to 22,500-23,000 and 24,000-24,500 in the long term.

The index has to break 17,200 in order to turn the short-term picture negative. Such a break can take it down to 16,600-16,500. Such a fall will delay our expected long-term rally. It will also keep the index vulnerable to see 15,500 and lower levels.

A fall below 15,000 is needed to negate our long-term bullish outlook.

bl.portfolio video

Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English Tamil

TECH QUERY

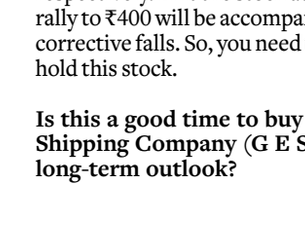


GURUMURTHY K, bl.research bureau

I bought shares of APL Apollo Tubes at ₹2,207. What is the long-term outlook?

Venkat Raman

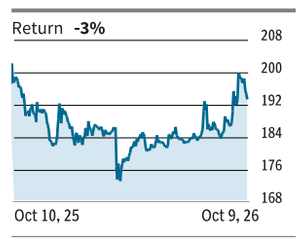
APL Apollo Tubes (₹2,105): The broader trend is up. For now, the stock is struggling to breach ₹2,300. A fall to ₹1,850-₹1,830 is possible in the short term. A bounce from this ₹1,850-₹1,830 support zone can take the price higher to ₹2,300 again. A strong and sustained break above ₹2,300 will be bullish to see ₹3,000-₹3,200 over the next one year. You can accumulate on dips at ₹1,880. Keep a stop-loss at ₹1,710 and hold the stock. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹2,130 when the price goes up to ₹2,340. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹2,440 and ₹2,860 when the share price touches ₹2,720 and ₹2,980. Exit the stock at ₹3,160. If the stock breaks below ₹1,830 then ₹1,650-₹1,630 can be seen on the downside.



I bought Castrol India shares at ₹193. What is the long-term technical outlook for this stock?

V Vijaykumar, Pune

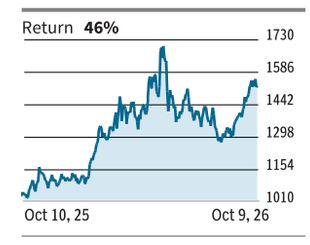
Castrol India (₹195): The stock is getting very good support in the ₹165-₹160 region. The bias is positive. A rise to ₹285-₹290 looks possible in the next four to six quarters. A strong break above ₹290 will boost the bullish momentum. It will clear the way for a fresh rally to ₹400 over the next three-four years. Accumulate on dips at ₹182. Keep a stop-loss at ₹138. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹230 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹270, Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹290 and ₹345 when the price touches ₹320 and ₹370 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹395. Please note that the rally to ₹400 will be accompanied by intermediate corrective falls. So, you need to have more patience to hold this stock.



Is this a good time to buy Great Eastern Shipping Company (G E Shipping)? What is the long-term outlook?

Gopalakrishnan

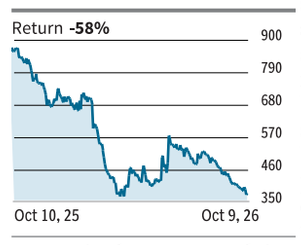
G E Shipping (₹1,534): The broader trend is up. But, ₹1,670 and ₹1,900 are crucial resistances to watch. A rise to ₹1,670 or ₹1,900 is possible in the short term. But a sustained break above ₹1,900 is needed to strengthen the bullish case for a rally to ₹2,500. Failure to breach ₹1,670 or ₹1,900 can keep the stock in a wide range of ₹1,250-₹1,670 (narrow) or ₹1,250-₹1,900 (wide) for some time. The region around ₹1,200 is a crucial support. The stock will come under pressure for a fall to ₹950 if it breaks below this support. It is better to stay out of this stock now. Instead, you can consider Castrol India explained in the previous query. Follow the same strategy.



I bought shares of Agarwal Industrial Corporation at ₹430. What is the outlook?

Mamitha, Kochi

Agarwal Industrial Corporation (₹374): The trend is down and strong since January 2025. After a corrective rise from ₹360 (March) to ₹609 (June), the stock has started to fall again. This leg of fall looks strong. So, the stock remains vulnerable to break the immediate support at ₹350. Such a break can drag the share price down to ₹185 in the coming months. To avoid this fall, the stock has to sustain above ₹350 and rise above ₹520 decisively. Only then a rise to ₹700 will come into the picture. But such a strong rise looks unlikely at the moment. So, it is better to exit the stock. Accept the loss rather than waiting with a hope to get a bounce.



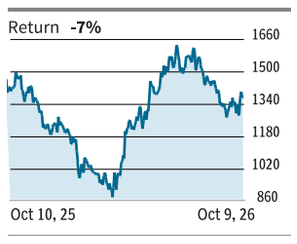
Send your queries to **techtrail@thehindu.co.in**

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Deepak Fertilisers & Petrochemicals (₹1,391.10)

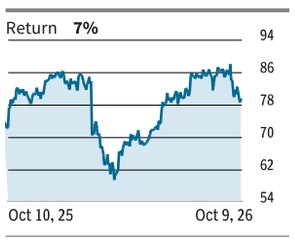
Forms a base



The trend has been down for the stock of Deepak Fertilisers & Petrochemicals in the last three months. But in the last couple of weeks, the downtrend lost momentum and the chart shows that a base has been formed at ₹1,280. Also, there has been an uptick recently on the back of this and the price is now above a hurdle at ₹1,380. In the coming weeks, we expect the stock to rally and hit ₹1,650 in the medium-term. Therefore, traders can buy now at ₹1,391 and accumulate at ₹1,350. Place stop-loss at ₹1,240. When the stock rallies to ₹1,510 and ₹1,600, tighten the stop-loss to ₹1,400 and ₹1,550 respectively. Book profits at ₹1,650.

IDFC First Bank (₹79.31)

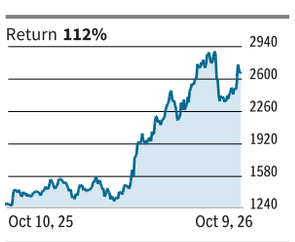
Crucial base ahead



The stock of IDFC First Bank has seen a sharp decline in price over the last month. The fall occurred on the back of the barrier at ₹87. But currently hovering around ₹79, there is a support ahead at ₹78, where the 50-week moving average coincides. Subsequent support is at ₹75. Thus, the price region between ₹75 and ₹78 is a support band. We expect the stock to restart the rally anywhere within these two levels. Once the uptrend resumes, the scrip can rise to ₹95. Buy now at ₹79 and accumulate at ₹76. Place stop-loss at ₹69. When the price goes up to ₹87 and ₹92, alter the stop-loss to ₹82 and ₹89 respectively. Exit the positions at ₹95.

R R Kabel (₹2,705.30)

Signs of recovery



Since April, the stock of R R Kabel has been in an uptrend. However, after hitting a record high of ₹2,980 in August, the price started to drop. While it slipped to a low of ₹2,340.50 last month, there has been a recovery of late. Now trading at ₹2,705, the price action of the stock hints at a fresh leg of rally. This can lift the stock above the prior peak of ₹2,980 to potentially touch ₹3,150 over the medium-term. Consider buying now at ₹2,705 and accumulate at ₹2,500. Keep initial stop-loss at ₹2,300. When the price hits ₹2,900, raise the stop-loss to ₹2,700. Tighten the stop-loss to ₹2,930 when the stock moves up to ₹3,050. Book profits at ₹3,150.

Bourses hold gains

US MARKET OUTLOOK. The benchmark indices have more room to rise

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite indices ended the week on a positive note. The Dow Jones snapped its five-week fall and recovered last week. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index were up for the fourth consecutive week. On the charts, the Dow Jones remains weak while the S&P 500 and NASDAQ Composite have the potential to go further higher from here.



GETTY IMAGES

DOW JONES (51,660.18)

The downtrend that has been in place since August is still intact. The bounce last week is just a correction within that. If the index gets a follow-through rise from here, then 52,200 and 52,500 can be seen in a week or two. However, a rise beyond 52,500 is less likely.

The chances are high for the index to reverse lower anywhere from the 52,200-52,500 resistance zone. That leg of fall can drag the Dow Jones down to 50,000-49,500 in the coming weeks.

A strong break above 52,500 is needed to avoid this fall and go higher towards 54,000. But that would need some strong positive trigger.

S&P 500 (7,811.54)

The strong bounce from the low of 7,731.26 indicates the presence of good buyers at lower levels.

Immediate support is at 7,785. Below that, 7,750-7,730 is the next key support zone. The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index breaks below 7,730. If that happens, a fall to 7,700-7,670 can be seen. But such a fall looks less likely now.

The broader bias remains positive. The S&P 500 can rise to 8,100-8,200. After this rise, there are good chances to see a corrective fall to 7,800.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (27,366.17)

The index made a high of 27,722.75 and has come down from there. Immediate resistance is at 27,500. Failure to breach it can drag the NASDAQ Composite index down to 26,900 or 26,700 in the short term.

A sustained rise above 27,500 is needed to strengthen the case for the rise to 28,300-28,500. From a big picture, this 28,300-28,500 region is a strong resistance zone which can halt the upmove.

We expect the NASDAQ Composite index to reverse lower from this resistance zone and fall back to 27,000 and even lower.

So, we reiterate that more caution is needed as the index goes above 28,000.

MORE RISE

The dollar index can rise to 103.50 on a break above 102.55

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (102.25) remained higher but stable last week. The index oscillated between 101.75 and 102.55 all through the week. The outlook remains bullish. A strong break above 102.55 can take the dollar index higher to 103.50 in the coming weeks.

In case the index breaks below 101.75, then a corrective fall to 101.30-101 can be seen first. Thereafter, a fresh leg of rise can begin and target 103.50 on the upside.

The dollar index will now have to decline below 101 to turn the outlook negative. Only then the downside will open up for a fall to 100 and lower. But that looks less likely and there is a strong support in the 101.30-101 region.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (5.24 per cent) seems to be struggling to get a sustained rise above 5.35 per cent.

However, the outlook remains bullish. The upside remains open to see 5.6 per cent.

Also, from a long-term perspective, the US 10Yr Treasury Yield has the potential to target 6 per cent.

The question is whether the above-mentioned rise can happen from here itself or after a corrective fall. Immediate support is at 5.2 per cent. A break below it can take it down to 5.15 per cent.

Failure to rise back from around 5.15 per cent can drag the yield down to 5 per cent. However, a fall beyond 5 per cent is unlikely.

As long as the US 10Yr Treasury Yield remains above 5 per cent, the broader bullish view will remain intact.

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

BANDU'S PICKS

1. **Physicswallah**
2. **RR Kabel**
3. **Cyient**
4. **Axis Bank**
5. **Gabriel India**

Last week's prize winner
Rajesh Bheda

Last week's winning stock
Cyient

Closing price (Oct 01)
₹1,105.50

Closing pric (Oct 09)
₹1,158.65

Return:
4.81 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to **bandublockbuster@gmail.com** with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Scan to know the winner selection process

CHENNAI
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - OCTOBER 11 - 2026

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were up 0.8 and 0.4 per cent respectively last week. BSE FMCG gained the most by 2.4 per cent, followed by BSE Teck 1.8 per cent and BSE Bankex 1.3 per cent. BSE Realty and BSE Metal declined by 4.2 per cent each last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Teck
P/E	19.3	19.2	32.4	13.3	49.0	56.5	31.8	42.8	18.5	16.0	10.7	29.8	10.7	36.7	19.3
P/BV	2.8	3.9	6.6	2.2	14.3	15.7	7.1	7.6	5.7	3.0	1.4	4.6	2.1	5.0	7.8
Dividend Yield	1.5	1.1	1.1	0.7	0.5	0.6	1.0	0.5	2.1	0.6	2.5	1.2	2.1	0.5	1.8
Weekly Return (%)	0.4 ▲	0.8 ▲	-2.2 ▼	1.3 ▲	-1.1 ▼	-1.1 ▼	2.4 ▲	-2.1 ▼	0.8 ▲	-4.2 ▼	-1.9 ▼	-2.2 ▼	-0.7 ▼	-4.2 ▼	1.8 ▲
Monthly Return (%)	-3.9 ▼	-3.1 ▼	-9.8 ▼	-2.5 ▼	-6.7 ▼	-8.4 ▼	-1.2 ▼	-5.2 ▼	-1.4 ▼	-10.6 ▼	-6.2 ▼	-7.6 ▼	-6.2 ▼	-7.9 ▼	-1.2 ▼
Annual Return (%)	-10.6 ▼	-11.8 ▼	-7.1 ▼	-1.7 ▼	5.9 ▲	-3.4 ▼	-15.3 ▼	10.3 ▲	-21.7 ▼	10.8 ▲	-11.8 ▼	3.5 ▲	-3.8 ▼	-8.3 ▼	-15.9 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Takeaways from Take 500

Wondering how to choose stocks for your portfolio from the dozens which are listed? Or how to keep track of the ones you own? Well, the listings on this page help you sift through the leading companies on their fundamentals and keep an eagle eye on their financial performance. Here's a short guide to interpreting the numbers:

CMP (Current Market Price) is the closing price of a stock on BSE on its last traded day, usually Friday.

EPS (Earnings per Share) is the net profit that the company has earned in the latest financial period, on each outstanding share. Here, we capture each company's total EPS for the last available trailing 12 months.

PE (Price Earnings Ratio) is the single most important number to gauge if a stock is expensive or cheap enough to buy. It divides the company's current market price by its EPS.

PB (Price to Book value) measures a company's stock price relative to its book value or net worth. PB is the appropriate value measure for banks and asset-heavy companies.

Sales (Qty) and Profit (Qty) capture the growth in a company's net sales and net profits for the latest reporting quarter, over the previous year, in percentage terms. We've adjusted the numbers for one-off and exceptional items.

Sales (TTM) and Profit (TTM) make the same comparisons for the trailing twelve months.

Wkly Rtn (Weekly Return) gives the change in the price of a stock in the last one week.

ROCE (Return on Capital Employed) tells you what returns a business is generating on the capital it uses.

DER (Debt Equity Ratio), which divides a company's total loans by shareholder funds, indicates how indebted a company is.

ROCE and **DER** give you the latest available year-end numbers for the company.

Yearly High and Low tell you the range that the company's stock has spanned in the last one year.

Face value other than ₹10 per share is mentioned in brackets next to the company name. As far as possible, consolidated numbers (latest available) have been used for a holistic picture of the company's finances.

Given that the top 500 listed companies are usually the most liquid and well-run, we've restricted the list to the S&P BSE 500 index constituents.

Note: Very large percentage changes in sales and profit are reflective of a change from near-zero or negative value.

Source: Capitaline database

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr.High	Yr.Low
360 ONE [1]	1039.9	30.9	33.6	4.6	202606	34.5	16.1	36.8	19.5	-0.5	12.1	1.6	1235.7	906.2
3M India	30263.1	391.4	77.3	19.3	202606	19.0	-0.4	15.7	-11.2	-1.6	47.3	0.1	38300.0	28747.3
A														
A B B [2]	6776.3	72.7	93.2	15.4	202606	21.0	8.0	10.0	-13.0	-1.1	9.8	0.1	7923.4	4640.5
A B Lifestyle	72.4	1.7	41.4	6.3	202606	11.1	20.6	9.1	31.5	-2.7	12.5	2.2	144.0	71.2
A B Real Estate	1020.9	-29.2		3.1	202606	30.4	-255.2	-55.2	-267.7	-7.3	-4.1	1.4	1914.0	1004.9
Aadhar Hsg. Fin.	443.6	26.3	16.9	2.6	202606	17.1	19.0	17.7	21.5	-1.1	11.3	2.5	563.0	425.1
Aarti Industries [5]	460.3	14.4	32.0	2.8	202606	42.5	256.5	27.0	122.2	-1.0	6.9	0.8	551.5	338.2
AAVAS Financiers	1194.3	61.9	19.3	2.5	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	0.1	9.9	3.2	1775.0	1050.3
Abbott India	25999.9	759.9	34.2	11.6	202606	4.3	17.1	6.3	11.2	-3.1	43.8	0.0	30598.0	25140.5
ACC	1133.5	101.2	11.2	1.0	202606	-4.6	-56.3	11.5	-18.6	-4.2	11.2	0.0	1986.9	1125.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	418.7	8.4	49.7	3.8	202606	67.8	64.8	47.5	45.4	-3.2	8.1	3.2	476.4	195.7
Action Const.Eq. [2]	1175.3	36.7	32.0	6.9	202606	20.5	22.3	5.2	3.3	-3.0	31.6	0.0	1267.1	746.1
Acutaas Chemical [5]	3160.1	47.2	67.0	15.7	202606	59.1	67.7	40.9	104.3	-1.1	32.2	0.0	3735.0	1381.5
Adani Energy Sol	1265.0	23.9	53.0	5.4	202606	42.4	124.2	20.9	21.8	-4.6	9.5	1.9	1789.0	804.7
Adani Enterp. [1]	2633.1	19.0	138.5	3.8	202606	49.9	14.9	18.1	-28.8	-6.8	5.6	1.5	3245.0	1753.5
Adani Green	1255.0	11.9	105.0	10.7	202606	15.6	16.6	7.2	1.0	-2.6	8.0	5.7	1631.4	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1760.0	57.7	30.5	4.2	202606	18.6	9.2	23.8	16.8	1.3	13.8	0.7	1891.8	1293.1
Adani Power [2]	189.0	7.4	25.6	5.9	202606	34.0	42.0	6.6	14.9	-4.0	16.6	0.8	254.2	128.4
Adani Total Gas [1]	563.5	5.7	98.0	12.7	202606	27.2	-14.2	19.8	-2.4	-3.4	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	1004.4	34.9	28.8	7.2	202606	3.5	11.7	6.6	3.9	1.2	32.2	0.0	1224.4	708.0
Aditya Bir. Fas.	43.7	-6.1		0.9	202606	10.6	-201.5	11.4	-1.4	-1.9	0.0	0.9	86.2	43.1
Aditya Birla Cap	379.2	14.7	25.8	2.7	202606	28.2	40.1	16.3	18.2	1.0	8.8	4.9	430.6	288.0
Aditya Infotech [1]	4186.1	38.9	107.5	15.2	202606	89.5	332.5	51.8	214.8	10.2	28.1	0.3	4264.1	1301.1
Aegis Logistics [1]	1388.1	35.6	38.9	8.1	202606	37.1	268.9	30.4	88.7	-0.9	16.1	0.8	1528.0	576.0
Aegis Vopak Term	286.0	2.4	117.0	9.3	202606	12.4	-7.0	26.1	42.9	-1.8	8.7	1.9	321.4	158.8
Aether Industri.	1747.7	18.1	96.7	9.4	202606	27.2	28.0	34.4	30.4	4.5	11.6	0.1	1813.0	723.2
Afcons Infrastr.	241.9	5.6	43.4	1.6	202606	-20.8	-77.7	-11.9	-61.5	-0.3	10.5	0.6	479.1	225.6
Affle 3i [2]	1417.5	33.9	41.8	5.4	202606	20.4	21.7	19.8	19.2	-2.2	16.7	0.0	1992.5	1251.9
AIA Engineering [2]	3735.7	136.0	27.5	4.3	202606	12.4	-1.3	5.5	14.7	-2.3	21.1	0.0	5175.0	3180.1
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3411.0	90.8	37.6	9.4	202606	24.8	30.9	20.2	22.0	-4.8	31.8	0.0	3797.0	2380.9
Alkem Lab [2]	5265.3	190.6	27.6	4.6	202606	10.9	-20.5	13.4	0.2	0.5	19.7	0.1	5933.0	5052.1
Allied Blenders [2]	712.1	8.0	89.3	12.0	202606	6.1	-13.0	8.0	-7.1	4.8	18.3	0.6	753.6	382.7
Alok Industries [1]	9.0	-1.5		-0.2	202606	6.5	-178.8	3.9	18.6	27.6	0.0	0.0	18.5	6.9
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	721.1	39.9	18.1	1.6	202606	23.9	15.9	12.7	-6.9	-3.6	11.7	0.0	1022.5	671.5
Amber Enterp.	6449.3	56.1	115.0	5.2	202606	12.7	-3.4	14.6	-28.1	-0.8	10.6	0.7	8970.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cements [2]	350.0	19.2	18.2	1.5	202606	-7.7	-29.1	7.1	5.7	-3.6	6.7	0.0	588.6	341.4
Anand Rathi Wea. [5]	2042.0	27.4	74.6	34.0	202609	15.7	-10.4	20.7	32.5	-3.0	59.8	0.1	2267.0	1354.0
Anant Raj [2]	570.4	16.1	35.5	3.6	202606	6.6	18.9	17.0	25.7	-1.5	12.0	0.1	713.0	403.0
Angel One [1]	292.0	11.3	25.9	4.4	202606	25.4	102.1	9.1	3.8	5.8	14.8	1.0	360.2	208.9
Anthem Bioscienc [2]	861.4	10.5	81.8	16.0	202606	-22.6	-11.7	-2.1	17.6	0.9	29.3	0.0	977.0	579.5
Apar Inds.	17979.5	287.9	62.5	9.5	202606	29.2	77.8	24.0	36.7	1.9	31.1	0.2	19269.2	6800.0
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	2105.1	44.3	47.6	11.0	202606	8.7	10.9	10.6	53.4	-0.7	30.6	0.1	2300.9	1691.1
Apollo Hospitals [5]	8020.0	146.3	54.8	12.2	202606	20.6	34.2	17.2	33.7	-1.2	18.1	0.7	9326.8	6680.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	400.1	33.6	11.9	1.5	202606	12.8	0.1	11.2	72.5	-1.3	13.4	0.3	540.3	365.4
Aptus Value Hou. [2]	216.0	19.7	11.0	2.1	202606	15.4	19.0	21.1	23.3	-4.7	15.4	1.6	322.5	193.5
Asahi India Glas [1]	946.1	17.5	54.0	6.1	202606	14.2	165.4	9.3	37.0	0.2	11.2	0.7	1073.0	775.1
Ashok Leyland [1]	145.5	6.4	22.9	6.0	202606	11.7	0.8	16.4	17.1	-3.6	13.8	4.3	215.4	134.2
Asian Paints [1]	2345.0	50.9	46.1	10.5	202606	17.9	40.0	9.9	26.7	-2.5	25.9	0.2	2985.5	2116.0
Aster DM Quality	700.0	4.5	157.2	14.5	202606	21.6	-17.0	15.7	8.6	-1.2	11.8	0.6	891.0	519.8
Astral [1]	1406.1	22.1	63.8	9.3	202606	15.9	48.2	16.8	22.3	5.0	19.4	0.1	1768.0	1311.9
Ather Energy [1]	1431.3	-9.7		13.9	202606	88.8	-128.5	67.2	52.4	1.9	0.0	0.4	1741.9	582.4
Atul	5876.9	270.2	21.8	2.8	202606	25.0	92.0	15.8	59.1	0.4	14.9	0.0	7198.2	5563.0
AU Small Finance	980.0	38.0	25.8	3.7	202606	21.1	37.0	17.3	30.8	-1.1	0.0	0.0	1144.7	755.0
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1686.1	65.7	25.7	2.6	202606	16.9	28.1	9.4	11.5	0.7	12.4	0.2	1740.0	1075.1
Authum Invest [1]	549.6	24.7	22.2	3.2	202606	20.9	17.8	-34.6	-48.7	1.9	13.6	0.2	683.5	400.0
Avenue Super.	3520.0	46.9	75.1	9.4	202606	14.9	11.3	15.6	13.0	-7.6	17.2	0.1	4642.0	3499.9
AWL Agri Busine. [1]	182.1	9.0	20.1	2.3	202606	17.5	48.2	16.7	2.3	3.6	17.1	0.2	282.9	171.2
Axis Bank [2]	1259.0	89.2	14.1	1.8	202606	9.9	22.2	5.6	-0.3	3.7	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1150.5
B														
B H E L [2]	432.8	7.0	62.0	5.8	202606	40.3	-17.3	27.0	739.4	2.6	5.6	0.3	455.9	229.7
B P C L	287.4	35.7	8.0	1.2	202606	34.4	-154.5	12.3	-11.7	-4.5	24.9	0.6	391.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto	9787.0	428.9	22.8	6.9	202606	65.0	45.9	36.3	55.2	-2.8	28.4	0.4	12470.0	8606.0
Bajaj Finance [1]	958.2	32.9	29.1	5.2	202606	19.6	27.4	18.8	17.6	0.9	10.9	3.8	1177.6	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1737.3	64.9	26.7	3.6	202606	19.4	12.3	15.1	9.3	0.4	11.8	5.2	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings	10800.0	795.8	13.6	1.6	202606	21.5	32.2	30.2	27.3	2.5	12.6	0.0	13245.0	8597.5
Bajaj Housing	81.5	3.2	25.1	3.0	202606	17.1	22.6	16.3	19.4	-1.7	8.8	4.4	112.4	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2010.4	72.7	27.7	3.6	202606	25.2	56.4	9.8	-3.3	-3.4	10.9	0.4	2775.0	1971.5
Balrampur Chini [1]	678.7	17.5	38.7	3.1	202606	6.1	-14.4	15.0	-11.3	4.6	9.3	0.7	781.0	393.4
Bandhan Bank	157.4	8.4	18.7	1.0	202606	2.8	34.9	-0.2	-34.1	-10.2	0.0	0.0	220.7	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	236.0	42.9	5.5	0.7	202606	6.8	68.2	4.9	14.1	1.8	0.0	0.0	325.6	223.9
Bank of India	134.5	25.9	5.2	0.7	202606	8.8	49.8	6.2	19.4	4.1	0.0	0.0	178.5	122.2
Bank of Maha	83.0	9.8	8.5	1.9	202606	13.9	34.5	15.8	31.0	3.3	0.0	0.0	94.5	54.7
Bata India [5]	613.0	13.5	45.3	4.9	202606	3.9	15.9	1.9	-20.7	0.0	12.0	0.9	1233.0	600.7
Bayer Crop Sci.	3495.5	162.9	21.5	5.3	202606	-4.2	15.4	-2.8	23.6	-1.7	28.0	0.0	5133.0	3366.1
Belrise Industri [5]	234.3	5.3	44.4	3.3	202606	12.6	8.9	11.6	29.1	-1.4	14.4	0.6	268.0	142.8
BEML Ltd [5]	1893.9	21.4	88.4	5.4	202606	29.3	-142.1	12.8	-40.3	-3.4	5.7	0.1	2276.8	1361.1
Berger Paints [1]	471.8	10.5	44.8	8.0	202606	12.0	18.2	5.2	5.1	4.3	21.3	0.1	594.2	391.5
Bharat Electron [1]	368.5	8.4	43.8	11.2	202606	24.9	8.7	19.8	11.7	-3.9	34.8	0.0	473.3	360.8
Bharat Forge [2]	1815.0	20.7	87.7	7.7	202606	18.7	-57.6	17.5	-1.3	-2.7	11.7	0.7	2293.0	1183.0
Bharti Airtel [5]	1806.6	51.0	35.4	6.4	202606	18.4	41.6	19.6	9.7	3.8	19.3	1.6	2174.7	1726.1
Bharti Hexacom [5]	1528.3	37.0	41.3	10.7	202606	10.9	23.2	7.9	28.6	10.7	20.5	1.0	1955.0	1359.9
Bikaji Foods [1]	472.0	10.4	45.2	7.4	202606	13.1	0.4	14.6	29.2	-6.4	20.1	0.2	768.3	464.5
Billionbrains [2]	192.4	3.9	49.5	12.5	202606	66.0	94.3	37.7	30.8	6.7	37.2	0.1	227.0	112.0
Biocon [5]	348.5	4.5	77.8	1.7	202606	9.8	287.2	10.1	103.2	-6.0	3.8	0.6	447.0	338.0
Birlasoft Ltd [2]	285.0	21.3	13.4	1.9	202606	7.4	51.3	1.3	26.1	5.7	20.0	0.0	473.8	267.1
BLS Internat. [1]	216.5	17.1	12.6	3.6	202606	25.3	11.2	31.8	24.9	0.2	33.8	0.2	349.2	212.2
Blue Dart Expres	4566.2	136.6	33.4	6.1	202606	15.0	81.2	9.2	30.8	1.4	15.0	0.6	7030.2	4460.1
Blue Star [2]	1572.6	25.7	61.1	9.4	202606	13.3	-21.0	5.9	-0.9	6.6	19.6	0.2	2032.0	1432.0
Bosch	43490.0	801.2	54.3	8.6	202606	22.0	5.2	13.6	6.5	-4.6	21.0	0.0	49629.5	28650.1
Brainbees Solut. [2]	169.3	-2.0		1.8	202606	13.1	-141.4	11.7	24.2	-3.2	0.0	0.3	379.3	161.6
Brigade Enterpr.	548.7	20.8	26.3	2.6	202606	-12.9	16.1	4.8	-9.6	-3.6	10.7	1.0	801.6	461.3
Britannia Inds. [1]	4821.0	108.1	44.6	22.7	202606	9.5	13.6	7.5	18.7	0.5	55.3	0.3	6269.9	4736.0
C														
C P C L	1487.9	280.3	5.3	2.0	202606	84.8	2471.9	33.5	2379.9	10.5	34.1	0.3	1677.0	714.9
C.E. Info System [2]	871.7	25.1	34.7	5.3	202606	14.9	7.9	1.8	-12.5	3.1	18.9	0.0	2000.0	795.3
Cams Services [2]	671.8	19.9	33.7	12.6	202606	11.5	17.4	7.7	5.1	-0.5	46.0	0.1	844.8	611.7
Can Fin Homes [2]	717.7	86.6	8.3	1.6	202609	7.7	9.2	7.9	25.1	1.2	9.1	6.7	970.0	702.0
Canara Bank [2]	119.5	21.9	5.5	0.9	202606	4.5	3.0	3.1	7.3	0.8	0.0	0.0	162.9	116.6
Caplin Point Lab [2]	2459.6	87.5	28.1	5.6	202606	19.6	15.8	15.0	17.7	-6.6	24.8	0.0	2990.6	1502.5
Capri Global [1]	241.9	11.7	20.6	3.2	202606	61.5	102.0	51.6	95.2	-3.1	11.7	3.5	287.5	151.2
Carborundum Uni. [1]	1202.6	15.9	75.4	5.9	202606	16.9	23.4	10.2	2.9	-3.0	10.7	0.1	1369.1	734.7
Castrol India [5]	194.7	10.9	17.9	10.1	202606	25.0	42.5	11.8	12.8	-2.2	58.8	0.0	207.0	170.2
CCL Products [2]	1051.2	32.4	32.4	6.0	202606	13.7	61.3	35.8	38.9	-0.3	15.8	0.7	1241.9	815.6
CEAT	3260.5	157.4	20.7	2.6	202606	22.4	-96.7	21.5	38.5	-0.8	17.7	0.6	4431.6	3061.3
Cello World [5]	365.3	14.1	25.9	3.6	202606	-0.4	0.5	7.2	-3.3	13.1	17.1	0.0	673.0	314.0
Cemindia Project [1]	1126.4	35.0	32.2	8.1	202606	5.6	2.6	8.9	46.8	-4.3	32.5	0.5	1650.0	481.4
Central Bank	30.1	5.0	6.0	0.7	202606	12.8	8.0	9.4	8.3	0.3	0.0	0.0	40.9	29.4
Cera Sanitary. [5]	4998.0	191.6	26.1	4.8	202506	5.4	-1.1	5.2	7.0	-2.0	22.0	0.0	6730.0	4463.0
CESC [1]	133.2	11.7	11.4	1.4	202606	5.4	3.9	8.7	12.8	1.3	10.2	1.6	204.4	128.4
CG Power & Ind [2]	856.6	8.1	106.0	16.9	202606	14.0	16.3	21.4	26.9	-2.3	27.0	0.0	981.2	525.5
Chalet Hotels	822.0	24.4	33.6	4.9	202606	-42.7	-54.4	6.0	87.8	-1.0	16.6	0.7	988.9	690.0
Chambal Fert.	374.2	48.1	7.8	1.4	202606	-11.8	-4.6	15.6	10.2	-6.3	25.4	0.1	510.7	371.5
Choice Intl.	713.2	10.2	69.7	9.8	202606	32.0	22.8	26.5	32.5	-0.9	19.1	0.6	860.0	568.6
Chola Financial [1]	1400.0	142.1	9.9	1.7	202606	19.5	39.3	17.5	21.1	2.1	10.5	13.8	2061.5	1305.0
Cholaman.Inv.&Fn [2]	1584.4	67.3	23.5	4.4	202606	21.9	45.6	19.6	29.1	0.1	9.7	7.1	1952.0	1299.8
CIE Automotive	371.0	23.6	15.7	1.8	202606	10.6	15.5	12.5	14.5	-1.6	14.4	0.1	525.9	367.4
Cipla [2]	1303.3	44.3	29.4	3.1	202606	3.5	-39.2	2.2	-33.6	-3.2	15.7	0.0	1672.2	1165.6
City Union Bank [1]	231.6	14.2	16.4	2.2	202606	23.6	25.1	19.8	20.4	0.8	0.0	0.0	248.8	157.5
Clean Science [1]	796.0	21.9	36.3	5.3	202606	10.5	4.7	-0.3	-13.3	-1.0	20.7	0.0	1096.9	652.8
Coal India	410.9	50.6	8.1	2.1	202606	7.8	0.6	10.1	-6.0	-2.5	20.8	0.1	490.9	369.6
Cochin Shipyard [5]	1233.2	25.9	47.7	5.5	202606	2.4	-19.4	-1.4	-19.1	-4.3	16.1	0.2	1864.5	1186.6
Coforge [2]	1868.0	43.7	42.7	3.1	202606	49.2	99.6	35.7	100.2	2.3	21.9	0.1	2022.0	1008.5
Cohance Life [1]	440.6	2.8	156.6	4.3	202606	-23.1	-144.2	-19.8	-77.5	-2.4	5.0	0.1	917.5	267.9
Colgate-Palmoliv [1]	1820.1	50.3	36.2	31.3	202606	12.0	7.8	3.7	-1.8	4.9	104.1	0.0	2329.9	1716.0
Concord Biotech [1]	1362.9	26.6	51.3	7.1	202606	26.2	32.8	-6.7	-22.0	-0.9	18.0	0.0	1621.3	987.1
Container Corpn. [5]	441.5	16.3	27.1	2.6	202606	0.3	0.1	1.7	-6.2	-0.9	12.6	0.1	557.8	421.8
Coromandel Inter [1]	1702.5	63.3	26.9	4.0	202606	15.9	-24.6	23.5	-6.0	-3.5	22.7	0.1	2496.1	1652.0
Craftsman Auto [5]	10178.0	179.1	56.8	5.1	202606	36.3	99.2	37.9	102.8	-0.7	13.9	1.0	11990.0	6251.7
CreditAcc. Gram.	1266.2	75.4	16.8	2.6	202606	21.9	719.7	11.9	524.3	2.2	10.0	3.0	1634.4	1112.9
CRISIL [1]	4431.8	120.9	36.6	9.9	202606	27.6	26.2	22.0	21.5	0.1	35.6	0.1	5060.0	3689.0
Crompton Gr. Con [2]	205.0	7.1	29.0	4.5	202606	11.8	14.9	7.9	-13.7	1.4	19.5	0.1	310.7	201.1
Cummins India [2]	4825.2	88.0	54.8	15.8	202606	18.1	2.5	15.4	14.4	-0.7	37.3	0.0	6142.8	3883.3
Cyient [5]	1158.7	36.9	31.4	2.3	202606	21.3	-32.3	3.2	-34.4	4.8	12.8	0.1	1226.3	751.0
D														
Dabur India [1]	386.1	11.2	34.5	6.0	202606	10.6	15.0	7.4	11.4	2.4	20.9	0.1	533.8	368.1
Dalmia BharatLtd [2]	1598.0	58.8	27.2	1.7	202606	7.0	-14.5	7.6	19.5	-4.9	7.8	0.4	2320.0	1586.0
Data Pattern [2]	4085.7	48.3	84.6	13.2	202606	16.8	-13.5	33.8	26.0	-3.8	22.7	0.0	5000.0	2131.0
DCM Shriram [2]	955.6	87.8	10.9	1.9	202606	9.2	445.3	11.1	121.9	5.7	11.2	0.4	1408.8	887.0
Deepak Fertilis.	1391.1	78.0	17.8	2.6	202606	22.5	101.5	13.6	0.3	6.9	11.7	0.8	1681.3	865.5
Deepak Nitrite [2]	1620.7	58.1	27.9	3.8	202606	36.4	207.5	7.1	30.5	8.5	11.3	0.3	1895.0	1280.4
Delhivery [1]	401.0	1.6	251.9	3.1	202606	27.8	-65.0	23.1	-40.0	0.1	0.6	0.2	524.3	374.4
Devyani Intl. [1]	123.8	-0.1		9.9	202606	16.5	277.6	14.7	43.9	-2.5	0.0	2.6	169.7	91.6
Divi's Lab. [2]	9326.0	112.2	83.1	14.8	202606	27.8	65.5	16.3	29.2	0.3	21.0	0.0	10000.0	5648.0
Dixon Technolog. [2]	12755.0	306.9	41.6	16.7	202606	21.1	194.9	14.3	128.5	0.4	32.1	0.2	17495.0	9605.1
DLF [2]	646.5	17.4	37.2	3.5	202606	-52.9	4.1	-27.7	1.6	-2.4	6.6	0.1	786.4	489.3
DOMS Industries	2060.3	35.8	57.5	10.3	202606	19.2	-22.3	19.9	4.6	-1.8	25.4	0.2	2704.0	2006.9
Dr Lal Pathlabs	1932.6	33.5	57.7	12.9	202

The missing Ctrl + F in your financial life

LEGACY VAULT. From policies to property papers, put your family's financial information in one place

Shriram Shivakumar



GETTY IMAGES

When life changes suddenly, families have enough to deal with. Searching for an insurance policy, investment statement or property document should not add to the uncertainty.

There is something we take for granted when working with information on a computer. If we cannot find a file, we press Ctrl + F, type a few words and usually find what we are looking for. However, there is no Ctrl + F for physical life.

If an insurance policy is somewhere in a cupboard, property papers are in a locker, an investment statement is sitting in an old e-mail account or an important contact number exists only in someone's phone, finding it can take considerably more effort.

One person often becomes the keeper of the family's financial information. The rest of the family may know broadly what the family owns. It is an entirely natural arrangement. But there is an interesting risk hidden inside it.

CONCENTRATION RISK

We routinely talk about concentration risk in investments. We know that depending too heavily on one company, asset class or sector can make a portfolio vulnerable.

What about concentration of financial knowledge?

A family can have a diversified portfolio and still have a single point of dependence when it comes to finding and understanding its financial information.

This matters not only between spouses but also across generations.

Children grow up in families where financial decisions are being made around them. As they become adults, they increasingly interact with banking, digital payments, investment platforms, insurance and other financial products themselves.

At some point, knowing what the family has and how its financial affairs are organised becomes part of their financial education.

What matters in such critical times is having enough shared awareness to navigate the family's financial affairs.

ORGANISE INFORMATION

One practical way of doing this is to organise the information itself. This is where FIDOK, the Family Financial Information and Documents Organiser Kit, comes in handy. At its simplest, it can be thought of as a Ctrl + F for the family's financial life.

FIDOK brings together the information that families typically have scattered across files, e-mails, folders, bank accounts and physical locations.

It begins with the family – capturing details of family members, dependants and important contacts. It then moves to identity and other essential documents, including document numbers, who holds them and where the physical and digital copies are stored. The location is recorded in enough detail to actually find the document — whether it is on the second shelf of the almirah in the office room or in a particular file in a cupboard.

The location of the digital copy is recorded too, whether it is in DigiLocker, Google Drive or another designated location.

Document expiry dates and renewal requirements are recorded as well.

For families that use lockers, relevant locker information is recorded along with details that help locate important documents. Information about important online accounts is recorded too, reflecting the increasingly digital nature of a family's financial life.

The financial information covers life insurance, health insurance and other insurance policies. Bank accounts, debit and credit cards are listed along with investment accounts covering mutual funds, fixed deposits, PPF, EPF, demat accounts and other investments.

The details go beyond simply listing the account or policy. For bank accounts, the relationship manager's details are recorded. The contact details of the family's financial adviser are recorded as well. For estate planning and property matters, the advocate's details are included.

Property is another important component. Details of properties are recorded along with information about where the related property papers are kept.

Do not store your ATM PINs or online passwords in FIDOK. It would be prudent to note down PINs and passwords in separate documents, and mention where they're stored in FIDOK.

The completed FIDOK is maintained as a physical printout and kept in a safe place in your house. Since it brings together a significant amount of personal and financial information, it needs to be treated with the same care as the documents it helps locate. It is preferable not to use online apps to store FIDOK. If you choose to do so, ensure that the service offers encrypted storage and multi-factor authentication.

Importantly, family members should know where FIDOK is kept and have access to it — otherwise, it defeats the purpose.

The idea is not to create another financial statement. It is to bring together the information a family already has but may otherwise have to search for across several places.

Once everything is in one place, you know what the family has, where it is kept and whom to contact when something needs attention. When important information is accessible to the people who need it, there is less uncertainty and less dependence on one person's memory. Sometimes, that knowledge itself can be a form of financial security. In today's day and age, FIDOK could be of significant help especially to those families, where children are settled abroad or live in different locations in India.

We have Ctrl + F on our computers because information is useful only when we can find it. Perhaps families need their own version of it. Knowing where you stand — and where to find what you need — can be a form of financial security in itself.

FINANCIAL FINDER

- Reduce dependence on one person's knowledge
- Record locations of key financial documents
- Keep passwords and PINs stored separately

The author is a Qualified Personal Finance Professional (QPFP®)

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5	Sep 14
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.7	6.25	May 18
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	6.5	6.75	6.25	6	Aug 10
Indian Bank	6.2	6.65	6.6	6.05	Aug 04
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	May 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.35	6.35	Jun 01
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.85	6.1	5.95	Jun 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.6	6.55	6.1	6	Aug 04
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.5	6.5	6.5	Sep 30
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7.45	7.45	7.25	Jun 20
CSB Bank	6	7.1	7	5.75	Sep 05
City Union Bank	6.25	7.25	6.5	6.25	Jun 16
DCB Bank	6.5	7.5	7.5	7.5	Aug 04
Dhanlaxmi Bank	7	7.1	6.5	7.25	Sep 02
Federal Bank	6	6.65	6.5	6.7	Sep 29
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Aug 19
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Oct 09
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.55	Sep 21
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.1	7.1	6.75	Sep 01
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	7	6.65	Jul 24
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.05	6.75	Oct 08
Karnataka Bank	5.75	7	6.15	6.15	Jun 08
Kotak Bank	6	6.65	6.65	6.4	Sep 23
Karur Vysya Bank	7	7.2	6.55	6.55	Jun 08
RBL Bank	6.05	7	7	7	Oct 01
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.6	6.8	6.2	Jun 19
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.35	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	6.75	Jun 02
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	7.1	7.75	8	Jun 16
ESAF Small Finance Bank	6	7.75	8	6	Aug 17
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.3	8	7.77	Sep 29
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.8	8.1	8.25	Sep 24
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.55	7.25	7.8	Sep 01
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.5	6.5	6.5	Sep 30
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 01

*Data as on respective banks' website on October 09, 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by bankbazaar.com;

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%) Jul 1 - Sep 30, 2026	Interest rate (%) Oct 1 - Dec 31, 2026	Compounding frequency
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5#	7.5#	Annually
Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on September 30, 2026
#Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, GoI

SIMPLYPUT.

Contagion risk

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Two avid investors meet for the weekly exchange of views and news affecting markets. The conversation explores contagion risk and what it means for investment prospects.

Rahul: Hey, thanks for the meet-up. I wanted to ask about this word contagion risk that is being thrown around now.

Abhijit: The markets seem to rediscover an older phenomenon once every few years — contagion risk, but this time from yield spikes. The last time this word was bandied about — around 2008 — the whole world was given a "crash" course in global financial systems. Similar to last time, the US caught the cold and Europe has started sneezing. Let us start with France's yield spike.

France, in its Budget announcement, projected a debt to GDP ratio of 119 per cent. The seemingly-unsustainable debt increase drove higher yields, as investors seek compensation for higher risk. This is on top of high inflation from energy prices, which had earlier caused inflation-led yield rise. Finally, the political situation is also not helping; student-riots in France, snap elections in Spain, shifting alliances in Germany and the never-ending Ukraine war.

Rahul: Didn't US yields spike first?

Abhijit: Yes, but Europe following suit is the quintessential 'contagion' part of the risk. The US reasons are roughly the same — high inflation, high government borrowings, but with AI-related debt-raising as a cherry on top. US yields are now eyeing escape velocity at 5.3 per cent for US 10-year bonds. From France, the yield spike has spread to Italy, Spain and Greece.

Rahul: Will the contagion stop at this level?

Abhijit: If the yields persist at the higher range, all other asset classes will come under strain, including the US or Indian equities. Borrowing costs and existing EMIs will rise limiting growth and demand respectively.

With the safest of assets yielding upwards of 5 per cent, the return expectations from other assets will rise — which implies a market sell-off — one which we are experiencing right now.

So essentially, from the US to France to Europe to India equities, the contagion risk seems to be taking shape.

Rahul: Seems like we have seen this movie before in 2008. How do they compare?

Abhijit: Broadly yes, 2008 crisis started in the US followed by spiked Euro bonds. But details matter. The start of the 2008 crisis is well-known, US sub-prime lending ran into housing market crash, which caused widespread defaults and credit crisis was born.

A credit crisis was more or less finally managed with the government's backing in both the US and Europe.

But Greece, it turns out, was hiding something bigger. On joining the Euro block in 2001, Greece suddenly found access to 'never-before' cheap interest loans. And it splurged like one would expect it to — including the 2004 Athens Olympics. Euro laws dictates a 3 per cent Budget deficit limit, which was 'managed' through creative accounting.

Credit crisis reached European mainland at this point in 2008. Investors, looking closely at sovereign debt instruments in times of credit freeze, found significant risks in Greece. Greece's newly-elected government in 2009 said that the Budget deficit was 13 per cent and not 6 per cent. Greece's bonds crashed, and then gradually followed by every other European bond with high debt and low growth: Portugal, Ireland, Italy and Spain (PIIGS).

Rahul: What is the contagion part if weak economies are exposed rightly?

Abhijit: The contagion part is when bonds are held by each other, Greek bonds held by commercial banks of France, Germany, Portugal and others which increases the systematic risk.

The credit freeze pushes otherwise healthy entities — countries, companies or small business to harder times which impacts the real economy.

The austerity measures enacted across countries can create a drag on the economies of the countries.

But the real contagion risk stems from the speculative part. Traders get an easy fix — wake up, short a European bond, book profits.

Rahul: Agreed, real economy is easier to deal with than speculative narrative feeding on itself. How did they turn it around?

Abhijit: By 2012, expectations of Euro Block collapse had gained real strength with speculators shorting weaker European economies. But at a routine press conference in June 2012 that turned out to be historical in global markets, Mario Draghi, the then ECB president, said the words "will do whatever it takes" to preserve the Euro.

ECB followed it up with a bond-buying fund – Outright Monetary Transaction fund. With the Central bank as the counterparty to the shorts and a mandate backed by deep pockets to stem the slide, speculative shorting came to a grinding halt.

Interestingly, with not much assistance from the actual fund apparently.

Rahul: Indeed, speculative narratives are fun like that. They come from a shred of truth that gets magnified.

Health insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male, non-smoker, sum insured of ₹10 lakh living in a metro city

Insurer	Plan name	Key features	Premium (₹)
ICICI Lombard	Elevate	OPD rider with no sub-limits. Single pvt AC Room. ₹2 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,182
Care	Care Supreme	Guaranteed 7x increase over 5 years with rider. No Room Rent Limit. ₹15 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover.	11,370
Niva Bupa Health	Health ReAssure	Unlimited claims up to the cover amount. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	14, 290
Star Health	Super Star	Fully loaded plan with one-time unlimited claim. Unlimited bonus. Lock the age till 50. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB.	8,614
Aditya Birla Health	Activ One Max	100% issuance offer guarantee. No Room Rent Limit. ₹10 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover	10,152
Tata AIG	Medicare Select	Special discount for young families and salaried customers. Single pvt AC Room. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	8,304
Bajaj General	My Health Care	The sum insured increases by 25% for every claim-free year up to 100%.	8,545

Date: October 09, 2026. Source: www.policybazaar.com. NCB: No Claim Bonus

Term insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male/female, non smoker, living in a metro city, Sum assured ₹1 crore with coverage up to 70 yrs

Insurance company	Plan name	Max coverage up to (years)	Max policy term (years)	Annual premium Male	Annual premium Female	Claim settlement ratio (%)
Aditya Birla Capital	Super Term Plan Plus	85	55	10,814	9,191	98.86
Bajaj Life	eTouch II	85	55	10,875	8,964	99.33
Canara HSBC Life	Promise 2 Secure	99	69	10,658	8,903	99.52
HDFC Life	Click 2 Protect Super	85	55	11,690	9,937	99.72
ICICI Prudential	iProtect Smart	99	69	11,461	9,741	99.34
Axis Max Life	Smart Term Plan Plus	85	55	11,025	9,371	99.78
SBI Life	Smart Shield Plus	79	49	13,206	11,109	98.34
TATA AIA Life	Sampoorna Raksha Promise	100	70	11,082	9,405	99.45
Bandhan Life	iTerm Elite	85	55	12,118	10,337	99.73

Claim settlement ratio as per data provided by insurer
Source: www.policybazaar.com, Date: October 09, 2026

ALERTS.

New health policies offer unlimited coverage



ManipalCigna Health Insurance has launched 'ManipalCigna INFINIX'. Focussed on customers in Tier 1 and Tier 2 markets, INFINIX offers unlimited sum insured, along with city-level pricing and the flexibility to personalise coverage based on individual healthcare needs and financial priorities. ManipalCigna INFINIX is available in two variants. INFINIX NOW is aimed at people with an existing health cover and looking to upgrade unlimited health coverage starting from Day 1. INFINIX CORE is ideal for first-time buyers seeking unlimited health coverage at a value price with flexibility to reduce applicable waiting periods. Both variants offer a choice of Rs 10 lakh or unlimited sum insured and are available with policy tenures of one, two or three years.

the hindu businessline. Classifieds

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, DEEP Kumar Jain, father and natural guardian of minor Dyuti Jain, (Dyuti)residing at Silver Spring, Tower 10, 3C, 5 JBS Haldane Avenue, Kolkata 700105, declare that she shall henceforth be known as Shivaanshi Jain, vide Affidavit No. 2343 dated 30.09.2026.

BUSINESS OFFER

BUSINESS

CORRUGATED BOXES supply ranging 3–ply to 9 as per your requirement & 3m adhesives tape supply 1/2, 3/4 1, 2 inches. Ct: 9655269274

MATRIMONIAL

BRIDES WANTED

PHYSICALLY CHALLENGED

WARMLY INVITING responses from a never–married lady (32–42 years) to join me (a 43–year–old man) and my 10–year–old son in building a supportive home together. Caste and religion are entirely open. I will do my best to be a supportive partner, and I warmly welcome alliances from individuals with physical disabilities, including those with partial visual impairment (must be mentally sound). Must be open to embracing a life with a child and relocating to Hyderabad. Language is no barrier, though a basic understanding of English or Hindi may help in everyday communication. If this resonates with you, please share your details and a photograph at: WA/7661056809

To advertise visit
www.thehinduads.com
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

CHENNAI
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - OCTOBER 11 - 2026



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	Trailing Returns (%) 3 Year CAGR	Trailing Returns (%) 5 Year CAGR	Trailing Returns (%) 10 Year CAGR	Sortino Ratio (%)
	EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Large Cap	101.8	76352	1.1	0.7	-8.7	9.1	9.2	12.2	0.29
★★★★★	Invesco India Largecap	68.3	1925	1.8	0.7	-3.1	11.5	8.6	11.5	0.25
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Large Cap	84.4	51296	1.2	0.6	-8.2	9.0	10.5	12.5	0.34
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	209.2	2465	1.7	0.7	-4.6	9.2	7.9	11.4	0.23
★★★★	Canara Robeco Large Cap	58.0	15963	1.4	0.5	-8.4	7.9	6.4	11.7	0.17
★★★★	JM Large Cap	144.5	356	2.1	0.8	-6.5	7.8	7.8	9.9	0.22
★★★★	SBI Large Cap	88.4	52373	1.2	0.7	-4.8	7.5	7.2	10.5	0.20
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	489.5	27933	1.4	0.8	-7.6	7.9	7.1	10.3	0.19
★★★	Bandhan Large Cap	74.1	2180	1.8	0.8	-4.8	10.6	7.9	11.2	0.22
★★★	DSP Large Cap	430.7	6642	1.6	0.8	-9.2	9.1	7.4	9.3	0.19
★★★	Edelweiss Large Cap	79.2	1366	1.8	0.6	-6.1	7.7	7.2	11.1	0.19
★★★	Franklin Ind Large Cap	956.4	6906	1.6	1.0	-7.3	8.0	6.0	9.4	0.15
★★★	HDFC Large Cap	1058.5	37294	1.3	0.9	-7.4	7.2	8.5	11.0	0.26
★★★	HSBC Large Cap	458.4	1755	1.8	1.0	-4.0	8.8	7.1	10.6	0.18
★★★	Kotak Large Cap	531.4	10514	1.5	0.6	-8.0	8.0	6.6	10.9	0.18
★★★	Mahi Manu Large Cap	20.8	647	2.1	0.7	-9.5	6.0	5.5	-	0.13
★★★	Tata Large Cap	473.3	2553	1.7	0.8	-6.9	8.0	7.0	10.2	0.20
★★	Groww Largecap	40.4	137	2.1	1.2	-6.7	7.8	6.4	9.2	0.16
★★	Mirae Asset Large Cap	105.4	38166	1.3	0.5	-7.4	6.6	5.4	10.9	0.13
★★	Union Largecap	21.8	408	2.1	1.3	-8.2	5.8	5.0	-	0.11
★★	UTI Large Cap	251.0	11436	1.5	0.9	-9.1	5.5	4.8	9.9	0.10
★	Axis Large Cap	56.8	29231	1.4	0.6	-6.9	6.8	3.6	10.7	0.05
★	LIC MF Large Cap	51.0	1302	1.9	0.9	-9.0	6.1	4.0	8.8	0.07
★	PGIM India Large Cap	314.2	502	2.1	0.8	-8.6	5.2	4.1	8.7	0.07
-	Taurus Large Cap	166.3	62	2.1	1.9	5.8	13.1	9.7	9.8	0.26
	EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	134.6	21020	1.4	0.5	-0.9	15.3	13.8	14.0	0.44
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	957.1	31628	1.3	0.7	-6.4	12.3	12.1	13.5	0.44
★★★★★	Quant Large & Mid Cap	118.6	3384	1.7	0.6	5.0	12.9	12.6	14.1	0.36
★★★★	Axis Large & Mid Cap	33.6	16438	1.4	0.5	1.7	13.0	9.3	-	0.26
★★★★	HDFC Large & Mid Cap	327.5	28543	1.4	0.8	-4.8	10.7	11.5	13.5	0.37
★★★★	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	104.5	12178	1.5	0.5	2.3	20.0	14.3	15.2	0.41
★★★★	UTI Large & Mid Cap	173.4	6220	1.6	0.8	-3.3	12.4	11.5	12.5	0.37
★★★	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	88.4	506	2.1	0.9	0.5	11.3	9.2	11.3	0.27
★★★	DSP Large & Mid Cap	579.5	17284	1.4	0.5	-6.4	11.1	9.4	12.5	0.28
★★★	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	85.3	4615	1.6	0.4	-1.8	11.6	9.8	13.2	0.30
★★★	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	28.8	5784	1.6	0.7	4.2	15.5	11.8	-	0.30
★★★	Kotak Large & Mid Cap	329.6	30581	1.4	0.5	-4.9	10.8	10.8	13.2	0.32
★★★	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	147.0	45811	1.3	0.5	-3.5	9.6	7.9	14.2	0.23
★★★	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1413.7	7411	1.5	0.9	-4.9	12.9	10.7	11.7	0.33
★★★	SBI Large & Midcap	607.1	40499	1.3	0.6	-2.7	10.8	10.7	12.9	0.35
★★	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	241.8	24578	1.4	0.5	-6.1	10.2	7.7	12.9	0.23
★★	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	178.5	3337	1.7	1.1	-6.9	9.3	7.3	10.2	0.22
★★	LIC MF Large & Midcap	36.9	2949	1.7	0.6	-4.4	10.9	8.1	12.0	0.24
★★	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	88.1	7131	1.5	0.7	2.0	12.2	9.6	13.3	0.27
★	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	898.7	5603	1.6	1.0	-0.5	9.3	5.0	9.6	0.12
★	Navi Large & Midcap	34.7	292	2.1	0.5	-1.5	7.2	7.2	10.8	0.20
★	Tata Large & Mid Cap	464.2	7254	1.5	0.6	-10.1	4.6	6.9	10.7	0.19
	EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	HDFC Flexi Cap	1953.3	108547	1.1	0.6	-4.1	13.9	14.4	14.3	0.51
★★★★★	JM Flexi Cap	95.7	5036	1.6	0.6	-2.7	12.0	12.5	14.2	0.38
★★★★★	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	81.0	145070	1.1	0.5	-5.1	11.7	9.9	15.7	0.34
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1868.6	27982	1.4	0.7	3.4	13.3	9.5	12.0	0.27
★★★★	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	36.8	3509	1.6	0.5	-4.5	11.8	9.6	12.9	0.28
★★★★	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1502.9	18188	1.4	0.8	-8.0	8.8	9.1	11.8	0.27
★★★★	HSBC Flexi Cap	226.4	5749	1.6	0.9	2.3	14.3	11.0	11.9	0.30
★★★	Axis Flexi Cap	27.1	13242	1.5	0.6	0.4	11.7	6.5	-	0.16
★★★	Bandhan Flexi Cap	201.2	7508	1.5	1.0	-4.3	9.2	7.8	9.8	0.21
★★★	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	323.9	12782	1.5	0.5	-6.1	9.3	7.0	12.4	0.19
★★★	DSP Flexi Cap	97.6	11720	1.5	0.6	-5.3	8.7	7.3	12.0	0.19
★★★	Kotak Flexi Cap	80.1	53087	1.2	0.5	-6.6	9.3	8.3	11.5	0.23
★★★	Navi Flexi Cap	24.2	286	2.1	0.5	5.6	9.4	8.3	-	0.24
★★★	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.2	5595	1.6	0.5	-4.3	8.4	5.3	12.2	0.14
★★★	Union Flexi Cap	50.5	2320	1.7	0.8	-2.3	9.3	7.8	11.8	0.22
★★	LIC MF Flexi Cap	99.2	1038	1.9	1.0	-2.2	8.8	7.8	9.5	0.22
★★	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	61.8	13446	1.4	0.7	-0.9	16.9	11.2	11.6	0.30
★★	SBI Flexicap	103.9	22109	1.4	0.7	-5.8	6.9	6.1	10.4	0.16
★★	Tata Flexi Cap	22.2	3454	1.6	0.6	-9.6	7.3	6.0	-	0.16
★	Shriram Flexi Cap	18.6	122	2.1	0.8	-7.6	4.6	4.4	-	0.08
★	Taurus Flexi Cap	238.6	385	2.1	2.0	6.3	11.4	9.4	9.4	0.27
★	UTI Flexi Cap	311.4	22495	1.4	0.9	-5.1	6.8	2.9	10.9	0.04
-	Quant Flexi Cap	101.8	7309	1.5	0.6	5.0	13.0	11.3	17.2	0.33
	EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS									
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	280.8	3297	1.7	0.8	-1.6	12.4	9.7	12.7	0.28
-	ICICI Pru Multi Cap	800.5	18717	1.4	0.8	1.0	13.1	12.1	12.9	0.41
-	Invesco India Multicap	126.1	4301	1.6	0.6	-3.3	10.6	9.4	12.1	0.25
-	ITI Multi Cap	25.5	1500	1.8	0.5	8.3	14.6	11.3	-	0.31
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	37.6	7457	1.5	0.5	6.8	14.8	12.4	-	0.36
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	285.0	53767	1.2	0.6	-5.4	11.3	13.8	14.1	0.45
-	Quant Multi Cap	636.7	7501	1.5	0.6	2.9	8.5	9.0	16.1	0.24
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	370.7	2901	1.7	0.8	-4.1	10.4	9.2	12.7	0.28
	EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Edelweiss Mid Cap	102.9	19230	1.4	0.4	1.3	18.2	14.8	16.4	0.44
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4288.8	50176	1.2	0.6	2.5	16.3	15.1	16.6	0.46
★★★★★	Quant Mid Cap	210.4	7654	1.5	0.7	0.3	9.2	12.3	16.4	0.36
★★★★	HDFC Mid Cap	198.1	101856	1.1	0.6	0.9	15.1	16.1	15.6	0.53
★★★★	Invesco India Midcap	187.5	15749	1.4	0.5	2.9	20.7	16.3	16.9	0.46
★★★★	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	33.7	5058	1.6	0.5	2.0	14.4	13.6	-	0.41
★★★★	Motilal Oswal Midcap	99.4	40208	1.3	0.7	-4.1	17.1	17.9	15.3	0.49
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	104.6	2503	1.7	0.5	2.8	13.7	11.9	13.8	0.36
★★★	HSBC Midcap	451.0	16800	1.4	0.5	12.4	21.3	15.7	15.6	0.42
★★★	ICICI Pru Mid Cap	319.7	7961	1.5	0.9	6.4	18.6	14.1	14.8	0.45
★★★	Kotak Mid Cap	137.0	66613	1.2	0.4	-1.6	14.9	13.4	15.6	0.41
★★★	PGIM India Midcap	62.9	10537	1.5	0.5	-4.0	9.4	7.6	13.6	0.22
★★★	SBI Midcap	228.9	23282	1.4	0.7	0.2	8.7	10.9	12.3	0.34
★★★	Sundaram Mid Cap	1390.2	13854	1.5	0.8	-0.9	15.4	13.9	12.7	0.42
★★★	Tata Mid Cap	431.3	5860	1.6	0.6	-0.2	12.0	11.7	14.2	0.37
★★	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	806.6	6550	1.6	0.9	3.0	13.1	11.2	11.9	0.33
★★	Axis Midcap	116.9	33528	1.3	0.5	2.4	14.5	10.5	15.6	0.31
★★	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2647.7	12156	1.5	0.8	-3.0	13.2	10.7	12.6	0.31
★★	UTI Mid Cap	297.1	11920	1.5	0.9	-1.4	9.8	9.3	12.1	0.26
★	DSP Midcap	145.2	19488	1.4	0.7	-2.0	11.7	8.7	12.3	0.26
★	LIC MF Midcap	29.4	369	2.1	1.2	1.4	13.6	9.9	-	0.28
★	Taurus Mid Cap	126.5	138	2.1	1.7	3.5	9.4	10.4	13.5	0.29
	EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	58.5	3671	1.6	0.4	26.4	20.0	17.2	-	0.43
★★★★★	Quant Small Cap	284.4	35572	1.3	0.6	10.7	16.4	16.8	19.5	0.42
★★★★	Edelweiss Small Cap	45.8	7000	1.5	0.4	5.2	13.1	13.4	-	0.39
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	46.3	16131	1.4	0.4	10.3	19.9	16.8	-	0.45
★★★★	Nippon Ind Small Cap	178.9	80906	1.1	0.5	6.5	13.7	16.2	19.1	0.45
★★★★	Union Small Cap	58.7	2732	1.7	0.8	18.9	15.5	14.9	15.9	0.39
★★★	AXIS Small Cap	113.1	30678	1.4	0.5	7.0	13.6	13.1	17.4	0.41
★★★	Canara Robeco Small Cap	39.3	13972	1.5	0.5	1.5	10.2	11.6	-	0.33
★★★	DSP Small Cap	223.0	21467	1.4	0.7	15.8	15.7	15.1	15.5	0.43
★★★	HSBC Small Cap	88.3	18513	1.4	0.6	10.4	13.0	14.5	16.7	0.37
★★★	Kotak Small Cap	265.3	19141	1.4	0.5	3.0	10.6	9.9	15.1	0.28
★★★	LIC MF Small Cap	34.2	841	2.0	0.8	12.1	16.0	14.9	-	0.39
★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	286.4	4107	1.6	0.7	10.1	14.2	13.4	13.5	0.38
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	170.4	14257	1.5	0.8	1.9	10.5	12.9	13.3	0.35
★★	HDFC Small Cap	134.5	40801	1.3	0.6	-4.8	8.8	12.0	15.7	0.34
★★	ICICI Pru Small Cap	89.1	9791	1.5	0.7	2.0	9.9	11.5	14.5	0.37
★★	Tata Small Cap	38.5	13214	1.5	0.4	-2.6	9.8	12.6	-	0.34
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	97.1	6120	1.6	0.8	15.1	13.8	11.1	11.8	0.30
★	SBI Small Cap	177.0	41059	1.3	0.6	4.0	10.0	11.3	16.4	0.35
	EQUITY - FOCUSED FUNDS									
★★★★★	HDFC Focused	223.2	26553	1.4	0.6	-5.1	13.5	14.7	12.9	0.53
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Focused	89.9	17168	1.4	0.6	-4.0	14.8	12.4	13.5	0.39
★★★★	360 ONE Focused	47.6	6800	1.5	0.8	1.4	10.2	9.3	13.9	0.25
★★★★	Quant Focused	88.7	825	2.0	0.7	4.2	11.5	10.5	13.0	0.29
★★★★	SBI Focused	385.2	50180	1.2	0.6	7.3	13.6	9.6	13.7	0.30
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Focused	139.0	7512	1.5	0.8	-1.6	10.7	8.2	11.2	0.24
★★★	Bandhan Focused	87.0	2094	1.8	0.7	-0.3	13.2	9.8	11.9	0.29
★★★	DSP Focused	52.5	2503	1.7	0.9	-3.5	10.8	8.7	10.2	0.24
★★★	Franklin Ind Focused Equity	94.2	10410	1.5	0.8	-13.7	5.8	7.3	11.3	0.20
★★★	Nippon Ind Focused	116.3	8075	1.5	1.0	-4.0	7.8	8.0	11.4	0.24
★★★	Sundaram Focused	157.8	1032	1.9	1.1	-1.5	8.3	7.2	11.8	0.20
★★	JM Focused	19.1	274	2.1	0.7	-5.8	9.3	9.3	10.3	0.27
★★	Mirae Asset Focused	24.3	6752	1.6	0.6	-6.4	6.1	3.9	-	0.08
★★	Motilal Oswal Focused	53.5	1845	1.8	0.8	23.0	13.8	9.4	11.7	0.22
★	Axis Focused	52.9	10476	1.5	0.8	-4.8	7.7	1.7	10.0	0.00
★	Baroda BNP Paribas Focused	19.8	520	2.1	0.5	-9.0	5.8	5.6	-	0.13
-	LIC MF Focused	21.1	171	2.1	1.1	-2.2	7.7	6.1	-	0.17
	EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS									
★★★★★	HSBC Value	108.3	14660	1.5	0.6	-1.7	13.5	12.9	13.9	0.40
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Value	435.4	57250	1.2	0.8	-8.4	10.3	11.8	13.2	0.45
★★★★	Bandhan Value	141.8	9981	1.5	0.6	-4.3	8.7	10.2	13.5	0.31
★★★★	Nippon Ind Value	209.2	8479	1.5	0.9	-8.3	11.5	10.8	13.5	0.33
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Value	130.9	6659	1.6	0.9	5.8	12.2	11.6	10.5	0.32
★★★	JM Value	92.7	780	2.0	1.0	-4.2	9.8	12.2	13.5	0.35
★★★	LIC MF Value	27.8	336	2.1	0.9	16.2	15.3	11.3	-	0.32
★★★	Templeton India Value	648.7	1807	1.8	0.8	-8.8	7.2	10.1	11.5	0.32
★★★	Union Value	27.1	378	2.1	1.1	-4.1	9.7	9.7	-	0.30
★★	HDFC Value	756.6	8039	1.5	0.9	1.7	13.9	11.5	12.6	0.36
★★	Tata Value	337.2	8239	1.5	0.7	-4.1	11.3	10.9	12.4	0.34
★	Quantum Value	111.9	1048	1.8	0.9	-10.8	7.7	7.6	9.3	0.22
★	UTI Value	155.8	9025	1.5	1.1	-8.2	10.2	8.9	11.8	0.27
-	Groww Value	26.1	74	2.1	0.9	-3.5	9.9	8.6	8.7	0.25
-	Sundaram Value	199.3	1217	1.9	1.4	-9.3	5.0	5.9	8.8	0.16
	EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS									
★★★★★	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	55.0	4890	1.6	0.6	5.0	19.1	15.2	15.1	0.36
★★★★★	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	392.3	13103	1.5	0.7	6.4	13.1	12.5	18.0	0.34
★★★★★	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	405.0	30027	1.4	0.8	-7.3	11.9	12.5	12.6	0.40
★★★★	Bandhan ELSS - Tax Saver	148.2	6965	1.6	0.6	-3.3	7.9	8.6	13.3	0.26
★★★★	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	158.7	1366	1.8	0.8	0.0	10.5	8.7	14.2	0.23
★★★★	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	130.5	15569	1.5	0.7	-6.4	11.1	9.5	12.9	0.28
★★★★	HDFC ELSS - Tax Saver	1296.4	14949	1.5	1.0	-9.6	11.1	11.7	11.8	0.40
★★★★	JM ELSS - Tax Saver	50.3	240	2.1	0.9	1.7	14.0	11.3	14.2	0.34
★★★★	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	47.1	26428	1.4	0.6	-4.9	9.9	8.1	14.3	0.24
★★★	Baroda BNPP ELSS Tax Saver	94.2	857	2.0	0.9	-1.3	12.5	8.9	11.5	0.25
★★★	Canara Robeco ELSS - Tax Saver	168.9	8167	1.5	0.6	-4.4	9.3	7.5	13.0	0.21
★★★	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	109.1	428	2.1	0.7	-1.8	10.7	8.6	10.8	0.25
★★★	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1343.2	5839	1.6	0.9	-8.9	8.5	9.0	11.0	0.27
★★★	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	135.7	3974	1.6	1.0	-0.5	14.3	10.8	12.1	0.30
★★★	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	882.5	13498	1.5	1.0	-6.8	9.3	7.7	11.2	0.23
★★★	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	111.7	6071	1.6	0.6	-3.9	8.9	9.3	12.3	0.26
★★★	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	125.0	14096	1.5	0.9	-2.9	10.8	9.8	9.4	0.29
★★★	Tata ELSS - Tax Saver	44.3	4427	1.6	0.7	-0.4	10.3	9.5	12.1	0.29
★★★	Union ELSS Tax Saver	62.6	821	2.0	1.2	-5.0	8.5	8.0	11.5	0.23
★★	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	121.0	2598	1.7	0.8	-4.8	10.0	7.3	11.8	0.20
★★	Mahi Manu ELSS Tax Saver	25.8	829	2.0	0.7	-9.8	5.5	6.2	-	0.16
★★	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	33.1	680	2.1	0.8	-5.1	6.9	7.2	11.1	0.20
★★	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	111.2	196	1.8	0.8	-10.7	7.6	7.6	9.4	0.23
★★	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	466.3	1212	1.9	1.4	-8.9	6.6	7.0	10.9	0.20
★★	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	188.9	3253	1.7	1.0	-8.4	6.1	5.2	10.2	0.11
★	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	57.8	13559	1.5	0.9	-5.6	8.9	6.0	9.0	0.15
★	Axis ELSS - Tax Saver	92.3	30269	1.4	0.7	-4.8	8.4	3.7	10.6	0.05
★	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	141.4	972	1.9	0.9	-7.1	7.6	6.5	10.4	0.18
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	17.9	52	2.1	0.8	-10.7	6.3	5.5	-	0.13
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	19.5	44	2.1	0.7	-7.0	4.7	4.0	-	0.07
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	178.5	71	2.1	1.6	-3.7	9.6	9.0	11.6	0.28
	EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS									
-	Invesco India Contra	127.7	19248	1.4	0.5	-6.2	11.9	10.4	13.5	0.31
-	Kotak Contra	144.4	5196	1.6	0.6	-5.5	12.4	11.1	14.0	0.35
-	SBI Contra	355.8	45068	1.3	0.6	-7.0	8.9	12.3	13.8	0.44
	EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS									
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Consumption	180.1	2255	1.7	0.6	-10.7	7.0	9.3	11.0	0.27
★★★★★	Tata India Consumer	45.7	2723	1.7	0.6	0.9	12.1	10.9	14.6	0.30
★★★★	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	88.3	4742	1.6	0.4	-7.8	8.2	9.6	13.6	0.26
★★★★	SBI Consumption Opport	265.1	2642	1.7	0.8	-13.9	3.2	8.6	12.0	0.25
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	195.9	5697	1.6	0.7	-10.5	6.6	7.0	11.6	0.18
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas India Cons	28.7	1354	1.8	0.6	-10.4	7.1	7.4	-	0.19
★★★	Canara Robeco Consumption	102.1	1872	1.8	0.7	-7.8	8.3	8.6	13.2	0.23
★★★	ICICI Pru Bharat Consumption	23.5	3049	1.7	1.0	-8.8	7.4	9.8	-	0.32
★★	Mahi Manu Consumption	20.7	453	2.1	0.7	-10.0	7.0	8.4	-	0.23
★★	UTI India Consumer	53.8	678	2.0	1.4	-9.1	7.5	6.3	9.8	0.15
★	Sundaram Consumption	88.8	1408	1.8	1.1	-10.3	6.3	8.4	9.8	0.24
	EQUITY - THEMATIC - INFRASTRUCTURE FUNDS									
★★★★★	BOI AXA Manufacturing & Infra	65.0	984	1.9	0.6	13.0	19.6	18.1	17.4	0.52
★★★★★	Quant Infrastructure	39.3	3076	1.7	0.7	3.1	15.2	14.7	18.4	0.38
★★★★	DSP India T.I.G.E.R.	341.2	6265	1.6	0.7	8.8	17.8	18.5	16.0	0.53
★★★★	ICICI Pru Infrastructure	189.2	8227	1.5	1.0	-3.8	15.0	18.1	16.2	0.64
★★★★	Invesco India Infrastructure	64.2	1489	1.8	0.8	0.7	16.1	15.8	16.5	0.43
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Infrastructure	104.3	1220	1.9	1.1	9.9	15.1	15.4	13.6	0.42
★★★	Bandhan Infrastructure	46.4	1433	1.8	0.8	-6.7	12.8	14.1	13.9	0.35
★★★	Canara Robeco Infrastructure	156.8	921	1.9	0.9	-3.2	16.0	16.6	14.0	0.49
★★★	Franklin Build India	134.0	3024	1.7	0.8	-5.7	13.3	15.3	14.9	0.46
★★★	Kotak Infra & Economic Reform	67.9	2334	1.7	0.6	3.5	14.2	15.8	14.2	0.42
★★★	LIC MF Infrastructure	52.3	1153	1.9	0.7	4.8	20.6	19.0	15.8	0.51
★★★	Tata Infrastructure	169.3	1982	1.8	1.0	-0.4	10.2	13.7	13.3	0.38
★★	HSBC Infrastructure	49.2	2379	1.7	0.9	5.7	14.1	15.7	14.5	0.41
★★	SBI Infrastructure	47.5	4701	1.6	0.9	-2.1	10.7	13.5	13.8	0.41
★★	Sundaram Infra Advantage	94.5	922	2.0	1.5	-0.6	13.5	13

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Month *Ann	Trailing Returns (%) 3 Month *Ann	Trailing Returns (%) 6 Month *Ann	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	AA & Below
-	360 ONE Liquid	2167.5	529	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.2	6.1	6.2	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Liquid	455.0	61167	0.3	0.2	5.9	6.3	6.4	6.5	-
-	Axis Liquid	3145.5	53470	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.3	6.5	6.5	-
-	Bandhan Liquid	3406.2	16269	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.1	6.3	6.3	-
-	Bank of India Liquid	3254.0	1874	0.1	0.1	5.9	6.3	6.4	6.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3243.5	12914	0.1	0.1	5.9	6.3	6.3	6.4	0.60
-	Canara Robeco Liquid	3397.4	5027	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.3	6.3	6.4	-
-	DSP Liquid	4031.7	24726	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.3	6.4	6.5	0.70
-	Edelweiss Liquid	3612.9	11741	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.3	6.4	6.5	-
-	Groww Liquid	2730.0	301	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.3	6.4	6.4	-
-	HDFC Liquid	5537.5	66295	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.2	6.3	6.4	-
-	HSBC Liquid	2813.9	23038	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.2	6.4	6.4	-
-	ICICI Pru Liquid	417.7	55340	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.2	6.3	6.4	-
-	Invesco India Liquid	3881.0	22395	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.3	6.4	6.5	-
-	ITI Liquid	1465.3	52	0.2	0.1	5.6	5.8	5.9	6.1	-
-	JM Liquid	76.9	1701	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.2	6.3	6.3	1.50
-	Kotak Liquid	5702.9	42047	0.3	0.1	5.7	6.2	6.3	6.4	-
-	LIC MF Liquid	5102.3	12872	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.2	6.3	6.4	-
-	Mahi Manu Liquid	1837.3	1041	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.3	6.4	6.4	-
-	Mirae Asset Liquid	2957.8	14887	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.3	6.3	6.4	-
-	Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.8	1016	0.4	0.2	5.3	5.7	5.8	5.9	-
-	Navi Liquid	30.5	82	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.4	5.6	5.7	-
-	Nippon Ind Liquid	6888.4	40490	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.3	6.4	6.4	-
-	Parag Parikh Liquid	1564.9	5228	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.2	6.3	6.4	-
-	PGIM India Liquid	367.6	1438	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.1	6.4	6.4	-
-	Quant Liquid	44.3	1149	0.5	0.3	5.0	5.7	5.6	5.8	-
-	Quantum Liquid	37.6	543	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.8	5.8	5.8	-
-	SBI Liquid	4409.9	77481	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.2	6.3	6.4	-
-	Sundaram Liquid	2487.9	6727	0.3	0.1	5.6	6.4	6.4	6.4	-
-	Tata Liquid	4445.7	28037	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.2	6.3	6.4	-
-	TRUSTMF Liquid	1370.0	748	0.2	0.1	5.6	6.1	6.2	6.3	-
-	Union Liquid	2716.6	5014	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.2	6.3	6.4	-
-	UTI Liquid	463.3	27453	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.2	6.3	6.4	-
-	WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1516.5	727	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.3	6.3	6.3	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

-	Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1482.4	11387	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	Axis Overnight	1458.7	10855	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	Bandhan Overnight	1463.0	1213	0.1	0.0	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Bank of India Overnight	1403.3	88	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.5	5.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1446.0	657	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	Canara Robeco Overnight	1426.1	623	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	DSP Overnight	1472.6	3194	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Edelweiss Overnight	1425.4	168	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	Franklin Ind Overnight	1438.0	874	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Groww Overnight	1414.6	63	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.8	4.9	5.0	-
-	HDFC Overnight	4055.7	10342	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	HSBC Overnight	1434.8	4805	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	ICICI Pru Overnight	1480.9	12280	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Invesco India Overnight	1392.4	485	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	ITI Overnight	1388.4	12	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.6	4.8	4.9	-
-	JM Overnight	1394.4	83	0.1	0.1	5.0	4.8	4.9	5.0	-
-	Kotak Overnight	1465.4	7935	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
-	LIC MF Overnight	1421.9	1218	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	Mahi Manu Overnight	1421.3	73	0.1	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	Mirae Asset Overnight	1409.6	1527	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Nippon Ind Overnight	147.6	6791	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	PGIM India Overnight	1418.9	96	0.1	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	SBI Overnight	4435.6	25553	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Sundaram Overnight	1458.2	1927	0.1	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	Tata Overnight	1448.1	5556	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
-	Union Overnight	1445.5	657	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	UTI Overnight	3743.6	8999	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.2	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

-	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.6	26933	0.9	0.3	5.9	5.4	5.7	6.0	-
-	Axis Arbitrage	20.1	10168	0.9	0.3	5.2	5.3	5.6	5.9	-
-	Bandhan Arbitrage	34.8	7796	0.9	0.3	5.4	5.2	5.5	5.7	-
-	Bank of India Arbitrage	14.8	111	0.9	0.3	8.2	5.7	5.4	5.7	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.2	1015	1.0	0.3	5.3	4.8	5.3	5.6	-
-	DSP Arbitrage	16.0	6720	0.8	0.3	5.6	5.2	5.5	5.8	-
-	Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.8	14250	0.9	0.3	5.0	5.2	5.7	6.0	-
-	HDFC Arbitrage	33.0	25407	0.8	0.3	6.1	5.4	5.8	6.1	-
-	HSBC Arbitrage	20.4	3633	0.8	0.2	5.6	5.3	5.6	6.0	-
-	ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.9	35576	0.8	0.3	5.7	5.5	5.8	6.1	-
-	Invesco India Arbitrage	34.4	30396	0.9	0.3	6.1	5.6	5.9	6.2	-
-	ITI Arbitrage	13.9	65	0.8	0.2	3.6	4.5	4.6	5.7	-
-	JM Arbitrage	34.9	341	0.9	0.3	5.9	5.1	5.4	5.7	-
-	Kotak Arbitrage	40.3	75275	0.8	0.3	5.2	5.5	5.8	6.1	-
-	LIC MF Arbitrage	14.8	305	0.7	0.2	6.0	5.4	5.8	6.0	-
-	Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.2	138	1.0	0.3	6.2	4.9	5.1	5.4	-
-	Mirae Asset Arbitrage	14.0	3838	0.8	0.1	5.2	5.3	5.7	5.9	-
-	Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.5	17216	0.9	0.3	5.8	5.3	5.7	6.0	-
-	PGIM India Arbitrage	19.7	98	0.9	0.3	6.4	5.0	5.6	5.7	-
-	SBI Arbitrage	36.4	46309	0.8	0.3	5.9	5.4	5.7	6.0	-
-	Sundaram Arbitrage	15.5	539	0.8	0.2	6.4	5.0	5.7	5.9	-
-	Tata Arbitrage	15.4	24539	0.9	0.3	5.5	5.3	5.6	6.0	-
-	Union Arbitrage	15.1	220	0.9	0.3	5.9	5.7	5.8	5.9	-
-	UTI Arbitrage	37.7	10900	0.7	0.3	6.1	5.4	5.8	6.1	-

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TERM FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	Trailing Returns (%) 2 Year CAGR	Trailing Returns (%) 3 Year CAGR	Trailing Returns (%) 5 Year CAGR	AA & Below (%)
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Ultra Short Term	594.1	16279	0.5	0.3	6.3	7.1	7.2	6.6	11.47
★★★★★	Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Term	1670.6	596	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.5	-
★★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short-Term	1417.7	1808	0.6	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.2	6.5	9.27
★★★★	Bandhan Ultra Short Term	16.5	4098	0.4	0.2	6.3	6.8	7.0	6.3	-
★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short Term	1465.8	2733	0.3	0.1	6.4	6.8	7.0	6.3	-
★★★★	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	30.0	15236	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.8	7.0	6.3	8.18
★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Term	4351.9	11551	0.9	0.3	6.2	6.6	6.8	6.2	22.52
★★★	Axis Ultra Short Term	15.9	4996	1.1	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.6	5.9	12.59
★★★	DSP Ultra Short Term	3666.5	4425	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.6	5.9	6.69
★★★	HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.4	15675	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.9	6.2	11.88
★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short Term	2913.0	1394	0.7	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.9	6.1	6.15
★★★	Kotak Ultra Short Term	46.2	15261	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.7	6.1	7.48
★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Term	1486.1	205	0.6	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.9	6.2	2.20
★★★	SBI Ultra Short Term	6457.8	11237	0.5	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.9	6.3	12.25
★★★	Tata Ultra Short Term	15.3	5404	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.5	6.6	5.9	11.99
★★★	UTI Ultra Short Term	4567.9	3017	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.7	6.1	14.54
★★★	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Term	1464.3	549	0.7	0.2	5.9	6.3	6.4	5.8	-
★★	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3403.8	196	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.3	6.4	5.8	4.15
★★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4088.6	529	0.8	0.3	5.9	6.3	6.5	5.8	-
★★	LIC MF Ultra Short Term	1420.7	1420	1.2	0.2	5.8	6.2	6.4	5.8	1.09
★★	PGIM India Ultra Short Term	36.6	232	0.8	0.3	5.6	6.2	6.4	5.8	-
★	ITI Ultra Short Term	1327.0	167	0.8	0.2	5.7	6.1	6.3	5.6	-
★	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.6	534	1.0	0.2	5.3	5.5	5.7	5.1	-
★	Sundaram Ultra Short Term	2869.9	2108	1.3	0.2	5.3	5.8	6.0	5.4	1.47

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TO SHORT TERM FUNDS

★★★★★	ICICI Pru Ultra Short to ST	588.3	18781	0.5	0.4	6.1	7.0	7.3	6.5	6.82
★★★★★	UTI Ultra Short to ST	3833.6	2604	0.4	0.3	6.0	6.9	7.2	6.5	7.33
★★★★	Axis Ultra Short to ST	3339.4	4563	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.8	7.1	6.4	6.72
★★★★	Bandhan Ultra Short to ST	41.5	6342	0.6	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.8	6.1	-
★★★★	HDFC Ultra Short to ST	62.0	16513	0.9	0.4	5.5	6.5	6.8	6.1	12.69
★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short to ST	30.9	847	0.8	0.3	5.8	7.3	7.4	6.4	7.86
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Ultra Short to ST	702.7	9185	1.0	0.4	5.2	6.2	6.5	5.9	8.14
★★★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short to ST	45.5	1113	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.7	6.9	6.2	-
★★★	DSP Ultra Short to ST	21.3	4455	0.5	0.3	5.5	6.5	6.8	6.1	-
★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short to ST	4071.3	1714	0.5	0.3	5.6	6.6	6.9	6.1	6.11
★★★	JM Ultra Short to ST	39.9	236	0.7	0.3	5.6	6.5	6.8	6.1	5.28
★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short to ST	2428.2	2290	0.7	0.2	5.6	6.5	6.8	6.0	7.60
★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short to ST	4030.5	7096	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.8	6.1	4.85
★★★	Tata Ultra Short to ST	4240.6	2727	0.5	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.9	6.2	3.11
★★	Kotak Ultra Short to ST	3585.9	12566	1.0	0.4	5.4	6.4	6.6	5.9	8.36
★★	LIC MF Ultra Short to ST	42.6	1900	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.5	6.7	5.9	5.33
★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short to ST	1755.3	497	0.9	0.3	5.5	6.4	6.6	5.9	16.22
★★	SBI Ultra Short to ST	3748.2	10942	0.8	0.4	5.4	6.4	6.7	6.0	4.91
★	Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short to ST	43.0	330	0.9	0.2	5.5	6.3	6.5	5.8	-
★	Sundaram Ultra Short to ST	3702.7	381	1.0	0.3	5.2	6.1	6.5	5.9	1.66

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

★★★★★	Nippon Ind Money Market	4500.6	19855	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.3	6.7	-
★★★★★	UTI Money Market	3346.8	16039	0.2	0.2	6.5	7.1	7.3	6.7	-
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Money Market	401.4	26943	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.7	-
★★★★	Axis Money Market	1552.8	19012	0.3	0.2	6.5	7.1	7.3	6.6	-
★★★★	Kotak Money Market	4869.8	27513	0.3	0.1	6.4	7.0	7.2	6.6	-
★★★★	Tata Money Market	5121.0	31690	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.3	6.6	-
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1494.0	3393	0.3	0.1	6.3	7.0	7.0	6.3	-
★★★	Franklin Ind Money Market	54.4	3887	0.3	0.1	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.5	-
★★★	HDFC Money Market	6196.9	27624	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.2	6.6	-
★★★	HSBC Money Market	28.6	6382	0.3	0.1	6.3	6.9	7.1	6.3	-
★★★	ICICI Pru Money Market	411.5	31010	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.6	-
★★★	Sundaram Money Market	16.3	1338	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.1	6.4	-
★★	DSP Money Market	57.0	8072	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.8	7.0	6.3	-
★★	Invesco India Money Market	3295.7	5481	0.4	0.1	6.2	6.8	7.0	6.2	-
★★	PGIM India Money Market	1434.2	123	0.3	0.1	6.1	6.7	6.9	6.2	-
★★	SBI Money Market	44.7	27850	0.5	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.8	6.2	-
★	Bandhan Money Market	43.7	13129	0.3	0.1	6.4	7.0	7.0	6.2	-
★	Edelweiss Money Market	30.7	2065	0.6	0.1	6.0	6.5	6.6	5.8	-

DEBT - SHORT TERM FUNDS

★★★★★	ICICI Pru Short Term	64.4	18890	0.9	0.4	4.9	6.6	7.1	6.4	7.04
★★★★★	UTI Short Term	33.7	1770	0.7	0.3	4.3	6.1	6.8	6.0	5.06
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Short Term	50.7	5966	0.8	0.3	4.5	6.3	7.0	6.1	7.06
★★★★	Axis Short Term	33.1	7425	0.8	0.3	4.8	6.7	7.2	6.2	7.14
★★★★	HDFC Short Term	34.2	14219	0.6	0.3	4.7	6.4	7.2	6.2	8.22
★★★★	Sundaram Short Term	47.2	176	0.7	0.2	4.7	6.1	6.9	6.0	2.84
★★★	Bandhan Short Term	61.3	8680	0.7	0.3	5.3	6.6	7.3	6.0	-
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Short Term	31.1	419	0.9	0.4	4.4	6.2	6.8	5.8	21.40
★★★	DSP Short Term	49.3	3416	0.8	0.3	3.9	5.8	6.6	5.6	-
★★★	HSBC Short Term	28.2	3881	0.6	0.3	4.4	6.2	6.9	5.7	-
★★★	Kotak Short Term	55.3	14241	1.0	0.3	4.1	5.9	6.7	5.6	-
★★★	Nippon Ind Short Term	56.3	6364	0.8	0.3	4.5	6.4	7.1	6.0	5.51
★★★	SBI Short Term	34.1	13243	0.7	0.4	4.2	6.2	6.8	5.9	7.66
★★	Canara Robeco Short Term	26.9	276	0.9	0.3	4.3	5.8	6.4	5.4	-
★★	Invesco India Short Term	3771.7	541	0.9	0.3	3.8	5.8	6.7	5.5	4.83
★★	Mirae Asset Short Term	16.6	512	0.9	0.2	3.6	5.7	6.5	5.5	0.97
★★	Tata Short Term	50.5	2912	1.0	0.3	3.9	5.6	6.3	5.4	-
★	Groww Short Term	2214.6	93	0.9	0.3	4.4	6.0	6.5	5.1	-
★	LIC MF Short Term	15.5	122	1.0	0.3	4.2	5.8	6.6	5.3	8.46
-	Bank of India Short Term	28.4	259	1.0	0.5	4.2	6.7	7.1	10.3	-
-	Mahi Manu Short Term	13.6	79	1.1	0.3	4.5	6.0	6.8	5.6	17.64

DEBT - MEDIUM TERM FUNDS

★★★★★	Nippon Ind Medium Term	16.9	146	0.9	0.4	5.1	7.5	7.9	6.2	32.55
★★★★	Axis Medium Term	30.1	1972	1.1	0.6	5.3	6.9	7.7	6.6	50.46
★★★★	ICICI Pru Medium Term	48.6	5331	1.2	0.6	5.7	7.4	7.8	6.6	30.87
★★★	HDFC Medium Term	60.4	3499	1.1	0.6	5.3	6.5	7.2	6.0	38.02
★★★	Kotak Medium Term	24.5	1912	1.4	0.6	4.9	6.7	7.9	6.3	36.26
★★★	SBI Medium Term	54.8	6419	1.0	0.6	5.4	6.5	7.2	6.2	38.74
★★	DSP Medium Term	86.1	249	0.6	0.3	3.3	5.8	6.7	5.7	-
★★	HSBC Medium Term	21.7	670	0.9	0.3	4.0	6.1	7.0	5.8	32.97
★	Bandhan Medium Term	48.6	1244	1.2	0.6	4.8	6.0	7.0	5.3	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Medium Term	43.8	3370	1.3	0.7	7.3	10.1	9.8	11.8	30.11
-	Sundaram Medium Term	71.3	32	1.6	1.0	2.2	4.1	5.1	3.9	3.09
-	UTI Medium Term	19.1	34	1.3	0.8	3.2	5.1	6.1	5.2	20.60

DEBT - MEDIUM TO LONG TERM FUNDS

★★★★★	UTI Medium to Long Term	75.9	303	1.4	1.1	2.6	4.4	6.1	6.6	10.64
★★★★	ICICI Pru Medium to LT	41.9	2019	0.9	0.5	3.0	5.2	6.7	5.7	-
★★★★	SBI Medium to Long Term	73.5	2036	1.3	0.7	2.9	4.6	6.1	5.4	29.83
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Medium to LT	128.7	1734	1.0	0.6	1.7	3.8	5.9	4.9	-
★★★	Kotak Medium to Long Term	79.4	1760	1.4	0.6	2.4	4.1	6.2	4.9	-
★★★	LIC MF Medium to Long Term	75.6	173	0.5	0.2	3.5	5.1	6.6	5.5	-
★★★	Nippon Ind Medium to Long Term	92.5	312	1.3	0.6	2.6	4.0	6.0	5.1	-
★★	Bandhan Medium to Long Term	68.0	428	1.7	0.8	4.6	4.4	6.3	4.6	-
★★	HDFC Medium to Long Term	60.1	813	1.2	0.7	2.6	4.2	6.4	4.8	-
★	Canara Robeco Medium to LT	56.5	111	1.6	0.6	1.4	3.2	5.2	4.1	-
-	HSBC Medium to Long Term	43.5	48	1.1	0.5	2.5	4.1	5.9	4.3	-
-	JM Medium to Long Term	63.9	29	0.9	0.5	1.9	4.4	6.1	4.7	-

DEBT - LONG TERM FUNDS

-	ICICI Pru Long Term	90.8	822	0.8	0.4	0.1	3.3	6.1	4.8	-
-	Nippon Ind Nivesh Lakshya LT	17.9	5839	0.6	0.3	-0.2	2.2	6.0	5.2	-

DEBT - DYNAMIC TERM FUNDS

★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Dynamic Term	49.0	1370	1.0	0.6	4.3	5.7	7.2	6.6	24.52
★★★★★	UTI Dynamic Term	32.4	396	1.1	0.5	3.6	5.0	6.5	6.8	-
★★★★	360 ONE Dynamic Term	24.0	549	0.5	0.3	4.0	6.3	7.8	6.5	4.56
★★★★	ICICI Pru Dynamic Term	38.9	12863	1.1	0.5	3.7	5.8	6.8	6.2	15.38
★★★★	Quantum Dynamic Term	22.1	84	0.8	0.4	1.9	4.2	6.5	5.7	-
★★★	Axis Dynamic Term	31.5	969	0.5	0.3	5.0	6.0	7.2	5.8	-
★★★	HDFC Dynamic Term	92.7	480	1.2	0.6	2.8	4.0	6.1	4.9	-
★★★	HSBC Dynamic Term	30.6	119	0.7	0.2	2.2	4.2	6.2	5.1	-
★★★	Kotak Dynamic Term	39.5	2219	1.1	0.5	4.1	5.1	7.2	5.7	4.26
★★★	Nippon Ind Dynamic Term	39.2	3702	0.6	0.3	3.7	5.5	6.9	5.7	-
★★★	SBI Dynamic Term	37.6	3502	1.2	0.5	4.3	5.0	6.8	6.0	-
★★	Bandhan Dynamic Term	35.9	1910	1.4	0.6	5.8	4.4	7.2	5.3	-
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Dynamic Term	46.4	114	1.4	0.6	0.8	3.1	5.2	4.9	-
★★	DSP Dynamic Term	3405.4	607	1.0	0.5	0.6	2.6	5.6	4.9	-
★	Canara Robeco Dynamic Term	29.4	80	1.4	0.6	0.4	2.0	4.6	4.0	-
★	Mirae Asset Dynamic Term	16.9	114	0.8	0.1	2.7	4.9	5.8	4.7	-
-	Groww Dynamic Term	1498.4	25	1.2	0.4	1.7	3.3	5.0	4.3	-
-	JM Dynamic Term	43.2	52	0.8	0.4	2.5	4.9	6.2	5.5	-
-	Mahi Manu Dynamic Term	14.9	47	1.4	0.4	2.9	4.6	6.3	4.8	10.55
-	PGIM India Dynamic Term	2689.2	78	1.4	0.4	1.2	3.4	5.7	4.7	-
-	Union Dynamic Term	23.3	62	1.3	1.1	-0.3	2.3	4.9	3.9	-

DEBT - CORPORATE BOND FUNDS

★★★★★	ICICI Pru Corporate Bond	31.9	28385	0.5	0.3	4.8	6.5	7.1	6.4	-
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Corporate Bond	63.8	8907	0.6	0.3	4.3	6.3	7.1	6.4	-
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Corporate Bond	119.2	22722	0.4	0.3	3.7	5.8	6.9	6.1	-
★★★★	Axis Corporate Bond	18.2

CHENNAI
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - OCTOBER 11 - 2026

Upgrade plan: Airlines ask Mumbai airport for T 1 structural safety reports

CLEAR PLAN. Airlines body also asked for a detailed redevelopment plan, including its scope and firm timelines

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Airlines have asked Mumbai airport to share structural safety reports of Terminal 1 (T1) ahead of the October 13 meeting to firm up reduction of flights.

The meeting is being held on the intervention of the Civil Aviation Ministry which put on hold reduction of 265 international flights from October 26. On October 1 Mumbai International Airport Ltd (MIAL) proposed reduction of the flights in view of planned redevelopment of T1 due to safety concerns.

In a letter to MIAL, the Airline Operators Committee (AOC) asked for an update on structural safety of T1. "There have been references to structural safety of T1 by MIAL at various forums. The AOC would like to review independent consultant reports that established such concerns," it has said.

The airlines also asked for a detailed redevelopment plan for T1, including its scope, phase-wise execution plan and firm timelines.



UPCOMING RENOVATION Mumbai airport has planned to redevelop a portion of terminal 1B from January 2027 BLOOMBERG

While airlines are supporting safe and timely development of T1, AOC has requested for details of actual capacity utilisation of Terminal 1 and 2 along with declared capacity.

"The AOC member airlines wish to place on record that the proposed 33 per cent reduction (of flights) has not be discussed with or agreed by the AOC committee or the affected AOC member airlines and is currently being proposed as an unilateral measure," it said.

TEMPORARY CLOSURE

MIAL in its October 1 letter had said airlines were called for stakeholder meeting on September 16. "A number of airline partners chose not to participate in the meeting. MIAL nevertheless remains committed to continued stakeholder engagement and reiterates that the development programme and implementation timelines remain unchanged," it said.

Mumbai airport plans to redevelop a portion of Terminal 1B from January. The airport said the 60-year-old Terminal is in need of repairs. It said the partial closure of Terminal 1B will not impact 90 per cent of city's air traffic. Further, it said the airlines have been an option to temporarily relocate operations to Navi Mumbai.

"With Navi Mumbai International Airport now operational and capable of providing an alternative option for airlines and travellers, the planned closure and phased demolition of T1 can no longer be deferred," it added.

Navi Mumbai Airport is offering a 100 per cent discount on landing fees for new international flights. In addition, it plans to offer cash vouchers to international passengers to offset the difference in the User Development Fee levied at Navi Mumbai and Mumbai airports.

FMCG players see strong growth across e-commerce, quick commerce

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi



Leading FMCG players reported a strong growth in alternative distribution channels including quick commerce, e-commerce and modern trade. In recent quarters, FMCG players have been reporting strong acceleration in sales in the overall e-commerce channel led by quick-commerce platforms.

As per an update for the Q2 FY27, food and FMCG conglomerate AWL Agribusiness (formerly Adani Wilmar) indicated that alternate channel, consisting of modern trade, quick-commerce and e-commerce, delivered "double-digit growth". "Within food and FMCG, key categories continued to gain traction across e-commerce and quick-commerce, collectively delivering 40 per cent year-on-year growth. AWL has established a meaningful presence across these channels, with average market shares of over 10 per cent in *atta*, over 25 per cent in *besan*, over 40 per cent in soya nuggets, and around 15–20 per cent across sugar, *suji* and *poha*," the company added.

It also said that execution metrics such as product fill rate and customer retention saw improvement during the quarter, supported by better assortment and availability.

OMNI-CHANNEL SALES

In a BSE filing, Dabur India noted that "emerging channels comprising e-commerce and quick-commerce are expected to report "strong growth momentum" in Q2FY27, led by its continued investments and focus on an omni-channel distribution approach. "Modern trade continues to grow in double digits. General trade continued to grow across both urban and rural markets, with rural continuing to outpace urban, led by continued efforts under Project Saksham," the company added.

Honasa Consumer Ltd, known for brands such as Mamaearth, also noted in its Q2 update that general trade and modern trade channels are expected to post strong growth on the back of its focus on garnering deeper offline distribution.

According to estimates by NielsenIQ, the overall e-commerce channel's share grew to 7 per cent of pan-India FMCG sales in the June quarter. E-commerce channel share of FMCG sales in the top eight metros was pegged at 21 per cent. At the same time in the top 52 cities, the online channel's share of industry sales was estimated at 21 per cent in the June quarter.

PM to open new Metro line in Chennai, launch a slew of projects today

Our Bureau
Chennai

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will be in Chennai on Sunday for a series of events including the opening of a new section of the Chennai Metro and inauguration of projects.

As per an official government statement, at around 11.30 am, he will take a ride on the Chennai Metro from Porur Bypass Station to Poonamallee Bypass Station and back. He will likely be joined by TN CM Joseph Vijay. The PM will also inaugurate the new Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch of Phase II of the Chennai Metro Rail Project, built at a cost of around ₹4,900 crore.

Then, he will perform Darshan and Pooja at the Jalakandeswarar Temple. Thereafter, he will take a walkthrough of the Brain Centre at IIT Madras.

This will be followed by the Prime Minister laying the foundation stone , inaugurating and dedicating various development projects worth over ₹13,000 crore. He will also address the gathering at this occasion.

Finally, the PM will participate in the Golden Jubilee celebrations of Jaigopal Garodia Hindu Vidyalaya Matriculation Higher Secondary School.

He will lay the foundation stone of and inaugurate key National Highway projects worth around ₹3,700 crore.

LOGISTICS PROJECTS

The Prime Minister will dedicate and inaugurate railway infrastructure projects worth over ₹750 crore.

He will inaugurate and lay the foundation stone of several port-related projects in Tamil Nadu to strengthen maritime infrastructure, expand cargo-handling capacity and improve logistics efficiency. This includes four infrastructure projects at Chennai Port: a Paved Storage Yard, four EXIM Godowns, an upgraded Cruise Terminal and a Seafarers Club. Further, Modi will lay the foundation stone of the Group II/III Lube Oil Base Stocks (LOBS) project at the Manali Refinery of Chennai Petroleum Corporation Ltd (CPCL) in Chennai. With a total cost of around ₹1,620 crore and a capacity of 270,000 tonnes per annum, the project aims to produce Group II/III Lube Oil Base Stocks for the manufacture of world-class, premium-quality lubricants in India.At the Sudha Gopalakrishnan Brain Centre (SGBC) at IIT Madras, the PM is set to launch its pioneering global scientific mission to map more than 100 human brains into three-dimensional atlases at cellular resolution, across the human lifespan — from the foetal stage to old age.

PRAYERS FOR ANCESTORS


INVOKING GODDESS DURGA. The devout take a holy dip in the Ganga on the occasion of Mahalaya Tarpan at Babughat in Kolkata on Saturday. With Mahalaya marking the end of 'Pitru Paksha' and the beginning of 'Devi Paksha', devotees perform 'tarpan', a ritual involving the offering of water and prayers in memory of departed ancestors. Mahalaya is also associated with the invocation of Goddess Durga ahead of the Puja festivities. ANI

SEBI to issue AI, ML norms for markets soon

Asian News International
New Delhi

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) will shortly issue guidelines for the responsible use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning in capital markets, while it expects to release guidelines on the settlement price of derivatives on expiry days in about a week, Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Saturday.

Addressing the second Capital Market Confluence 2026 organised by the Bombay Stock Exchange Brokers' Forum, Pandey said the AI framework would follow a tiered approach with clear accountability, data controls, kill switches and human oversight.

On derivatives trading, Pandey said SEBI was examining comments received on a consultation paper addressing concerns on the settlement price of derivatives on expiry days, following a review of the Closing Auction Session.

The regulator hopes to issue guidelines on the matter in about a week.

He also said implementation of changes to bring tender offers, buybacks and offers for sale within the interoperability framework was targeted by the end of November.

Personal-care co Nat Habit raises ₹142 cr in Series C led by Trident Growth Partners

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Nat Habit, a personal care brand built around the all-natural and Fresh Ayurveda positioning, has raised ₹142 crore in a Series C funding round led by Trident Growth Partners, with participation from existing investors including Bertelsmann India Investments, Mirabilis Investment Trust and Sharrp Ventures. The all-primary funding round also included new investors Physis Capital and Hero Family Office. The brand said it has reached an annualised gross revenue of ₹330 crore.

The funds will be deployed to expand its product portfolio, scale distribution across quick commerce and offline retail while deepening its digital reach across Tier 2/3 cities and beyond. In addition, the company will continue to strengthen the formulation and manufacturing capabilities central to its Fresh Ayurveda positioning.

Atul Gupta, Managing Partner, Trident Growth Partners, said, "India's personal-care market is evolving, with consumers increasingly seeking all-natural products they can trust for the whole family. Nat Habit has built a compelling business around Fresh Ayurveda, bringing natural goodness to everyday personal care through advanced in-house R&D, formulation and manufacturing..."

Swagatika Das, Co-founder, Nat Habit, said, "Our ambition now is to make our products accessible to many more households across India. This investment marks an important step in that direction, enabling us to expand our product portfolio, strengthen our presence across quick commerce and offline retail, and reach deeper into emerging markets. We are delighted to welcome Trident Growth Partners as we build on this momentum and take Nat Habit into its next phase of growth."

Founded in 2019 by Swagatika Das and Gaurav Agarwal, the brand's portfolio includes hair-, skin-, body- and baby-care products. It has served over 60 lakh households across India.

No FSSAI or TN notice on paneer items: Milky Mist

Our Bureau
Chennai

Erode-based value-added dairy products company Milky Mist has clarified that it has not received any notice from FSSAI or the Tamil Nadu Food Safety Department directing an inquiry into its paneer products.

The clarification, in a filing to the stock exchanges, comes after some media reports on Thursday alleged that the Central Food Safety Department had instructed the Tamil Nadu Food Safety Department to submit samples of Milky Mist's paneer for laboratory testing. The reports also said that the action was taken after tests revealed poor quality of Milky Mist Paneer.

"The company will appropriately respond to any communication received from the concerned authorities and take necessary action, if any, in accordance with applicable law," it said.

The development comes amid a widespread crackdown on adulterated and analogue paneer by the food safety regulator.

Rain deficit: Gujarat to release Kadana Dam water to save crops in Kheda, Anand districts

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

The Gujarat government will release "198 million cubic metres (mcm) of water from the Kadana Dam to irrigate standing Kharif crops across approximately 80,000 hectares" in the Mahi command area covering Kheda and Anand districts, as the State grapples with a significant rainfall deficit and lower-than-average sowing of several crops.

Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel has approved the release of 5,500 cusecs of water from October 10, according to a statement issued by the Directorate of Information, Gandhinagar.

The intervention comes as Gujarat received 810 mm of rainfall between June 1 and October 10, that is, 89 per cent of the average rainfall for the period. In comparison, the State received 975 mm during the corresponding period last year, nearly 110 per cent of the average. The rainfall deficit widened in early October, with the State receiving just 0.3 mm between October 1-10, against the seasonal average of 11 mm, a shortfall of approximately 97 per cent.


GROWING SHORTAGE. The rainfall deficit widened in early October, with Gujarat receiving just 0.3 mm between October 1-10, a shortfall of approximately 97 per cent REUTERS

The water release is expected to provide irrigation support to farmers in the Mahi command area, particularly those with standing crops that require water as the Kharif season draws to a close.

Farmers in Anand and Kheda together have sown 3.8 lakh hectares this Kharif season, including substantial acreage under paddy, vegetables and tobacco. The two districts account for approximately 2.37 lakh hectares of paddy cultivation, nearly a quarter of Gujarat's total paddy acreage.

SOWING DROPS

Gujarat recorded sowing across 83.42 lakh hectares this season compared with the three-year average of 85.53 lakh hectares. Several oilseed and pulse crops have witnessed a sharp contraction. Sesamum acreage declined 59 per cent to 20,348 hectares against the average of 49,550 hectares, while *moong* area fell 32 per cent to 32,857 hectares from 56,236 hectares. *Guar* seed acreage also declined 40 per cent.

The latest decision follows a series of water-management measures announced by the State government on September 5. The meeting also reviewed the potential impact of the prevailing El Nino conditions on rainfall and water availability.

MORE NARMADA WATER

At a high-level meeting chaired by CM Patel in Gandhinagar, the government decided to allocate additional water from the Narmada Project and extend supplies through existing irrigation networks to support farmers amid concerns over rainfall and reservoir inflows.

As part of those measures, the government approved the supply of 5,000 cusecs of Narmada water to the Mahi command area for 20 days. It also extended water supply through Link-1 of the SAUNI Yojana to Devbhumi Dwarka and Jamnagar by 10 days, while the supply of 2,000 cusecs to North Gujarat through the Sujalam-Sufalam Pipeline Yojana was extended by another 15 days.

US lifts sanctions on Russian diesel sales until April 7

Press Trust of India
Washington

The US on Friday lifted sanctions on the sale of Russian diesel till April 7 next year.

The announcement by the US Department of Treasury came minutes after President Donald Trump spoke with his Russian counterpart, Vladimir Putin, and struck a deal to supply diesel to the US and global markets.

"...all transactions prohibited by the Russian Harmful Foreign Activities Sanctions Regulations... related to the sale, delivery, offloading, or importation, including importation of diesel fuel of Russian Federation origin are authorised through... April 7, 2027," the Treasury Department said.

In a post on Truth Social, Trump said Russia will immediately supply more than 300,000 tonnes of diesel, 500,000 tonnes in November, and one million tonnes immediately thereafter.

Diesel prices surged after Moscow banned exports post Ukraine attacks on its refineries.

Apple cuts components order on iPhone 18 Pro demand dip

Reuters
Bengaluru

Apple has told some suppliers to cut production of components for its newly launched iPhone 18 Pro and iPhone 18 Pro Max, as soaring memory chip costs and price increases have dampened consumer demand, Nikkei Asia reported on Friday.

The iPhone maker has turned more conservative on shipments since early September, with component orders for October slashed by at least 15 per cent compared with what was originally requested, Nikkei reported, citing multiple people familiar with the matter.

Reuters could not immediately verify the report.

Tech companies have been scooping up advanced chip-making capacity and memory chips to power AI data centres, sparking shortages and price increases that are expected to shrink both the personal computer and smartphone markets this year.

RISING COSTS

Apple raised iPad and MacBook prices in June, saying it could no longer shield customers from soaring memory and storage chip costs driven by the AI industry's data centre buildout.

Demand for devices has been softer from late August into October, but that could be related to Apple changing its



launch schedule for iPhone models, Nikkei reported. Apple last month unveiled the latest generation of its flagship smartphone, with iPhone 18 Pro and the 18 Pro Max
handsets, alongside its foldable phone Duo.

As more AI features are added to iPhones and other products, Apple's demand for high-performance memory has increased, elevating the strategic role of suppliers amid a global shortage.

businessline.
Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

Published by Nirmala Lakshman at Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai-600002 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., and Printed by Ra Babu Vijay at THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. Plot B-6 & B-7, CMDA Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu Dist., Pin: 603209. Editor: Raghuvir Srinivasan (Editor responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act). ISSN 0971 - 7528